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Capital deploys amphibious machines to clean key drains

NATION: PG 5
Assam: PM Modi accuses Congress of endangering national security

FILM: PG 14
Priyanka recalls witnessing Vijay's stardom in Chennai

Centre assures ample LPG supply, yet rush continues

LPG PRODUCTION UP 30% TO MEET DEMAND | CRUNCH FUELS CYLINDER THEFTS

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: Even as the government assured on Friday that there is no shortage of petrol, diesel, or cooking gas in the country and urged people not to panic, as ample supplies are available and distribution is proceeding normally, people continued to face hardships and queued up at gas agencies across several cities, towns and rural areas to get LPG refills.

In a press briefing, Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary in the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, said, "To meet the increasing demand for LPG, production of LPG in the country has been increased by 30 per cent, and its supply to households is given top priority."

She further said, "Our refining system is running at full capacity, and we have ample supplies of petroleum products in stock. All our refineries are running normally, and no shortage of petroleum products has been reported from anywhere in the country."

"Supply of domestic LPG for households, hospitals, and educational institutions is given top priority. Commercial LPG cylinders are made available at the disposal of state governments, who can then distribute these as per their requirement." She added, "In addition, an extra allocation of 48,000 kiloliters of kerosene oil has been made. States have been asked to identify places where it may be distributed if needed."

However, the country continues to grapple with the LPG crisis and reports of people making a beeline for getting a refill for their cylinder poured in.

A report quoting local police from Punjab said that a 66-year-old man collapsed and died on Friday morning while queuing for a domestic gas cylinder in Barnala district. The incident took place in the district's Sehna village amid reports of Continued on P4

People queue up to avail LPG cylinders at a gas agency, in Anantnag, on Friday PTI

NO SHORTAGE

- 'Our refining system is running at full capacity, and we have ample supplies of petroleum products in stock'
- 'All our refineries are running normally, and no shortage of petroleum products has been reported from anywhere in the country'
- 'Supply of domestic LPG for households, hospitals, and educational institutions is given top priority'
- 'Commercial LPG cylinders are made available at the disposal of state governments, who can then distribute these as per their requirement'

US REFUELLING PLANE CRASH IN IRAQ KILLS 6

Explosion hits Tehran rally as war rages on

Drone strike in Oman kills two Indians

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: A large explosion rocked an area of Iran's capital where thousands were gathered Friday for an annual state-organised rally to support the Palestinians and call for Israel's demise.

Israel had earlier warned that it would target the area in central Tehran. There were no immediate reports of casualties.

But the decision to proceed with the mass demonstration that was attended by some senior government officials, and Israel's threat to target the area, underscored the fierce determination on both sides nearly two weeks into a war that has rattled the global economy and shows no sign of letting up.

Iran has continued to launch widespread daily missile and drone attacks on Israel and neighbouring Gulf states, and has effectively closed the Strait of Hormuz, through which a fifth of the world's traded oil passes, even as US and Israeli warplanes pummel military and other targets across Iran.

Iran's Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei on Thursday vowed to continue the attacks and keep the strait closed in his first public statement since succeeding his father, who was killed on the opening day of the war.

Khamenei has not been seen in public since taking over leadership, and the written statement was read by a state TV anchor.

US Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth said Khamenei "is wounded and likely disfigured," without providing evidence about the supreme leader's condition or elaborating on how the US knows. Israel suspects Khamenei was wounded at the start of the war. Continued on P4

» SAFE PASSAGE FOR INDIA SHIPS: IRAN

WAR TENSIONS

- Khamenei has not been seen in public since taking over leadership, and the written statement was read by a state TV anchor
- US Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth said Khamenei 'is wounded and likely disfigured", without providing evidence about the supreme leader's condition or elaborating on how the US knows
- Iranian authorities say that more than 1,300 people have been killed there, and Israel has reported 12 deaths
- The US has lost at least 11 soldiers, while another eight have suffered severe injuries

EAM dials Iranian counterpart again

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar spoke to his Iranian counterpart Seyed Abbas Araghchi -- their fourth such conversation since the West Asia crisis began -- as New Delhi intensifies efforts to secure safe passage to 28 merchant vessels currently stationed on either side of the Strait of Hormuz.

The two foreign ministers held the phone conversation on Thursday night. See P4

Stock markets tumble for 3rd day

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: Stock market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended sharply lower on Friday, propelled by heightening conflict in West Asia and surging oil prices. Besides, heavy selling in global markets, persistent foreign fund outflows and weakness in the rupee also dented investors' sentiment. Declining for the third day running, the 30-share BSE Sensex tumbled 1,579.82 points, or 2 per cent, to 74,454.60 during intra-day trade. See P10

"Uttar Pradesh will set new benchmarks in field of education"
Rajnath Singh

In today's paper ...

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'RATH KA MELA'

People gather around a chariot of Lord Ranganatha during the 'Rath ka Mela', near Rangji Mandir in Vrindavan, on, Friday PTI

India, US in talks on trade pact: Ministry

NEW DELHI: India and the US remain engaged in discussions for a mutually beneficial bilateral trade agreement, the commerce ministry said on Friday.

Chief negotiators of the two countries were scheduled to meet last month in Washington to finalise the legal text for the first phase of the bilateral trade agreement, but it was agreed to be postponed following a decision of the US Supreme Court striking down sweeping tariffs of the American administration.

The ministry has denied reports about a hold-off on bilateral engagement.

"We have noted a media report regarding ongoing trade talks with the US. It is denied that there is any hold off in bilateral engagement. It is reiterated that the two sides remain engaged for a mutually beneficial trade agreement," the commerce ministry said in a statement.

The remarks came after the United States Trade Representative (USTR) on March 11 launched a fresh round of Section 301 trade investigations targeting policies and industrial practices of 16 economies, including India and China. Following the US Supreme Court's ruling, President Donald Trump announced 10 per cent tariffs on all countries for 150 days from February 24. And now the US has announced these investigations. See P11

REMOVAL BID BACKED BY 193 MPs

CEC ouster move lands in both Houses

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Opposition MPs have submitted notices in both Houses of Parliament seeking a motion for the removal of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, sources said on Friday.

According to a source, 130 Lok Sabha MPs and 63 Rajya Sabha MPs have signed the notice.

The signatories include members from all the INDIA bloc parties, including the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), which is no longer formally a part of the Opposition alliance, the source said.

Some Independent MPs have also signed the notice while several others have evinced interest in joining the initiative, the source added.

This is the first time a notice has been moved seeking the removal of the CEC.

According to sources, the notice lists seven charges against Kumar, including alleged "partisan and discriminatory conduct in office", "deliberate obstruction of investigation of electoral fraud" and "mass disenfranchisement".

The Opposition parties have accused the CEC of aiding the ruling BJP on several occasions, especially with the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, which they alleged aims to help the saffron party at the Centre.

The process for removing the CEC is similar to that for the removal of a Supreme Court or a high court judge, meaning an impeachment can be effected only on the ground of "proven misbehaviour or incapacity".

In a blogpost published on Friday, TMC Rajya Sabha leader Derek O'Brien said the term "proved misbehaviour" has been interpreted to include deliberate abuse of powers, partisan exercise of constitutional functions favouring one political formation over others and actions that undermine public confidence in the independence and impartiality of Continued on P4

Gyanesh Kumar

The Oppn parties have accused the CEC of aiding the ruling BJP on several occasions, especially with the ongoing SIR of electoral rolls

Flying IndiGo? get ready to pay more

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: IndiGo will start levying fuel charges ranging from Rs 425 to Rs 2,300 on domestic and international flight tickets from March 14 amid the steep surge in jet fuel prices due to the West Asia crisis.

The move will increase the airfares and comes three days after Air India Group announced the introduction of such charges.

For domestic flights and those within the Indian subcontinent, the fuel charge will be Rs 425, while it will be Rs 900 for the Middle East services, the airline said in a statement on Friday.

The fuel charge will be Rs 1,800 for South East Asia, China, and Africa flights, and Rs 2,300 for Europe flights.

Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) accounts for nearly 40 per cent of an airline's operational costs.

For each domestic flight, the fuel surcharge announced by IndiGo is higher compared to the Rs 399 being levied by Air India and Air India Express. Akasa Air and SpiceJet have not announced the levying of fuel charges so far.

While announcing the introduction of the fuel charge, the airline said the measure has been taken due to the significant surge in fuel prices, following the ongoing geopolitical issues in the Middle East.

"While offsetting the entire impact of this fuel price surge requires a very substantial adjustment to fares, IndiGo has introduced a relatively smaller amount as a fuel charge, keeping in mind the consequential burden Continued on P4

TO ALSO HANDLE BENCH ALLOCATION

SC plans AI system for case listing

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: In a move that could mark a significant change in the functioning of the Supreme Court's administrative side, software powered by Artificial Intelligence (AI) will take over case listing and bench allocation in the top court effectively removing human intervention in the process.

The decision was taken by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Justice Surya Kant, according to Bar & Bench.

Currently, cases are allocated to different Benches by the CJI who is the master of roster, a power which bring the office of CJI under immense scrutiny.

The reforms stem from an internal probe that surfaced two systemic failures within the registry - one, registry officials who had dug into their positions over extended periods, and two, outdated technological infrastructure that had long provided cover for administrative lapses including irregular and improper case allocation.

Alongside, the Supreme Court registry has witnessed an unprecedented wave of interdepartmental transfers of registry officials in a bid to Continued on P4

CLOSER LOOK

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Assam: PM attacks Cong; unveils ₹24,250 cr projects

GUWAHATI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday attacked the Congress, accusing it of endangering national security by handing over indigenous people's land to infiltrators, while launching projects worth over Rs 24,250 crore on the first leg of his two-day tour to Assam ahead of the assembly polls.

Modi said the state was writing a new chapter of peace and development under the "double-engine" government and that the BJP-led administration was bringing to an end a "historic injustice" towards the tea garden community by granting them land rights for their homes.

Recalling the days of his profession as a tea seller, Modi charged the Congress with neglecting tea garden workers by denying them land rights for decades.

The Prime Minister unveiled projects valued at over Rs 4,570 crore in Kokrajhar and later launched development initiatives worth Rs 19,680 crore in Guwahati. See P5

VENDORS HIKE PRICES BUT LOSE CUSTOMERS

LPG scarcity leaves Delhi's street food vendors fighting for survival

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Issues with the availability of LPG have begun to disrupt the livelihoods of street vendors across the national capital, forcing many to shutter their stalls or borrow heavily to sustain daily operations.

The disruption has pushed several small-scale traders into financial distress. While some have suspended business, others are buying cylinders at "inflated rates" on the black market to keep their stoves burning. Naresh Chawla, who operates a fast-food stall near PVR Saket, said a single establishment often supports several workers and their families.

"One small shop supports eight to 10 livelihoods. I employ three to four workers who have migrated from villages. Many of us have taken loans to run these stalls. If this continues, 30 per cent of street vendors will lose their means of survival," he said.

He added that the exhaustion of savings is making it difficult for vendors to meet household responsibilities and care for elderly parents.

The disruption is visible across the city. In Adarsh Nagar, a food vendor named Vicky said he paid around Rs 4,000 for a small cylinder. To offset the cost, he increased the price of his dishes by Rs 10, but said many customers immediately walked away after hearing the new rate.

"Customers at street stalls are not wealthy. They tell me if they had more money, they would dine at restaurants," Vicky said. He further said that after paying his staff, he lacked the funds to purchase basic ingredients like paneer, having already borrowed money for his mother's treatment.

Many vendors said they are now dipping into savings or taking loans to manage daily household expenses.

In Sangam Vihar, Upendra Gupta, a tea and samosa vendor, said he managed to stay open only after buying a small LPG cylinder for around Rs 2,200 from the black market. Meanwhile, in northwest Delhi, pani puri seller Rafiq Ahmed was forced to close his stall on Thursday afternoon.

"I simply could not arrange a cylinder," Ahmed said, expressing concern for his workers who send their earnings back to their families in rural areas. "They come from very poor backgrounds. I don't know how to face them when I am struggling to make ends meet myself." Manoj Kumar, a chaat vendor in southeast Delhi, said the shortage has also meant long queues and uncertainty at gas agencies. "We cannot take the LPG (liquified petroleum gas) cylinder from our homes and use it at the stall because then what will we cook for our children?" he said, adding that by the time vendors reach gas agencies, the stock is often exhausted.

The supply situation comes after a government revision of the priority order for allocating domestically produced natural gas, driven by energy supply disruptions linked to the widening West Asia conflict.

A gazette notification prioritised LPG, CNG and piped cooking gas in natural gas allocation. However, street vendors with limited financial reserves continue to struggle, with many considering temporary manual labour until the supply situation improves.

Cops caution people against cyber fraud

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has warned citizens against clicking on suspicious links or trusting calls from unknown numbers claiming to be from gas agencies, cautioning that cyber fraudsters may exploit panic over LPG availability to cheat people.

In a post on X, police said rumours about LPG shortages were being used by scammers to lure users through fraudulent links related to gas booking or supply confirmation. Once clicked, such links may compromise personal or banking details, leading to financial losses. Fraudsters may also pose as gas agency representatives and ask residents to click on links or download files sent through messaging platforms. Police advised people not to open files with the ".apk" extension, which can install malicious applications and give criminals access to sensitive data. Citizens have been urged to verify information through official channels.

Police nab DU student in Lahori Gate murder case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has arrested a 24-year-old DU student for allegedly strangling a woman to death inside a hotel room in Old Delhi's Lahori Gate area, as the victim was "pressuring" him to marry her, an official said on Friday.

Abhishek Tiwari, a resident of Shahdara, has been arrested for the murder of the 25-year-old woman, whose body was found in a hotel room earlier this week, DCP (North) Raja Banthia said. The victim worked as an accountant with a private company in Chandni Chowk.

During interrogation, Tiwari told police that he was pursuing BCom through the School of Open Learning, University of Delhi, and was working as an accountant at a shop in Chandni Chowk, the DCP said.

Police said he met the woman around two years back through a common friend, and they developed a close friendship.

However, of late, the woman was pressuring him to marry her, which he did not want. "Due to the pressure, the accused planned the murder and called her to meet him at a hotel on Church Mission Road on March 11. After having physical relations with her, he strangled her to death with his hands and fled from the spot," the DCP said.

KEY POINTS

- According to the police, accused met the woman about 2 yrs ago through a common friend and they later developed a close friendship
- The woman had recently been pressuring him to marry her, which he did not want: Police
- He allegedly called her to a hotel on Church Mission Road on March 11 and strangled her after meeting her
- The crime came to light around 12.30 am when hotel staff alerted police after getting no response from the room

The matter came to light around 12.30 am on the intervening night of Wednesday-Thursday, when a staff member of the hotel informed the local police that the occupants of a room were not responding to repeated knocks on the door.

"When police forced open the door, a woman was found lying on the bed, partially covered with a blanket. There was blood on the bed and clothes lying nearby. The crime scene has been examined," the officer said.

Police said the woman, a resident of Maujpur in north-east Delhi, lived with her parents, grandmother and younger sister.

She checked into the hotel around noon on March 11 with Tiwari, who was reportedly seen leaving the hotel once around 5 pm after locking the room from the outside.

The woman's family had lodged a missing person report at the Jafrabad police station after she did not return home on Wednesday, with her phone unreachable.

Police will produce the accused, who has been booked under Section 103 (murder) of the BNS, before the concerned court and seek his custody for further questioning, the officer said.

Leaves of Delhi Police personnel cancelled amid LPG supply panic

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has cancelled routine leave for its personnel with immediate effect to maintain law and order amid the LPG supply concerns triggering widespread anxiety among households and businesses.

In an order issued by the Joint Commissioner of Police (Operations), all districts and units have been directed not to grant routine leave to any personnel until further orders.

The communication, dated March 12, stated that leave will be sanctioned only in genuine emergency cases and that too after due verification and approval by the competent authority. "All DCPs are requested to ensure meticulous compliance," the order said, adding that it has the approval of the special commissioner of police (operations).

The directive comes as Delhi Police has increased vigilance across the city due to irregular LPG supplies that have led to complaints of black marketing, panic buying and crowding outside gas agencies in some areas.

Earlier, senior police officials had directed station house officers (SHOs) to prepare lists of gas agencies in their jurisdictions and deploy police personnel near them to maintain law and order and ensure smooth distribution of LPG cylinders.

Police teams, including PCR vans, motorcycle patrol units and plain-clothes personnel, have been stationed near gas agencies to deter hoarding and prevent the illegal sale of cylinders at inflated prices.

Officials said the deployment aims to ensure LPG cylinders reach consumers through proper distribution channels and prevent exploitation of the supply crunch.

Atal Canteens under pressure as city residents turn to them for daily meals

NEW DELHI: The footfall at Atal Canteens across the capital has increased sharply as concerns over dwindling LPG stock have come to haunt city residents in the wake of military escalations in West Asia.

With residents rushing to Atal Canteens to avail daily meals as LPG cylinders at their homes are exhausted, the sudden dependence on these subsidised facilities has resulted in long queues outside the canteens, with food items running out on some evenings.

Abha Shekhar, a resident of Ashram, said her family has been eating at an Atal Canteen twice a day as they have not been able to arrange a gas cylinder for the past few days.

> **"It is close to our home, so we manage. Otherwise, I have no other option to cook food"**

"Since Tuesday, my family has been coming here for lunch and dinner. It is close to our home, so we manage. Otherwise, I have no other option to cook food," she said.

Shekhar said she works as a house help and her husband is a construction worker. The couple has been visiting cylinder distributors every day but they have still not been able to get a refill.

Hemant, who runs a ration shop near the Atal Canteen in Ashram, said he has also started eating at the facility in recent days to save the gas available at his home.

"I have started eating at the canteen for the past few days. Earlier, I never came here, but yesterday and even this morning I brought my family to eat here," he said.

Hemant said he had refilled his gas cylinder around 20 days ago and it is likely to last only a few more days. Until he manages to get another cylinder, he plans to rely on the canteen as the meals are affordable.

Rising footfall at Atal Canteens has led to food shortages, while caterers say LPG supply constraints are affecting meal preparation. PTI

Congress protests outside BJP HQ over LPG shortage

NEW DELHI: Congress workers led by Delhi Pradesh Congress Committee (DPCC) president Devender Yadav on Friday staged a protest outside the Bharatiya Janata Party headquarters at DDU Marg, alleging mismanagement of LPG supplies and rising shortages.

The protesters gathered at Rajiv Bhawan before marching to the BJP office, raising slogans against the government led by Narendra Modi and demanding the resignation of Union Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri.

Some women demonstrators carried gas cylinders and symbolically prepared tea and rotis on an earthen stove to highlight the crisis. Police detained several protesters during the demonstration and later released them from the IP Estate police station. Congress leaders alleged that households were struggling due to the shortage of cooking gas. MPOST

Court declines plea seeking FIR against Kapil Mishra

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Friday dismissed a plea seeking registration of an FIR against Kapil Mishra and others over an alleged incident linked to the 2020 Northeast Delhi riots.

Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate Ashwani Panwar rejected the application filed by Mohammad Ilyas, observing that registration of an FIR was not legally permissible in view of earlier judicial findings. The court noted that a sessions court order dated November 10, 2025 had already set aside a previous magistrate's direction asking police to probe Mishra's alleged role.

The magistrate said the special judge's findings had attained finality and were binding on the court. PTI

UTTAM NAGAR CASE

Social media handles 'spreading rumours' face legal action: Cops

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has initiated legal action against several social media accounts for allegedly spreading rumours and circulating misleading content, including a viral video seeking financial donations, in connection with the recent Uttam Nagar murder case, officials said on Friday.

A video that surfaced on social media on March 10 contained a QR code requesting financial assistance from the public using narratives linked to the incident. During verification, it was found that nearly Rs 37 lakh had already been credited to the suspect bank account in the last two days, they said.

"In view of the potential scam that may be played upon the general public, the manager of the concerned bank branch

has been informed to block all credit and debit facilities of the said account and freeze the amount deposited by the public," Deputy Commissioner of Police (Dwarka) Kushal Pal Singh said.

He added that the police had taken serious note of misleading and inflammatory content circulating on social media following the March 4 clash in Uttam Nagar that led to the death of a 26-year-old man.

Acting swiftly, police coordinated with multiple social media platforms to ensure the removal of such content, he said. "So far, 14 take-down requests under Section 79(3)(b) of the IT Act have been sent to social media platform 'X', while eight similar requests have been forwarded to Instagram for removal of the identified inflammatory content," the officer said.

Police said action has also been initiated against individuals operating social media accounts involved in rumour-mongering and spreading unverified information.

Police warned that spreading misinformation on social media is punishable and strict action will be taken. Earlier, two juveniles and 14 adults were arrested for Tarun's killing during a Holi clash in Uttam Nagar. MPOST

Two arrested by Delhi Crime Branch in fake 'No Entry' sticker fraud racket

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police Crime Branch has arrested two more members of an organised "traffic fraud and extortion" syndicate accused of selling counterfeit stickers to commercial vehicle drivers to bypass enforcement during restricted "No Entry" hours in the capital.

The accused have been identified as Jai Bhagwan (38), a resident of Charkhi Dadri in Haryana, and Shivam Sharma (26) from Farrukhabad in Uttar Pradesh. Police said Bhagwan is one of the masterminds of the network, while Sharma worked as a key associate responsible for distributing the fraudulent stickers used by the gang.

According to investigators, the syndicate facilitated the illegal movement of commercial goods vehicles during restricted hours by selling

counterfeit stickers, locally known as "marka", to drivers and transporters. The stickers were sold for between Rs 2,000 and Rs 5,000 per vehicle each month and were falsely projected as providing immunity from traffic enforcement and challans. The arrests were made during the investigation of two cases registered at the Crime Branch police station following complaints by Delhi Traffic Police personnel. Several drivers of light and heavy commercial vehicles had attempted to evade checking by displaying suspicious stickers, key rings or marks claiming exemption from enforcement.

During the probe, police used technical surveillance and intelligence inputs to uncover what they described as an organised criminal network operating a parallel system of fraud and extortion. Investigators said the accused cheated vehicle owners and drivers while also attempting to intimidate traffic personnel.

TAKEAWAYS

- Syndicate sold counterfeit 'marka' stickers to commercial vehicle drivers to bypass 'No Entry' restrictions
- Stickers were sold for Rs 2,000–Rs 5,000 per vehicle monthly, falsely claiming immunity from traffic checks

Police said the syndicate filmed traffic officers, edited clips to pressure them, while two accused were arrested with fake stickers.

PANEL HEARINGS AT SABARMATI LAWNS FROM MONDAY

Student, teacher bodies to hold 'public inquiry' against JNU VC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The teachers' association and the students' union of JNU have declared a joint "public inquiry" against university vice chancellor Santishree Dhulipudi Pandit, beginning Monday on campus at the Sabarmati lawns.

This follows a recent student referendum conducted by the JNU Students' Union (JNUSU), with a vast majority of those who voted voting that they wanted the VC to resign.

The JNUSU and the JNU Teachers' Association (JNUTA) will present their "chargesheet" against the VC on Monday and Wednesday, respectively.

The "chargesheets" will be presented "before a panel of public figures from different walks of life. An oral presentation of the case will accompany a written submission that will include all relevant documents," JNUTA said in a statement on Friday.

Over 90 per cent of the 2,400-odd students who cast their votes voted in favour of VC Santishree Dhulipudi Pandit's resignation. A section of the students and faculty members claimed that there were over 9,000 eligible voters and most of them refrained from taking part in the exercise.

The university and the students' union have been at loggerheads over multiple controversies. The campus has witnessed continued protests since early February after the university suspended four JNUSU office-bearers, along with former JNUSU president Nitish Kumar, for two semesters.

The suspensions were issued for "extensive damage to university property" during a November 21, 2025, protest at the Dr B R Ambedkar Central Library.

The controversy triggered protests demanding revocation of the suspension order and clashes between student groups. Jawaharlal Nehru University Teachers' Association said the public inquiry aims to present the situation at Jawaharlal Nehru University and allow the administration to present its defence before a final report is released.

Woman held under preventive detention for drug trafficking

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has detained a 41-year-old alleged drug trafficker under the Prevention of Illicit Traffic in Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (PIT-NDPS) Act, an official said on Friday.

The accused, identified as Sonia, a resident of Uttam Nagar, was detained following a preventive detention order issued by the competent authority under Section 3(1) of the PIT-NDPS Act on February 26, police said.

Sonia is a habitual offender with a criminal history dating back to 2009. She has been involved in at least eight criminal cases related to excise violations and narcotics trafficking.

The detention was carried out as part of a crackdown on organised drug trafficking networks in the national capital, the police said, adding that she has been lodged in Tihar jail in compliance with the detention order. According to the police, Sonia's involvement in narcotics trafficking came to light in 2023 when she was identified as the source of supply in a case registered at Uttam Nagar police station under the NDPS Act.

In that case, a man, Ramniwas, was arrested with 1.41 kg of marijuana and Rs 5,960 cash. During interrogation, he allegedly revealed that the contraband had been sourced from Sonia. Police said Sonia was arrested again in 2025 in an NDPS case after an accused claimed he sold ganja on her directions. Authorities later issued a preventive detention order to curb her alleged drug trafficking. MPOST

Delhi Police nabs burglar 'Doremon'

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have arrested a serial burglar nicknamed "Doremon" and his associate in northwest Delhi, solving 11 criminal cases.

Dinesh alias Doremon (26) and Sunny (26) were apprehended on March 11 during night patrolling near Raja Park while dragging a motorcycle later found to be stolen. A spring-actuated knife was recovered from Dinesh.

Police said Dinesh, a "bad character" of Ashok Vihar police station with 17 previous cases, and Sunny confessed to several burglaries. MPOST

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NAJAFGARH, PANKHA ROAD DRAINS

Capital deploys amphibious machines to clean key drains ahead of monsoon

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a major push to strengthen Delhi's drainage system and prevent monsoon waterlogging, the city government on Friday deployed high-tech amphibious excavator machines to clean key drains, including the Najafgarh and Pankha Road drains. The machines, capable of operating in waterlogged and marshy conditions, are expected to accelerate desilting operations and remove years of accumulated silt, garbage and water hyacinth from the city's major drains.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta flagged off the machines at Badusarai Bridge along the Najafgarh Drain and the Pankha Road Drain, marking the launch of a technology-driven initiative to improve the capital's drainage infrastructure. The event was attended by Cabinet Ministers Parvesh Sahib Singh and Ashish Sood, along with senior officials.

Addressing the gathering, the Chief Minister said the deployment of modern machines would significantly strengthen the city's efforts to clean drains and restore the health of the Yamuna river. "Cleaning the Yamuna and freeing Delhi from waterlogging is our commitment. The government is using modern technology with full dedication to clean the city's drains and make the river clean and free-flowing," she said.

Gupta noted that the Najafgarh Drain is the largest drain in Delhi and carries nearly 75 percent of the silt from the city's drainage network. According to estimates, more than 10 million metric tonnes of silt have accumulated in the drain over the years. She said amphibious machines would now make it possible to remove the massive silt buildup more efficiently.

"Earlier it was extremely difficult to remove such large volumes of silt. These floating machines can reach the middle of the drain and remove sludge directly, speeding up the entire cleaning process," she said, adding that the government has also decided to procure additional machines in the coming months.

Cabinet Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said the use of amphibious machines marks an important step in modernising the city's drainage management. "The use of advanced amphibious machines for cleaning the Najafgarh Drain and other major connected drains marks an important step by the Delhi Government. These modern machines will help remove years of accumulated silt, garbage and water hyacinth effectively, improving the water-flow capacity of the drains and reducing waterlogging during the monsoon," he said.

Minister Ashish Sood said cleaning of the Pankha Road drain was an Assembly poll promise, adding it had remained neglected for years and caused waterlogging. He said initial cleaning and partial beautification have been completed within the government's first 100 days.

HIGHLIGHTS

- CM Gupta flagged off the machines at Badusarai Bridge along the Najafgarh Drain and the Pankha Road Drain, marking the launch of a technology-driven initiative to improve the capital's drainage infra
- The event was attended by Cabinet Ministers Parvesh Sahib Singh and Ashish Sood

L-G Sandhu hits ground running

Takes stock of governance, service delivery issues

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Newly appointed Delhi Lieutenant Governor (L-G) Taranjit Singh Sandhu has hit the ground running, holding a series of review meetings with senior officers on Friday. Sandhu took the oath of office and secrecy as the 23rd L-G of Delhi in a ceremony at Lok Niwas on Tuesday.

In a series of posts on X, L-G Sandhu shared details of his meetings with top officers, including Delhi Police Commissioner Satish Golcha, Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar and other officers.

In a meeting with Additional Chief Secretary (Food and Civil Supplies) and Health Secretary Rupesh Kumar Thakur, the L-G reviewed the situation and emphasised on preparedness, coordination and effective response.

Sandhu reviewed the challenges relating to security, law and order, cybercrime and merging unconventional issues, with the Delhi Police commissioner, who called on him.

Various important civic issues, including waste disposal, flattening of garbage mounds in the city, and improving transparency and efficiency in MCD's licensing and enforcement activities, were discussed by the L-G with Commissioner Khirwar.

On the first day after taking the oath, Sandhu on Thursday met the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) vice chairman Sarvana Kumar and discussed sector-specific issues.

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Friday also called on President Droupadi Murmu at Rashtrapati Bhavan. In a post on X, Sandhu said he received guidance from the President during the meeting. "Honoured to call on Hon'ble President of India Smt. Droupadi Murmu ji and receive her guidance for the road ahead. Grateful for her encouragement," he wrote.

The L-G also spent some time walking through the Rashtrapati Bhavan gardens and interacting with visitors. Sharing photographs from the visit, he said it was a pleasure to meet many Delhi residents enjoying the spring blooms. The gardens, known as Amrit Udyan, attract large numbers of visitors every year during February and March when a wide variety of flowers are in full bloom.

ACs and laundry units among upgrades planned at Asha Kiran home: Delhi min

NEW DELHI: Air-conditioners, new laundry units and improved water supply systems are among upgrades being rolled out at the Asha Kiran home in Rohini, Delhi Social Welfare Minister Ravinder Indraj Singh said during an inspection of the facility on Friday.

Singh, conducted an inspection of Asha Kiran Home for men and women at Avantika Sector in Rohini along with senior officials of the social welfare department, and reviewed the ongoing development and renovation works, and the facilities available for residents.

> 'Security is being enhanced with the installation of CCTV systems in droms'

Spread across about 6.04 acres, the institution houses persons with intellectual disabilities and has a capacity of 570 residents.

According to an official statement, around Rs 5.34 crore has been sanctioned to the Public Works Department in FY 2025-26 for upgrading buildings, infrastructure and facilities at the institution.

The works include painting and repairs in dormitories, tile work in toilets and bathrooms, steel work and coil fencing around gym and park areas, and horticulture-related improvements. The institution is also being equipped with two new laundry machines of 60 kg capacity each and installation of air-conditioners as part of the infrastructure push.

To strengthen basic infrastructure, two new borewells are being constructed, CPVC water supply pipelines are being installed and two submersible pumps are being set up. Renovation of the underground water tank and installation of floodlights along the boundary wall are also part of the works.

Security arrangements are also being enhanced with the installation of CCTV systems in the dormitories, according to the statement.

Minister Ravinder Indraj Singh said the government aims to ensure dignified care for residents with disabilities. He directed officials to complete works at Asha Kiran Home and prepare a proposal to repair and operationalise the half-way home in Narela. PTI

Girl jumps onto metro track, hurt

NEW DELHI: A school student was injured after jumping onto the metro tracks at Dwarka Sector 14 metro station on Friday afternoon, allegedly due to stress related to her board examinations, police said. Authorities received a PCR call around 12.58 pm and rushed to the spot. The girl was quickly rescued by metro staff and commuters and taken to a hospital for treatment.

Police said she was conscious and had injuries on both knees. The student said she had been under severe stress due to ongoing board exams. PTI

Delhi ties up with IIT Madras to test 'smog-eating' surfaces

Six-month study will begin with lab testing before moving to field trials to evaluate the effectiveness

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a new technology-driven step to tackle the capital's air pollution challenge, the Delhi government has partnered with Indian Institute of Technology Madras to study innovative "smog-eating" surfaces that could help break down harmful pollutants directly in the urban environment. The initiative aims to test photocatalytic materials that can reduce key pollutants responsible for smog, including nitrogen dioxide and volatile organic compounds.

The Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) for the pilot study was signed on Friday between the Government of NCT of Delhi and IIT Madras. The project will evaluate Titanium Dioxide (TiO_2)-based photocatalytic materials and similar safe catalysts that can help neutralise pollutants when activated by sunlight.

Delhi Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said the government is encouraging scientific innovation to address the city's pollution crisis.

"Through this IIT Madras study, we aim to find the best, long-lasting, and affordable ways to put 'smog-eating' coatings on roads, buildings and city surfaces. It can work in our favour if the study can provide evidence-based findings that such coatings or materials can cut NO_2 and other pollutants," Sirsa said.

Highlighting the government's broader approach to air quality management, he added, "It is essential to find innovative scientific solutions for cleaning Delhi's air, and our government is diligently supporting innovators through such initiatives."

Sirsa further emphasised that the government wants to address pollution without hindering the city's growth. "Delhi's population is growing with urbanisation from nearby areas, expanding our infrastructure rapidly. Our focus, under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, remains on achieving cleaner air for the people without blanket bans. Therefore, we must use science to shield our air and protect our health without halting this vital growth," he said.

The study will be led by Professor Somnath C. Roy of IIT Madras. According to him, the project will begin with laboratory testing before moving to field trials in Delhi.

"The study will begin with lab testing in a smog chamber at IIT Madras to precisely measure pollutant abatement. Following this, our team will conduct real-time field assessments in Delhi's urban environment on surfaces like concrete, asphalt, metal panels, glass and roads," Roy said.

The six-month study will explore multiple applications of the technology, including coatings on roads and buildings as well as special pollutant-removal panels that could be installed on rooftops or street-light poles.

If the results prove successful, the Delhi government may consider scaling up the technology during peak smog months later this year.

Kapil Mishra inaugurates 'Bhakti Sangeet' Fest

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi's Art, Culture and Languages Minister Kapil Mishra on Friday inaugurated the three-day devotional music event 'Bhakti Sangeet' organised by the Sahitya Kala Parishad at Central Park in Connaught Place, highlighting the government's focus on promoting the capital's cultural and spiritual traditions.

The event opened with a devotional performance by renowned singer Anuradha Paudwal, while artists Bhairav Singh Chauhan and Agnihotri Bandhu also performed on the first day.

Addressing the gathering, Mishra said the Delhi government is committed to reviving and promoting the city's cultural heritage. "Restoring the pride of Delhi's original culture is the government's priority. Folk culture and devotional events in Delhi are now being organised with full grandeur," he said.

He added that the capital is steadily moving towards becoming a major cultural hub. "Under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Delhi is emerging as the 'cultural capital' of the country," Mishra said.

Highlighting recent initiatives, the minister said several cultural and religious events have been organised across the city.

"With the support and blessings of Delhiites, every event celebrating folk culture and devotion has gained grandeur," he said.

Mishra also noted that programmes such as Bhajan Clubbing in Delhi University colleges have received an enthusiastic response from the youth. He added that more large-scale cultural events, including a major programme at Red Fort later this month, are being planned to further strengthen Delhi's cultural identity.

Electoral registration officers designated for Delhi assembly constituencies ahead of SIR

NEW DELHI: Ahead of the Special Intensive Revision of the voters' lists in the national capital, the Election Commission has designated ADMs and SDMs as electoral registration officers (EROs) for all the 70 assembly constituencies in Delhi.

The office of Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) is preparing for the SIR exercise, and currently, the mapping of voters of the electoral rolls of 2025 is being done vis-a-vis the voters of the base year 2002.

There were 1.55 crore voters in the Delhi assembly polls for 70 seats held in February 2025.

> **The Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will visit households daily to gather electoral details from each voter for mapping the electoral roll**

A recent gazette notification stated that the Election Commission of India has designated, in consultation with the Delhi government, additional district magistrates (ADMs) and Sub Divisional Magistrates (SDMs) as the EROs. Another notification said that the same officers will also serve as returning officers for these assembly constituencies.

Furthermore, district magistrates have been designated as District Election Officers (DEOs) for the 13 districts in the national capital, reflecting the recent reorganisation of districts in Delhi, which has increased from the previous 11 to 13, officials said.

The CEO's office is preparing for the SIR, and various forms needed for the exercise are being printed out.

In February, the Election Commission of India announced that the SIR is expected to begin in April 2026 and instructed the CEOs of various states, including Delhi, to complete the necessary preparatory work as soon as possible.

Booth Level Officers will conduct daily household visits to update the 2025 electoral roll. The Delhi CEO's office has sought exemption for around 7,500 teachers assigned to this task from census duties, while 8,000–10,000 staff will be deployed for Census 2027 operations. PTI

PLANS HERITAGE-LED REDEVELOPMENT OF OLD DELHI

Delhi to change name of Shahjahanabad Redevelopment Corporation: CM Gupta

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Rekha Gupta government has announced a renewed push to redevelop and preserve the heritage of Old Delhi, with plans to restructure the Shahjahanabad Redevelopment Corporation (SRDC) and accelerate infrastructure projects in the historic area. The decisions were taken during the 38th board meeting of the Shahjahanabad Redevelopment Corporation chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday. The meeting reviewed ongoing development works in the Shahjahanabad area and discussed measures to strengthen the corporation's functioning.

Officials said the government is considering renaming the corporation, with three proposed names to be finalised in order of preference before a final decision is taken.

Addressing the meeting, Gupta emphasised the need to revive Old Delhi while protecting its historical identity. "The time has come for a comprehensive restructuring and revival of the institution. We will not only change the board's name but also use it to accelerate the real redevelopment of Old Delhi and the Shahjahanabad area," she said.

The Chief Minister said the government has initiated several development projects aimed at restoring the historic character of the area while improving civic infrastructure. "Old Delhi is the heart of the national capital. Our goal is to preserve its historical heritage, identity and cultural dignity while introducing modern facilities," Gupta said.

According to officials, development works worth around Rs.160 crore are currently underway on 28 roads in Old Delhi. These include road construction and improvement, beautification of public spaces, strengthening sanitation systems, improving maintenance of public toilets and carrying out large-scale cleanliness drives. A phased plan is also being prepared to place electricity wiring underground across the area.

Gupta also announced plans to develop the historic Town Hall building as a heritage landmark to enhance the cultural appeal of the area.

During the meeting, concerns were also raised about the functioning of the corporation during the previous government's tenure. "Available documents clearly indicate that serious irregularities and corruption were carried out in the name of development works, and these will be thoroughly investigated," Gupta said.

Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood said the review revealed several issues in earlier projects. "The previous government launched projects merely for show and without any concrete planning. Under the leadership of the Chief Minister, we are committed to preparing a comprehensive development strategy that preserves Delhi's cultural heritage and historic residential areas," he said.

TAKEAWAYS

- Officials said the govt is considering renaming the corporation, with three proposed names to be finalised in order of preference before a final decision is taken
- Gupta emphasised the need to revive Old Delhi while protecting its historical identity
- 'Old Delhi is the heart of the national capital. Our goal is to preserve its historical heritage, identity and cultural dignity,' CM Gupta said

Capital gets brief respite as max temp falls to 32.6 deg C

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi experienced a slight decrease in heat on Friday, with the maximum temperature reaching 32.6 degrees Celsius, 3.7 degrees above normal, and the city's air quality improved to the 'moderate' category, with an AQI of 186.

This drop in temperature was welcomed, as the city felt the heat creeping in on Thursday, recording a high of 35.8 degrees Celsius.

Friday began with a warm morning, where the minimum temperature was recorded at 20.4 degrees Celsius, 5.3 degrees above normal and the highest for the year, according to data from the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

Station-wise data showed that Ridge recorded the highest maximum temperature at 33.8 degrees Celsius, 3.6 degrees above normal, followed by Lodi Road at 33 degrees Celsius, 4 degrees above normal.

Ayanagar recorded 32.8 degrees Celsius, 2.8 degrees above normal, and Palam recorded a maximum temperature of 31.5 degrees Celsius, 2.1 degrees Celsius above normal.

For Saturday, the weather office has forecast a partly clear sky, with the maximum temperature expected to settle around 33 degrees Celsius.

On the air quality front, the city's 24-hour average Air Quality Index (AQI) stood at 189. According to the CPCB's SAMEER app, during the evening hours, 15 stations were categorised as 'poor', while 31 stations fell into the 'moderate' category.

In the morning hours, the air quality was also recorded in the 'moderate' category at 9 am, with an AQI reading of 184, CPCB data showed.

On the minimum temperature front, Safdarjung recorded 20.4 degrees Celsius, 5.3 degrees above the season's normal, while Lodhi Road recorded 19.2 degrees Celsius, 5.2 degrees above normal.

Ridge station reported a minimum of 19 degrees Celsius, while Ayanagar recorded a minimum temperature of 19.8 degrees Celsius.

'DISCUSSED BILATERAL MATTERS AS ALSO BRICS RELATED ISSUES'

West Asia crisis: Jaishankar holds 4th phone call with Iranian counterpart

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar spoke to his Iranian counterpart Seyed Abbas Araghchi – their fourth such conversation since the West Asia crisis erupted – as New Delhi intensifies efforts to secure safe passage for over two dozen Indian-flagged merchant vessels currently stationed on either side of the Strait of Hormuz.

The two foreign ministers held the phone conversation on Thursday night.

Jaishankar and Araghchi spoke on February 28, soon after the US and Israel launched the attack on Iran that killed Ayatollah Ali Khamenei. They also spoke on March 5 and March 10.

"Had another conversation with Iranian FM @araghchi yesterday night. Discussed bilateral matters as also BRICS related issues," the external affairs minister said on social media.

S Jaishankar with Iran Foreign Minister Seyed Abbas Araghchi FILE

The latest phone conversation came as India ramped up efforts to secure safe passage to the Indian-flagged merchant vessels through the strategic shipping route of Strait of Hormuz that has been partially blocked by Tehran following an escalation in its conflict with the US and Israel.

Global oil and gas prices have surged after Iran virtually blocked the Strait of Hormuz, a narrow shipping lane between the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman that handles roughly 20 per cent of global oil and LNG (Liquefied Natural Gas).

An Iranian readout said Araghchi briefed his Indian counterpart on the latest situation "resulting from the aggressions and crimes" committed by the US and Israel against Iran and its consequences on the stability and security of the region and the world.

It said the Iranian foreign minister emphasised to Jaishankar Tehran's firm will to exercise the "legitimate right to self-defence".

"Araghchi emphasised the need for international and regional forums and organisations to condemn military aggression against Iran," the readout said.

'Will try our best': Iranian envoy on passage for India's vessels

New Delhi: As several India-flagged vessels remain stranded in the Strait of Hormuz due to the ongoing conflict in West Asia, Iran's Ambassador to India, Mohammad Fathali, on Friday said that "we will try our best" to resolve the issue. Interacting with reporters on the sidelines of an event here, Fathali said, "We believe that Iran and India are friends. We have common interests, we have common faith." As the war entered its fourteenth day, with no end in sight, the Iranian envoy said, "Iran doesn't want war, but Iran is ready for war." While US President Donald Trump told reporters on Wednesday that "we're not finished yet", Iran continued to remain defiant and used the choking of the strategic Strait of Hormuz as leverage against the US-Israel combine. AGENCIES

AMRUT Mitra Mahotsav: Women driving change in urban water mgmt

'It should not only be limited to service delivery': Khattar

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) launched the AMRUT Mitra Mahotsav in New Delhi, highlighting the increasing trend of women SHGs leading the charge for urban water management under the aegis of the Ministry's AMRUT 2.0 initiative.

Under the aegis of Union Minister Manohar Lal Khattar, the national-level event saw the attendance of over 1,000 women, along with 300 officials from 30 states and Union Territories.

AMRUT Mitras from Arunachal Pradesh, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha, Tamil Nadu, Chhattisgarh, and Karnataka from different states spoke at the event, sharing their roles in water quality testing, billing, water collection, faecal sludge management, and the operation and maintenance of water assets, thereby emphasising the growth of livelihoods as well as the increasing trend of community engagement with the initiative.

> The national-level event saw the attendance of over 1,000 women

Addressing the audience, Khattar stated, "Water management should not only be limited to service delivery, but the movement should become a people's movement with a sense of 'Jan Bhagidari'." The involvement of women is essential for water management, as they are the primary water managers at both household and community levels." He further added that the participation of SHGs has increased the efficiency of services, transparency, and the connection between the people and ULBs. He said that by enabling women in the management of water in urban areas, the people have become owners of efficient water management systems.

The Union Minister further said that the government plans to expand the scope for women from SHGs in water reuse and recycling, digital water management, smart metering systems, etc. He further added that women from SHGs will be entrusted with the responsibility for conducting IEC activities for water conservation.

The Union Minister mentioned that the government has recognised the importance of water reuse by planning it as a major component in the AMRUT 2.0 programme. He said that the AMRUT Mitras will be used for creating awareness among the people on water reuse, which will be backed by the efforts taken by the people for water recycling.

Today, over 45,000 SHG women are participating in the programme from 1,910 cities in 34 states and UTs. The government plans to expand the scope for women from SHGs by scaling up the AMRUT Mitra programme from 1,900 cities to 5,000 cities.

Pending MGNREGS dues to states Rs 9,300 crore in FY26: Govt to RS

NEW DELHI: Pending liabilities to states under the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme stood at more than Rs 9,300 crore in FY 2025-26, with Uttar Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh and Karnataka topping the chart with the highest outstanding amounts, the government informed the Rajya Sabha on Friday.

In a written reply, Minister of State for Rural Development, Kamlesh Paswan, said the total pending liabilities across states and Union territories were Rs 9,308.67 crore as of February 9, 2026. According to the data tabled in the House, Uttar Pradesh had the highest pending liabilities at Rs 1,158.71 crore, followed by Andhra Pradesh at Rs 1,014.60 crore, Karnataka Rs 746.65 crore, Tamil Nadu Rs 729.88 crore, Madhya Pradesh Rs 704.64 crore, Bihar Rs 664.72, Maharashtra Rs 528.28 crore and Assam at Rs 482.51 crore.

The other states with significant pending liabilities included Kerala (Rs 419.09 crore), Odisha (Rs 411.64 crore), Jharkhand (Rs 385.02 crore) and Rajasthan (Rs 383.24 crore). AGENCIES

Cong MLAs moved to HP before RS polls in Hry

CHANDIGARH/ SHIMLA: In an attempt to keep its flock together, Congress on Friday moved its Haryana MLAs to Himachal Pradesh ahead of the polling for two Rajya Sabha seats in Haryana on March 16, according to sources.

BJP's Sanjay Bhatia, Congress' Karamvir Singh Boudh and BJP-backed Independent candidate Satish Nandal are in the fray for the polls.

The party legislators left Chandigarh late afternoon.

The sources said that the Congress MLAs, who arrived in Shimla in three buses around 8 pm, have been lodged in two hotel in Kufri in the suburbs of Shimla city and 37 rooms have been booked for them.

However, the state government and officials are tight-lipped on the matter.

One of the resorts also has ample open space for airlifting. Earlier, a viral video showed a motorcade of Congress MLAs en route to Shimla crossing Solan. Congress with 37 members in the Assembly has the required strength to help its candidate win a seat. The prospects, however, could be in jeopardy in case of cross-voting.

While Congress leaders and MLAs who attended a legislature party meeting here did not disclose the destination they were headed to, sources said that they have been moved to Himachal Pradesh, a neighbouring state ruled by the party. The MLAs will return shortly before the voting, they said.

The Congress MLAs assembled at the residence of CLP leader Bhupinder Singh Hooda, where the meeting was held, and later on most legislators left in two tempo travellers.

Hooda asserted that not only will his party candidate win, but may get over and above 37 votes.

Haryana Congress president Rao Narender Singh and party general secretary incharge of Haryana, B K Hariprasad, party MPs including Deepender Singh Hooda and Varun Chaudhary were also accompanying the party legislators. However, at least five legislators were not going due to prior family engagements or health reasons. AGENCIES

From Page 1

Centre assures

a shortage of cooking gas due to the ongoing conflict in West Asia.

The deceased, Bhushan Kumar Mittal, was a resident of Sehna and had arrived at the gas agency at 7:15 am to secure a spot in the queue. Sehna station house officer (SHO) Renu said that Mittal collapsed at approximately 8 a m, just minutes before the agency was scheduled to open. Many in the queue had reportedly been waiting since 6 am. Police said that Mittal was 25th in a line that had swelled to over 130 people by the time of the incident.

A shortage of commercial Liquefied Petroleum Gas (LPG) cylinders has begun affecting hotels, restaurants, small eateries, boarding schools, and colleges across several towns in Uttarakhand, raising concerns ahead of the tourist and wedding season.

In Mussoorie, several hotels are already facing a crisis due to the limited availability of commercial LPG cylinders. Mussoorie Hotel Association president Sanjay Agarwal said they submitted a memorandum through the Sub-Divisional Magistrate (SDM)'s office to the chief secretary, chief minister, and cabinet minister Ganesh Joshi, highlighting the disruption.

Many hotels have stopped serving food items that require higher LPG consumption and may have to shut their kitchens if the situation persists, association secretary Ajay Bhargava said, adding that families who had booked hotels for weddings are also facing difficulties.

Besides hotels, boarding schools are also affected due to the shortage of commercial LPG cylinders. The administrator of Mussoorie's Guru Nanak Fifth Centenary Day Boarding School, Sunil Bakshi, said the institution, which serves food to more than 250 students, is struggling to maintain kitchen operations.

Domestic consumers are also facing difficulties. Rajendra Semwal, a resident of Camel's Back Road in Mussoorie, said the missed-call booking system for LPG cylinders was not functioning, forcing households to use charcoal stoves and induction cooktops.

At the press conference, the senior Petroleum and Natural Gas ministry official said: "More than 50 lakh LPG cylinders are being distributed daily through more than 25,000 distributors, and more than one lakh petrol pumps are running normally across the country."

Domestic PNG connections and CNG for transportation are being provided in full, while supplies in some industries have been curtailed for household consumption.

Sujata Sharma added that in recent days, bookings for LPG have increased as people are doing panic buying. However, she maintained that supplies were going on normally.

In an appeal to people, Sharma said, "We urge people not to rush for refills. Most people are able to book their cylinders online through mobile apps, IVRS, SMS, and WhatsApp. There is no need for people to queue up."

As India grapples with a persistent LPG supply crisis, reports of cooking gas cylinder thefts have emerged from Bengaluru. At least two separate instances of cylinder pilferage from residential neighbourhoods have been confirmed in Karnataka's capital city.

A video posted by the PTI on X showed a man arriving at a residential street on a motorbike and subsequently fleeing with a cylinder concealed within a sack. This particular theft occurred in the Kalyan Nagar district of Bengaluru.

India is in its fourth consecutive day of LPG shortages, with disruptions being reported across major cities of the country, including Mumbai, Bengaluru, and Kolkata, and Chennai.

The US-Israel attacks on Iran and Tehran's retaliation have led to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz, a key sea route through which India gets 85-90% of its LPG imports from West Asian nations, including Saudi Arabia and Qatar.

On the procurement front, India has been steadily reducing its dependence on the Strait of Hormuz. Roughly 70% of crude oil imports now arrive via alternative routes, up from 55% previously — a shift that offers some buffer against regional disruptions.

Amid the shortage, many restaurants are prioritising serving vegetarian dishes to customers, which generally require shorter cooking times.

People lined up in snaking queues outside distribution outlets across India today as the LPG shortage continued and reports of hoarding made rounds, according to a PTI report.

Long queues were seen at various gas centres in Patna, Bhagalpur, Rohtas, Katihar and other districts of Bihar despite the district administrations claiming there was no shortage of domestic gas cylinders.

Amid LPG supply shortage, hotels and restaurants in Madhya Pradesh are turning to the traditional 'tandoor' and electric appliances to sustain their businesses, PTI reported.

In its advisory, the Madhya Pradesh Hotel Association (MPHA) asked members to ditch gas for traditional wood-fired 'tandoors' and switch to 'crisis menus' to keep their businesses afloat. It has also asked eateries to prioritise dishes that require lower gas usage or shorter cooking cycles.

Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu said there is no shortage of LPG and dismissed reports about the hoarding of gas cylinders in the state, PTI said adding that he cautioned the public against fake news. Sukhu added that the Centre has assured there will be no shortage of gas supplies in Himachal Pradesh.

Explosion hits

With growing global concerns about a possible energy crisis and no end to the war in sight, the price of Brent crude oil, the international standard, remained over USD 100 per barrel.

Brent prices have spiked as high as about USD 120 per barrel and are about 40 per cent higher than when Israel and the US launched the war on February 28.

The explosion rocked the Ferdowsi Square area midday, where thousands had gathered for an annual Quds Day rally. Israel had issued a warning on a Farsi-language X account for people to clear the area shortly before the blast.

Senior security official Ali Larijani, who was also at the Quds Day demonstrations, told Iranian media covering the event that the suspected Israeli attack was a "sign of its desperation."

Israel had earlier announced another wave of strikes in Iran targeting infrastructure, and said its air force had hit more than 200 targets in the last 24 hours, including missile launchers, defence systems and weapons production sites.

In Washington, Hegseth said that over 15,000 enemy targets have been struck, which is more than 1,000 a day since the war began on February 28.

In a social media post hours earlier, US President Donald Trump had said "watch what happens to these deranged scumbags today," while claiming that Iran's military had been decimated and that its leaders had been "wiped from the face of the earth."

Iran has been attacking oil and other infrastructure around the Gulf region, and on Friday Saudi Arabia said that it had downed nearly 50 drones sent in multiple waves.

In Oman, two people were killed when two drones crashed in an industrial area in the region of Sohar, the Oman News Agency reported.

In the business and tourism hub of Dubai, black smoke billowed from an industrial area from a blaze that authorities said was sparked by debris from an interception.

Iran said earlier this week that it would target banks and financial institutions, after an airstrike hit a bank in Tehran.

In Turkiye, NATO defences intercepted another ballistic missile fired from Iran, the third time since the war began. Residents in the southern city of Adana reported hearing a loud explosion and sirens sounding at Incirlik Air Base, which is used by US forces, in the early hours of the day.

Nearly 60 people were wounded in northern Israel after the Lebanon's Iran-backed militant group Hezbollah said that it had fired several rocket salvos toward the area and at Israeli troops in southern Lebanon. Almost all the injuries were described as very minor.

One person was killed in southwestern Beirut in an Israeli strike, according to the Lebanese Health Ministry, and another attack hit an apartment in the capital, leaving it engulfed in flames. The Israeli military said it had targeted a Hezbollah member.

In eastern Lebanon, a strike on an apartment wounded a local official with the Lebanese branch of the Muslim Brotherhood and killed his two sons, the state-run National News Agency reported. For the past two years, Israel has targeted officials with the group.

More than 600 people have been killed in Lebanon since the fighting began, the Health Ministry has reported, and nearly 800,000 have been internally displaced, according to the UN refugee agency.

Iranian authorities say that more than 1,300 people have been killed there, and Israel has reported 12 deaths. The US has lost at least 11 soldiers, while another eight have suffered severe injuries.

The US military said that four of six crew members of an American KC-135 refuelling plane that went down in Iraq had been found dead and that recovery efforts were ongoing to find the other two.

US Central Command said that the crash wasn't related to friendly or hostile fire, and that two aircraft were involved, including one that landed safely.

The KC-135 is the fourth publicly acknowledged aircraft to crash as part of the US military's operations against Iran. Last week, three American fighter jets were mistakenly downed by friendly Kuwaiti fire.

Iran's secretive new leader issued his first public statements Thursday, resolving to keep fighting, promising more pain for Gulf Arab states and threatening to open "other fronts" in a war that has already disrupted world energy supplies, the global economy and international travel.

The hard-line stance revealed by Supreme Leader Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei came as Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said his country's attacks were creating conditions for the Iranian population to topple the government.

"It is in your hands," Netanyahu said at a news conference, addressing the Iranian people. "We are creating the optimal conditions for the fall of the regime."

President Trump posted a new threat to Iran's leaders Friday on his Truth Social website, saying: "They've been killing innocent people all over the world for 47 years, and now I, as the 47th President of the United States of America, am killing them," Trump wrote. "What a great honour it is to do so!"

Meanwhile, two Indian nationals were killed and 10 others injured in a drone strike in Oman's Sohar city on Friday that marked the first Indian fatalities on land since the Iran-US conflict erupted on February 28.

Joint secretary (Gulf) in the Ministry of External Affairs Aseem Mahajan confirmed the killing of the two Indians in Oman at an inter-ministerial media briefing on the crisis in West Asia.

He also said that 150,000 Indian nationals have returned to India from West Asia after the conflict began.

"I wish to share with you an incident that happened in Sohar city today. There was an attack and in this incident two Indian nationals have died," he said.

"We express our deepest condolences to their families. Of the 11 injured (in the attack), 10 are Indians. Out of them, five have been discharged after receiving treatment, and five others are receiving treatment in local hospitals," Mahajan said.

"None of them is reported to have serious injuries. Our mission is in close touch with the concerned company and local authorities and is rendering all assistance," he said.

CEC ouster

the CEC, amongst other attributes.

He pointed out that in the last 75 years, India has had 25 CECs and "neither House of Parliament has ever brought a removal motion against the CEC".

Calling submitting the notices in both Houses a "strong messaging", O'Brien said members of the opposition are using "every constitutional tool available to protect the sanctity of India's glorious institutions".

"However, if the notice is not taken up by the Union government, doubts will be raised about a tacit understanding between the executive and the CEC," he said.

Article 324(5) of the Constitution says the CEC shall not be removed from office except in like manner and on like grounds as a judge of the Supreme Court, and the conditions of service of the CEC shall not be varied to his disadvantage after his appointment.

The motion for removal may be introduced in either House of Parliament and must be passed by a special majority -- a majority of the total membership of the House and a two-thirds majority of the members present and voting. The law on the appointment of CEC and election commissioners says, "The CEC shall not be removed from his office except in the like manner and on the like grounds as a judge of the Supreme Court," and the other election commissioners shall not be removed from office "except on the recommendation of the CEC".

According to the Judges (Inquiry) Act, 1968, if the notice for the motion is given on the same day in both Houses of Parliament, no committee shall be constituted unless the motion has been admitted in both Houses.

After the motion has been admitted in both Houses, a committee shall be constituted jointly by the Lok Sabha speaker and the Rajya Sabha chairman.

The committee will consist of the chief justice of India (CJI) or a Supreme Court judge, the chief justice of one of the 25 high courts, and a "distinguished jurist".The committee proceedings are like any court proceeding where witnesses and the accused are cross-examined.

The CEC, too, will get a chance to speak before the committee.

According to the rule, once the committee submits its report, it will be tabled in the House and discussions will commence for impeachment.

The motion to remove a judge, and in this case the CEC, will have to be passed by both Houses.

When the House discusses the motion, Kumar will have the right to defend himself standing at the entrance of the House chamber. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Flying IndiGo?

on customers," the airline said.

From 00:01 hours on March 14, overall prices for all new bookings on IndiGo flights will include the fuel charge, a statement said.

While regretting the inconvenience resulting from the fuel charge, IndiGo said it would continue to monitor the situation and make relevant adjustments as and when appropriate.

On March 10, Air India and Air India Express announced that they would levy a fuel charge of Rs 399 on each domestic flight ticket from March 12 and also hiked the charge for international bookings due to a steep rise in jet fuel prices. The revised rates came into effect from March 12.

SC plans AI

dismantle years of entrenched incumbency and systemic inefficiency. A second round of transfers is expected before the end of the month. The trigger was a glaring lapse uncovered during proceedings before a bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice Vipul Pancholi, which was hearing a petition filed by Irfan Solanki challenging the Uttar Pradesh Gangsters and Anti-Social Activities (Prevention) Act, 1986, on grounds of repugnancy with Section 111 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023.

The State of Uttar Pradesh brought to the court's notice that a near-identical challenge in Md. Anas Chaudhary v. State of Uttar Pradesh had already been dismissed by a three-judge bench comprising former Chief Justice of India DY Chandrachud, Justice PS Narasimha and Justice Dipankar Datta on December 12, 2022, with a direction to the petitioner to pursue remedies before the competent forum.

Despite the dismissal, a similar petition had found its way onto the cause list before a fresh bench.

CJI Kant took strong exception to the lapse. Though Senior Advocate Shoeb Alam sought to withdraw the plea, CJI Kant had directed that it will remain pending before the Court and will be taken to a logical conclusion. The CJI had then announced that a deeper administrative probe would follow.

LAUNCHES PROJECTS WORTH RS 24,250 CRORE

Assam: PM Modi accuses Congress of endangering national security

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GUWAHATI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday attacked the Congress, accusing it of endangering national security by handing over indigenous people's land to infiltrators, while launching projects worth over Rs 24,250 crore on the first leg of his two-day tour to Assam ahead of the Assembly polls.

Modi said the state was writing a new chapter of peace and development under the "double-engine" government and that the BJP-led administration was bringing to an end a "historic injustice" towards the tea garden community by granting them land rights for their homes.

Recalling the days of his profession as a tea seller, Modi charged the Congress with neglecting tea garden workers by denying them land rights for decades.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Assam Governor Lakshman Acharya and state CM Himanta Biswa Sarma during the foundation stone-laying and inauguration ceremony of various development works, in Guwahati, Assam, Friday PTI

The Prime Minister unveiled projects valued at over Rs 4,570 crore in Kokrajhar and later launched development initiatives worth Rs 19,680 crore in Guwahati.

In the first programme of the day, Modi addressed a public meeting in Kokrajhar district virtually from Guwahati after rain disrupted his travel schedule.

He said the sounds of bombs and gunfire because of insurgency are a thing of the past, and asserted that the BJP ensured long-lasting peace in the region, while the Congress, during its tenure, signed various accords for "selfish political interests."

"The Congress has endangered national security by handing over the land of indigenous people to infiltrators," the PM said, alleging that the grand old party was always in league with the infiltrators and never legally granted land rights to the state's indigenous population.

Highlights

- 'State writing a new chapter of peace and development under the double-engine govt'
- Modi charged the Congress with neglecting tea garden workers by denying them land rights for decades

The Congress handed over Adivasi land to the infiltrators, and in districts like Dhubri and Goalpara, the situation was grim, affecting Kokrajhar's demography, he claimed.

"I am happy Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma is leading a major drive to clear land from encroachment, and the BJP government has handed rights to the indigenous people," the PM said.

Modi alleged that Kokrajhar has witnessed the betrayal of the Congress for decades, as the Opposition party had made false promises.

"The Congress signed peace accords just for show and for selfish interests, but the BJP worked for permanent peace, and ensured the development of Bodoland," Modi said.

He said that hills of Bodoland echoed for decades with sounds of guns and bomb blasts, but "now those days are over, and it is moving ahead in the path of peace and development". In an apparent reference to Rahul Gandhi's 'Mohabbat ki Dukaan' (shop of love) slogan, the Prime Minister claimed: "The Congress is a 'jhute vaido ke dukaan' (a shop of false promises), and with one lie it gives four more 'super lies' as a gift, as they do not intend to fulfill any promise."

LPG CRISIS

Oppn protests in Parl, questions PM's absence from House

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Opposition MPs on Friday held a protest in the Parliament Complex over the LPG crisis issue, and raised slogans demanding answers from Petroleum Minister Hardeep Puri and Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

TMC MPs started the protest around 10.30 am on Friday outside the Parliament building, holding posters, chanting "LPG crisis", and raising slogans attacking the ruling BJP, questioning "where did the gas cylinders go?"

They were joined by MPs from Congress and other INDIA Bloc parties.

Opposition MPs also raised slogans accusing Prime Minister Modi of "vanishing" along with the gas cylinders, and accused him of "surrendering."

"There's an acute crisis of LPG in the country. People are panicking. You can see that even in Bengal, because systems are crashing at the main distributors, they're resorting to manual bookings," TMC MP Mahua Moitra said.

"You have families, old people, young parents standing in queue waiting to book their cylinders, and the government is putting out this information that you can get your cylinders in two and a half days... We challenge the prime minister, challenge ministers to go and find out where people are getting their cylinders within two and a half days on booking," she said.

She said the petroleum minister "lied to the country" and said that India has 75 days' worth of supplies.

"Now they've invoked the Essential Commodities Act and said that there are barely 25 days. All we get are lies. And where is the prime minister? The prime minister has not come to the house for the last five days," she said.

Opposition urges govt, Speaker to revoke suspension of 8 MPs

NEW DELHI: The Opposition has urged the government and Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla to revoke the suspension of seven Congress members and one CPI-M MP who were suspended during the first part of the Budget session for "unruly behaviour".

Congress general secretary K C Venugopal, SP's Dharmendra Yadav, NCP (SP)'s Supriya Sule, DMK's Kanimozhi and TMC's Shatabdi Roy met Parliamentary Affairs minister Kiren Rijiju on Thursday and called for revoking the suspension of the eight opposition MPs, Congress sources said.

According to sources, Rijiju assured them that he would take up the matter with the Speaker. MPOST

Govt okays Rs 1,912.99 cr additional disaster aid for 5 states, J&K

NEW DELHI: The Centre has approved Rs 1,912.99 crore in additional financial assistance to five states and the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir affected by floods, flash floods, cloudbursts, landslides and cyclone 'Montha' in 2025, an official statement said on Friday.

The decision was taken by a high-level committee (HLC) chaired by Union Home minister Amit Shah, it said.

According to the statement, the five states are Andhra Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh, and Nagaland.

"Of the total amount, Rs 341.48 crore has been approved for Andhra Pradesh, Rs 15.70 crore for Chhattisgarh, Rs 778.67 crore for Gujarat, Rs 288.39 crore for Himachal Pradesh, Rs 158.41 crore for Nagaland and Rs 330.34 crore for Jammu and Kashmir," it said.

> According to statement, the five states are Andhra Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh, and Nagaland

This assistance is over and above the funds already released to states under the State Disaster Response Fund (SDRF), it said.

During the Financial Year 2025-26, the Centre has released Rs 20,735 crore to 28 states under the SDRF and Rs 3,628.18 crore to 21 states under the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), it said.

In addition, Rs 5,373.20 crore has been released to 23 states from the State Disaster Mitigation Fund (SDMF), while Rs 1,189.56 crore has been provided to 21 states under the National Disaster Mitigation Fund (NDMF), it said. MPOST

'Govt compromised country's energy security'

Rahul attacks govt, invokes Ambedkar, Kanshi Ram to reach out to Dalit voters

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi launched a sharp attack on the Centre while attempting to reach out to Dalit voters by praising BR Ambedkar and Kanshi Ram.

Addressing party workers in Lucknow, Gandhi targeted Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the BJP and the India–US trade and energy arrangements, alleging that the government had compromised the country's energy security.

He claimed that Union minister Hardeep Singh Puri had been named in the Epstein files and alleged links between the minister's family and funding from George Soros. Gandhi also said Modi was "psychologically finished" and accused him of working in the interests of the United States rather than India.

LoP in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi addresses the 'Samvidhan Sammelan', in Lucknow, Friday PTI

"Prime Minister Modi has compromised the country's energy security because the United States will now decide where India buys oil from. The situation in the energy sector will worsen," Gandhi said.

Invoking Dalit icons, Gandhi said Kanshi Ram had spoken about equality in society and argued that the Congress had not done enough in the past. According to him, that gap helped Kanshi Ram emerge as a powerful leader in Uttar Pradesh politics.

"If the Congress had done its work properly, Kanshi Ram would not have succeeded. If Jawaharlal Nehru were alive today, Kanshi Ram would have been a Congress chief minister," Gandhi said. He also accused the BJP of dividing society into "15 and 85 per cent", alleging that benefits were concentrated among a small section.

Gandhi further alleged that the Modi government does not follow the ideological principles of the Constitution. He said the voices of Dalit leaders are reflected in the Constitution while figures such as Vinayak Damodar Savarkar and Nathuram Godse are not part of its ideological framework.

Criticising the government over trade ties with the US, Gandhi claimed India would import goods worth about Rs 9 lakh crore from the United States. "I want to ask what will happen to our businesses. Cotton, soyabean, fruits, almonds and walnuts from American farmers will enter the Indian market and destroy local producers," he said.

Gandhi also called for stronger commitment from party workers in Uttar Pradesh. "Congress only needs 100 people in UP who are ready to sacrifice everything and say they will not step back from the goal. Then our work will be done," he said.

'Samridhi Yatra': Nitish launches projects worth Rs 816 cr in Saharsa, Khagaria

SAHARSA/KHAGARIA: Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar on Friday launched several development projects worth around Rs 816 crore in Saharsa and Khagaria districts during his 'Samridhi Yatra'.

The CM also reviewed ongoing schemes and development projects in the two districts.

According to a statement issued by the chief minister's office, "The CM launched more than 125 schemes/projects, worth Rs 512 crore in Saharsa. These included the inauguration of 70 schemes worth Rs 286 crore and laying the foundation stone for around 20 schemes, worth Rs 90 crore. Besides, the CM also launched 35 schemes worth Rs 136 crore." MPOST

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

EXAM SPECIAL TRAINS-2026

It is notified for the information of all concerned that following exam special trains will be run by Northern Railway on following dates to facilitate the candidates appearing in Uttar Pradesh Police (SI) Recruitment and Promotion Board Exam-2026:-

04510/04509 Saharanpur Jn.-Ghaziabad-Saharanpur Jn. Unreserved Special Train — 04 Trips

Train No.: 04510		↓ STATIONS ↑	Train No.: 04509	
ARR.	DEP.		ARR.	DEP.
----	11:30	Saharanpur Jn.	22:30	----
14:45	----	Ghaziabad	----	19:00

DATE OF RUN: 04510 Ex Saharanpur Jn. on 14.03.2026 & 15.03.2026 and 04509 Ex Ghaziabad on 14.03.2026 to 15.03.2026.
STOPPAGES: Tapri, Nagal, Talheri Buzurg, Deoband, Rohana Kalan, Bamanheri, Muzaffarnagar, Jaruda Naraa, Mansurpur, Khatauli, Sakhoti Tanda, Daurala, Pabli Khas, Meerut Cantt., Meerut City, Partapur, Mohiuddinpur, Modinagar, Muradnagar, Duhai, Guldhar & Naya Ghaziabad stations.
ACCOMMODATION: General.

04350/04349 Bijnor-Bareilly Jn.-Bijnor Unreserved Special Train — 04 Trips

Train No.: 04350		↓ STATIONS ↑	Train No.: 04349	
ARR.	DEP.		ARR.	DEP.
----	04:20	Bijnor	18:20	----
08:50	----	Bareilly Jn.	----	13:00

DATE OF RUN: 04350 Ex Bijnor on 14.03.2026 & 15.03.2026 and 04349 Ex Bareilly Jn. on 14.03.2026 to 15.03.2026.
STOPPAGES: Haldaur, Chandpur Siau Halt, Gajraula Jn., Amroha, Moradabad & Rampur stations.
ACCOMMODATION: General.

04247/04248 Lucknow Jn.-Shahjahanpur Jn.-Lucknow Jn. Unreserved Special Train — 04 Trips

Train No.: 04247		↓ STATIONS ↑	Train No.: 04248	
ARR.	DEP.		ARR.	DEP.
----	04:10	Lucknow Jn.	16:10	----
07:15	----	Shahjahanpur Jn.	----	13:00

DATE OF RUN: 04247 Ex Lucknow Jn. on 14.03.2026 & 15.03.2026 and 04248 Ex Shahjahanpur Jn. on 14.03.2026 to 15.03.2026.
STOPPAGES: Malihabad, Sandila, Balamau Jn. & Hardoi stations.
ACCOMMODATION: General.

04430 Saharanpur Jn.-Ghaziabad Unreserved Special Train — 02 Trips

STATIONS ↓	Train No.: 04430	
	ARR.	DEP.
Saharanpur Jn.	----	16:10
Ghaziabad	21:10	----

DATE OF RUN: 04430 Saharanpur Jn. on 14.03.2026 to 15.03.2026.
STOPPAGES: Tapri, Nagal, Talheri Buzurg, Deoband, Rohana Kalan, Bamanheri, Muzaffarnagar, Jaruda Naraa, Mansurpur, Khatauli, Sakhoti Tanda, Daurala, Pabli Khas, Meerut Cantt., Meerut City, Partapur, Mohiuddinpur, Modinagar, Muradnagar, Duhai, Guldhar & Naya Ghaziabad stations.
ACCOMMODATION: General.

Temporary extension of 54424/54423 Hisar-New Delhi-Hisar Passenger up to Aligarh Jn. — 04 Trips

Train No.: 54424		↓ STATIONS ↑	Train No.: 54423	
ARR.	DEP.		ARR.	DEP.
----	05:20	Hisar	----	22:50
No change between Hisar-New Delhi-Hisar				
09:40	10:00	New Delhi	17:30	18:20
13:00	----	Aligarh Jn.	----	14:00

DATE OF RUN: 54424 Ex New Delhi on 14.03.2026 & 15.03.2026 and 54423 Ex Aligarh Jn. on 14.03.2026 to 15.03.2026.
STOPPAGES: Tilak Bridge, Anand Vihar Halt, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad Jn., Maripat, Dadri, Ajaibpur, Dankaur, Wair, Chola, Sikandarpur, Khurja Jn., Danwar, Somna, Kulwa & Mahrawal stations.
ACCOMMODATION: General.

04422/04421 Ghaziabad - Moradabad - Ghaziabad Unreserved Special — 04 Trips

Train No. 04422		↓ STATIONS ↑	Train No. 04421	
Arr.	Dep.		Arr.	Dep.
--	10:00	Ghaziabad	21:15	—
12:40	--	Moradabad	--	18:00

Days of Run: 04422 Ex Ghaziabad and 04421 Ex Moradabad on 14.03.2026 & 15.03.2026
Accommodation: General
Stoppages: Hapur, Gajraula Jn. & Amroha Stations.

04548/04547 Saharanpur Jn-Meerut City-Saharanpur Jn. Unreserved Special — 04 Trips

Train No. 04548		↓ STATIONS ↑	Train No. 04547	
Arr.	Dep.		Arr.	Dep.
--	13:20	Saharanpur Jn.	18:20	—
15:40	--	Meerut City	--	16:00

Days of Run: 04548 Ex Saharanpur Jn. and 04547 Ex Meerut City on 14.03.2026 & 15.03.2026
Accommodation: General
Stoppages: Tapri, Nagal, Talheri Buzurg, Deoband, Rohana Kalan, Bamanheri, Muzaffarnagar, Jaruda Naraa, Mansurpur, Khatauli Sakhoti Tanda, Daurala, Pabli Khas & Meerut Cant Stations.

04220 Lucknow-Varanasi Jn. Unreserved Special — 02 Trips

STATIONS ↓	Train No. 04220	
	Arr.	Dep.
Lucknow	--	18:20
Varanasi Jn.	23:45	--

Days of Run: 04220 Ex Lucknow on 14.03.2026 & 15.03.2026
Accommodation: General
Stoppages: Barabanki Jn, Daryabad, Rudauli, Ayodhya Cantt, Ayodhya Dham Jn, Goshain Ganj, Akbarpur Jn, Malipur, Shahganj Jn & Jaunpur Jn Stations.

04222 Lucknow-Prayagraj Sangam Unreserved Special — 02 Trips

STATIONS ↓	Train No. 04222	
	Arr.	Dep.
Lucknow	--	17:45
Prayagraj Sangam	Open Timing	--

Days of Run: 04222 Ex Prayagraj Sangam on 14.03.2026 & 15.03.2026
Accommodation: General
Stoppages: Bachhrawan, Harchandpur, Rae Bareli Jn, Fursatganj, Gauriganj, Amethi, Maa Chandika Devi Dham Antu, Maa Belha Devi Dham Pratapgarh Jn, Bishnathganj, Mau Aimma, Siwaith, Phaphamau Jn & Prayag Jn Stations.

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'HARMFUL TO THEIR GROWTH'

SC rejects hearing on menstrual leave policy

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday refused to entertain a PIL seeking a nationwide policy providing paid menstrual leave for women students and workers, observing no one would give them jobs in such a scenario and that such a provision would unintentionally reinforce gender stereotypes.

The top court, however, asked the Centre and competent authorities to consider the representation of the PIL petitioner and examine the possibility of framing a policy on menstrual leave after consulting all relevant stakeholders.

A bench comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi observed that while the intent behind the petition might be welfare-oriented, the practical reality of the job market could lead to "counter-productive" outcomes for women.

"These pleas are made to create fear, to call women inferior, that menstruation is something bad happening to them... this is an affirmative right... but think about the employer who needs to give paid leave," the bench observed.

Senior advocate MR Shamsad, appearing for the petitioner, said the Karnataka government has formulated a policy to allow menstrual leave and some private organisations are also providing this facility.

"Voluntarily they are giving, then it is excellent. That is a very good thing. But the moment you introduce it as a compulsory condition in law, you do not know the damage it will do to the career of women. Nobody will give them responsibilities, even in judicial services, a normal trial will not be assigned to them," the CJI said.

Highlights

- The top court, however, asked the Centre and competent authorities to consider the representation of the PIL petitioner
- The bench observed that the while petition might be welfare-oriented, the practical reality of the job market could lead to "counter-productive" outcomes for women
- During the hearing, the bench highlighted the risk of "unintended consequences", suggesting that a mandatory leave policy might discourage private employers from hiring women
- "Nobody will give them responsibilities... This can be harmful to their growth," the bench added.

During the hearing, the bench highlighted the risk of "unintended consequences", suggesting that a mandatory leave policy might discourage private employers from hiring women.

"The moment you introduce it as a compulsory condition in law, you do not know the damage it will do to the career of women," CJI Kant remarked.

"Nobody will give them responsibilities... This can be harmful to their growth," the bench added.

Justice Bagchi echoed these concerns from a business perspective, noting that affirmative action is constitutionally recognised but must be balanced against market realities.

"Look at the practical reality in the job market. The more unattractive the human resource, the less is the possibility of assumption in the market. Will any employer be happy with the competing claims of other genders," Justice Bagchi asked.

The bench was hearing a PIL filed by Shailendra Mani Tripathi.

At the outset, the bench raised the issue of locus of the PIL petitioner and pointed out that no woman herself has approached the court.

It was the third petition filed by Tripathi on the same issue.

The first petition was dealt by the bench in 2023 and it allowed the petitioner to give a representation before the Union Ministry of Women and Children.

The petitioner approached the court in 2024 again on the ground that the Centre did not respond to his representation. The PIL was disposed of in July 2024 again with the direction to the government to take a decision.

"These petitions are deeply rooted, designed PILs. You are not a bona fide petitioner. This is basically only to create a type of impression in young women that you still have some natural issues and you are not at par with male persons and you cannot work like them during a particular time," the bench observed initially.

Gas 'crunch' hits people across India

Govt advises against 'panic booking'; says uninterrupted LPG supply to households ensured

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Panic reigned in the streets on Friday as a scramble for domestic gas made people queue up across states, eateries shut shop, and reports of hoarding made rounds, even as the Centre insisted there was no shortage of LPG in the country.

The Centre on Friday said uninterrupted LPG supply to households has been ensured, and there is no need for panic booking for cylinders.

Briefing the media, Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary in the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, said the domestic production of LPG has already increased by 30 per cent since March 5. "There is no need for panic booking, and there has been no dry out at any LPG dealer," Sharma added.

LPG bookings have surged to 75.7 lakh against an average of 55.7 lakh in the pre-war period, "showing panic booking", she said.

People wait in a queue for LPG cylinders, in Mumbai, on Friday PTI

All the same, long queues were witnessed outside LPG distribution centres across Bihar despite the district administrations claiming there was no shortage of domestic gas cylinders.

People turned up in large numbers at distribution agencies in Patna, Bhagalpur, Rohtas, Katihar and other districts.

The West Asia conflict has impacted the supply of crude oil and petroleum products, following the closure of the Strait of Hormuz, a narrow passage of water between Iran and Oman.

In Delhi, the gas crunch sent small-scale traders into financial distress.

Naresh Chawla, who operates a fast-food stall near PVR Saket, said a single establishment often supports several workers and their families.

"One small shop supports eight to 10 livelihoods. I employ three to four workers who have migrated from villages. Many of us have taken loans to run these stalls. If this continues, 30 per cent of street vendors will lose their means of survival," he said.

In the city's Adarsh Nagar, a food vendor named Vicky said he paid around Rs 4,000 for a small cylinder.

Many vendors said they are now dipping into savings or taking loans to manage daily household expenses.

In UP also several districts were afftecte.

In Prayagraj's Jhunsi area, tensions escalated to the point where police had to be called after a dispute broke out at a gas agency. The agency office was briefly shut amid the chaos.

In Shahjahanpur's Jalalabad, angry consumers blocked the Bareilly–Farrukhabad highway around 10 am after they failed to receive LPG cylinders. Police reached the spot soon after and managed to persuade the protesters to clear the road.

Ireland's Attorney General to visit India

NEW DELHI: As part of the Irish government's global celebrations marking St. Patrick's Day, Ireland's Attorney General, Rossa Fanning SC, will visit India from 16 March for a two-city programme in New Delhi and Mumbai.

St. Patrick's Day provides an important opportunity to showcase Ireland internationally and engage with political, business, civil society, cultural and diaspora leaders.

During his visit, Fanning will meet senior ministers from the Indian government and members of the judiciary to discuss areas of mutual interest, including cooperation on legal and governance matters. He will also deliver public lectures at Jawaharlal Nehru University and Mumbai University. MPOST

National dialogue on online crimes launched

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In an attempt to upgrade the response to cybercrimes against women and children, Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan has launched the National Dialogue on Online Crimes Against Women and Children (OCWC) here on Thursday. The dialogue was meant to stress the need for better coordination and the establishment of proper institutional mechanisms to combat cybercrimes in our increasingly digital society.

The dialogue was organised by the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) under the Ministry of Home Affairs. The dialogue was meant to bring together all the key players to discuss the best way to combat cybercrimes against women and children effectively.

The move is also a step towards the government's efforts to ensure a safe, secure, and dignified digital space for women and children in the country under the leadership of Prime Minister Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah.

Mohan highlighted the increasing challenges posed by cybercrimes as our society is becoming increasingly digital. He also emphasised the need for states and union territories to develop their institutional mechanisms to combat cybercrimes against women and children by establishing specialised units to deal with cybercrimes.

Mohan also asked law enforcement agencies across the country to focus on cases involving online crimes against women and children. He asked these agencies to respond quickly and cohesively.

NHRC steps in, seeks reports on missing children from 5 states

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) has taken suo motu cognisance of a media report which highlighted the fact that a huge number of cases of missing persons are pending in Bihar, a majority of whom are children.

The media report states that between 12,000 and 14,000 cases of missing persons are registered every year in the state of Bihar since 2013. However, only two-thirds of the missing children have been found so far.

The NHRC has observed that "the matter is of serious concern to the Commission". The contents of the media report, if true, reveal serious violations of human rights.

> Observed that "the matter is of serious concern to the Commission"

The Commission is also concerned about the fact that even after taking various measures to deal with the issue of missing persons, the number of such cases is increasing while only a few cases are being successfully solved."

According to the report, based on data provided by the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB), it was observed that the highest numbers of human trafficking cases were registered in Odisha, Bihar, Telangana, and Maharashtra. Among these states, Odisha reported the highest numbers of cases related to the trafficking of minor boys, followed by Bihar. In the case of trafficking of minor girls, the highest numbers of incidents were reported in Rajasthan.

The media report, which was released on March 9, 2026, also raised concerns that some of these missing children could be engaged in illegal activities such as begging, child labour, prostitution, etc.

To address this issue, the NHRC has directed the Chief Secretaries of Bihar, Odisha, Telangana, Maharashtra and Rajasthan, along with their respective Directors General of Police, to provide information on this issue within two weeks.

Centre says HP delays land, funds

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In order to enhance strategic infrastructure development and accelerate regional development, the Centre on Friday highlighted a number of railway projects that are at different stages of development in Himachal Pradesh. It also highlighted that delays in acquiring land and the state government's delayed financial commitments have hindered work on a few projects.

In a reply to the Rajya Sabha on Friday, Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said that the work on the rail line between Nangal Dam and Daulatpur Chowk on the Amb Andaura-Mukerian rail line has been completed. The work on the remaining stretches that connect Himachal Pradesh with Punjab and the Jammu route is ongoing. Besides, the minister confirmed that the 60-km rail line between Nangal Dam and Daulatpur Chowk has already been completed. The work on the 42-km rail line between Daulatpur Chowk and Mukerian is ongoing. The work on the 10.5-km rail line between Daulatpur Chowk and Kartoli in Punjab has already been completed. The work on the rail line between Kartoli and Talwara and the rail line between Talwara and Mukerian is ongoing.

Also, while replying on the Floor of the House, the minister for railways explained the details of the two major projects undertaken by the Railways. The first is the Chandigarh-Baddi rail line, which is a 33-km stretch. This Rs 1,540 crore project is being undertaken with equal funding from the Centre and the Himachal Pradesh government. The work is underway, with 75 per cent of the viaduct work completed. However, the work is now stalled as the Himachal Pradesh government has not paid its share, with a balance of Rs 186 crore still pending from the state government.

The second major rail line under the Railways is the Bhanupalli-Bilaspur-Beri line, which is a 63-km stretch. This line is being undertaken with 75% funding from the Centre and 25% from the state.

Progressive Punjab Investors' Summit secures Rs 10K cr on Day 1

NEW DELHI: The Progressive Punjab Investors' Summit 2026 began on a strong note in Mohali on Friday, with investment commitments worth over Rs 10,000 crore on the opening day and major industry leaders announcing expansion plans in the state.

Addressing investors and industry leaders, AAP National Convenor Arvind Kejriwal said the Punjab government would provide every facility needed for industries to compete with China, asserting that a business-friendly environment had already helped attract Rs 1.50 lakh crore in investments in four years. He highlighted how the CM Bhagwant Mann-led government has introduced a 45-day single-window clearance system and is building a business-friendly ecosystem focused on human capital, industrial growth and large-scale job creation for youth. Mann said the summit marked the beginning of a new phase of economic growth, employment and industrial expansion, as the state positions itself as a major investment destination with faster approvals, pro-industry policies and a focus on education, healthcare and skilled manpower.

Arvind Kejriwal and Bhagwant Mann during the inaugural ceremony PTI

Addressing the Summit, Mann stated: "In a major boost to the industrial development of the state, the Punjab government has roped in leading industries to invest. It is a matter of immense pride and satisfaction that on the very first day of the summit the state has secured investments worth more than Rs 10,000 crore. Major industry leaders such as HMEL, Tata Steel, JSW, Trident Group, Hero Industries and several others have announced plans to expand and set up their ventures in the state."

He continued: "Punjabis are known for their entrepreneurial abilities, innovation and problem solving spirit. You will rarely find a Punjabi begging because our people believe in hard work and are doers." MPOST

INAUGURATES 3-DAY 38TH VASANT UTSAV IN PANCHKULA

Hry CM Saini stresses on environmental initiatives

SWATI MAHAJAN

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday inaugurated the three-day 38th Vasant Utsav at the Town Park in Sector-5, Panchkula. For the first time in the 37-year history of the Utsav, it is being organised on the lines of the Surajkund Mela.

On the occasion, the cactus garden, Asia's largest, which had remained closed for nearly a year for maintenance, was also reopened for the public.

Earlier, the CM was welcomed at the venue in traditional style with a ceremonial turban, dhol-nagadas and musical instruments. He visited the flower exhibition organised during the festival and showed keen interest in various varieties of flowers displayed in the cut, dry and fresh flowers sections. He also visited stalls showcasing products made by self-help groups.

Addressing the gathering as the chief guest, the CM said that "the festival is a vibrant celebration of our culture, love for nature and social harmony, and has become a major attraction for people across the state".

Speaking on environmental issues, the CM said: "The world today is facing serious challenges such as global warming and environmental pollution, and these problems can only be addressed through conservation of nature." He said the Haryana government is continuously implementing initiatives to increase green cover, promote water conservation and protect biodiversity.

Under the Pran Vayu Devta Pension Scheme, a provision has been made to provide an annual pension of Rs 3,000 for the maintenance of trees older than 75 years. So far, 3,819 trees have been identified, and Rs 2 crore 5 lakh has been disbursed as pension to those who are taking care of these trees. In addition, 1,541 more trees have been identified under the scheme.

Saini reviews schemes to strengthen vehicle scrapping

CHANDIGARH: Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini chaired a meeting in Chandigarh to review the implementation of various incentive schemes under the Haryana Registered Vehicle Scrapping and Recycling Facility Incentive Policy–2024, aimed at promoting the vehicle scrapping and recycling sector in the state. During the meeting, emphasis was laid on encouraging the scientific and environmentally responsible scrapping and recycling of old vehicles, while also attracting investment and generating new employment opportunities in the state. Haryana Industries and Commerce Minister Rao Narbir Singh joined the meeting through video conferencing. MPOST

Rly electrification nears completion in TN; Infra boost ahead of polls

'Over 97% of broad-gauge lines electrified', new trains run

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Centre informed the Parliament on Friday that railway electrification across the country is being accelerated with a mission-mode focus. Currently, 99.4% of the broad-gauge network is electrified.

In a written reply to the Rajya Sabha, Rail Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw stated that in Tamil Nadu, which is preparing for upcoming elections, electrification has reached 97%. The minister highlighted that efforts are also underway to make rail journeys more comfortable for passengers.

Between April 2021 and February 2026, the railways have added 295 train stoppages in Tamil Nadu and launched 52 new trains, including 16 Vande Bharat and 12 Amrit Bharat trains.

Under the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme, 77 stations are being developed, with 20 already completed, including Chidambaram, Karaikkudi Junction, Pollachi Junction, Srirangam, and Tiruvannamalai.

Ashwini Vaishnaw speaks in the House on Friday PTI

The railways have recently completed infrastructure projects covering over 1,700 km, aimed at enhancing connectivity in the state. However, the Ministry noted that the Tamil Nadu government needs to expedite land acquisition for pending projects.

Budgetary allocations for railway infrastructure and safety projects in Tamil Nadu have seen a sharp rise. The average annual allocation increased from Rs 879 crore during 2009–14 to Rs 6,626 crore in 2025–26, more than seven times higher. As of April 1, 2025, 15 projects covering 1,700 km have been sanctioned, including nine new lines, three gauge conversions, and three doubling works, totaling Rs 22,808 crore. Of this, 665 km has been commissioned, with an expenditure of Rs 7,591 crore.

Recently completed projects include gauge conversions (Dindigul–Palani–Pollachi, Pollachi–Palghat, Mayiladuturai–Thiruvarur–Karaikkudi, Quilon–Tirunelveli–Tiruchendur) and doubling works.

Over Rs 1K cr been spent on Aadhaar: Govt

NEW DELHI: The Centre told Parliament on Friday that the Aadhaar programme has cost the government thousands of crores since it began in 2009, with expenditure exceeding Rs 1,600 crore in some recent financial years as the biometric ID program expanded to nearly all Indians. In a written reply to the Rajya Sabha, Jitin Prasada, the Minister of State for Electronics and Information Technology, said that Aadhaar has become the largest biometric identity program in the world with nearly 134 crore live Aadhaar numbers.

The government expenditure on the Aadhaar program began at Rs 26.21 crore in 2009-10 and increased over the years. Expenditure increased to Rs 1,187.5 crore in 2011-12. MPOST

CBI grills Anil Ambani's son

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) on Friday questioned Jai Anmol Ambani for over six hours in connection with a bank fraud case of Rs 228 crores involving Reliance Home Finance Limited.

The agency had summoned Ambani to the headquarters of the CBI in Delhi as part of the investigation into the case. Ambani was produced before the investigating officer of the case and was examined for 6.5 hours. The agency has asked him to appear before it on Friday for further questioning.

The CBI had registered a case on December 6, 2025, against Reliance Home Finance Limited, Jai Anmol Ambani, Ravindra Sudhalkar, and unknown public servants regarding an alleged bank fraud of Rs 228.06 crores.

According to the CBI, the case was registered on the basis of a complaint received from Union Bank of India that the company had engaged in a criminal conspiracy, cheating, and criminal misconduct that caused wrongful loss to the bank.

Vinai Saxena takes oath as 4th L-G of Ladakh

LEH/JAMMU: Vinai Kumar Saxena on Friday took oath as the Lieutenant Governor of the Union Territory of Ladakh, eight days after President Droupadi Murmu appointed him to the constitutional post.

Saxena, who succeeds Kavinder Gupta, was administered the oath of office and secrecy by Chief Justice of the High Court of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh, Justice Arun Palli, at a ceremony held at the Arya Nagarjuna Auditorium of the Central Institute of Buddhist Studies in Choglamsar, an official spokesman said.

Earlier, Chief Secretary Ashish Kundra read out the warrant of appointment issued by the President, following which Saxena signed the charge certificate.

Following the swearing-in ceremony, he was accorded a ceremonial guard of honour by Ladakh Police.

He is the fourth LG of the Union Territory and succeeds Gupta, who took over as LG on July 18, 2025, and resigned from the post on March 5 this year to take up a new assignment as the governor of Himachal Pradesh.

> Saxena succeeds Kavinder Gupta. He described Ladakh as "crown of India"

Talking to the media after the ceremony, the LG expressed his gratitude to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah for entrusting him with the responsibility of serving the people of Ladakh.

Describing Ladakh as the "crown of India", he assured that he would work wholeheartedly in accordance with the aspirations and requirements of the people.

Highlighting his development approach, Saxena said that he intends to visit villages and remote areas across Ladakh to understand the problems faced by people on the ground and identify practical and sustainable solutions.

He said Ladakh possesses tremendous tourism potential and emphasised that one of his key priorities would be to make Ladakh one of the most beautiful and sought-after tourism destinations in the country and the world. AGENCIES

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EDITORIAL

CHOKEPOINT?

India's decision to temporarily reintroduce kerosene for household use and allow hotels and restaurants to switch to coal and other alternate fuels is a reminder of how quickly global geopolitics can reshape everyday life. The move, prompted by disruptions in West Asia that have effectively shut the Strait of Hormuz, illustrates the extent to which the country's energy security remains vulnerable to distant conflicts. For millions of households and businesses, the consequences of a war thousands of kilometres away have suddenly become tangible in the form of altered fuel supplies, rationed LPG cylinders and a return to fuels that policymakers had spent years trying to phase out. In ordinary circumstances, the reappearance of kerosene as a cooking fuel would appear like a reversal of policy. In the current situation, however, it reflects a pragmatic response to a global crisis that has disrupted one of the world's most critical energy transit corridors.

The Strait of Hormuz occupies a unique place in the global energy system. The narrow waterway between Iran and Oman serves as the primary maritime exit for oil and gas producers in the Gulf, carrying roughly a fifth of the world's oil and a significant portion of liquefied natural gas. For India, the route is particularly vital. The country imports nearly 88 per cent of its crude oil requirements, half of its LNG needs and a substantial share of the LPG used in households. A large portion of these imports travels through the strait, making any disruption to shipping lanes immediately consequential. The current conflict, which escalated after military strikes and retaliatory attacks in West Asia, has halted the steady flow of tankers through the corridor. What might otherwise appear to be a distant geopolitical flashpoint therefore becomes a direct challenge to India's energy supply chains.

Yet the crisis also reveals the complex layers of India's energy dependence. While crude oil supplies can be replaced relatively quickly through purchases from other producers such as Russia, the United States or Africa, LPG presents a different challenge. India consumes more cooking gas than it produces domestically, meaning imports remain essential to meeting demand. A significant portion of these imports has traditionally come from Gulf producers whose shipments must pass through the Strait of Hormuz. Finding alternative supplies is possible, but it involves longer shipping routes and logistical adjustments that cannot happen overnight. In such circumstances, the government's priority has been clear: protect household cooking fuel supplies even if that means temporarily restricting commercial consumption and allowing businesses to shift to other fuels.

The reintroduction of kerosene carries symbolic weight because it represents a step back from a policy direction India has pursued for more than a decade. Successive governments invested heavily in expanding access to cleaner cooking fuels, particularly through initiatives such as the Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana, which provided millions of low-income households with LPG connections. Cities like Delhi proudly declared themselves kerosene-free as part of efforts to reduce pollution and eliminate the risks associated with the fuel's misuse and adulteration. That long transition away from kerosene was intended not only to improve public health but also to modernise household energy consumption. Its temporary return underlines how fragile those gains can be when external shocks disrupt supply chains.

At the same time, the government has been careful to emphasise that the country is not facing a broader fuel shortage. Petrol and diesel supplies remain stable, refineries are operating at high capacity, and crude oil imports have been diversified across a larger pool of suppliers. In recent years India has consciously expanded its network of energy partners, purchasing crude from around forty countries compared with fewer than thirty earlier. That diversification has helped cushion the impact of disruptions in any single region. Even so, the current episode demonstrates that diversification alone cannot eliminate vulnerability when a single maritime corridor carries such a large share of global energy trade. The Strait of Hormuz remains one of the world's most consequential choke points, and any prolonged disruption there inevitably reverberates across energy markets.

Another challenge confronting policymakers has been the risk of panic buying. Reports of rising LPG bookings in recent days reflect a familiar pattern that accompanies supply scares. When households fear shortages, they often attempt to secure additional cylinders, creating the very pressure they are trying to avoid. The government's decision to increase the minimum refill interval and expand delivery authentication measures is therefore aimed at preventing hoarding and diversion. By regulating commercial consumption and monitoring distribution more closely, authorities hope to ensure that essential sectors such as hospitals, educational institutions and households continue to receive priority access to fuel. Such measures may appear restrictive, but they are designed to stabilise supply in the midst of uncertainty.

The broader lesson of the current crisis lies in the reminder that energy security cannot be separated from geopolitics. India has made significant progress in diversifying its energy sources and strengthening its refining capacity, yet the country's dependence on imported fuels remains substantial. As long as large volumes of oil and gas move through a handful of maritime corridors, conflicts in distant regions will continue to carry domestic consequences. The temporary measures announced by the government are therefore best understood as crisis management rather than a structural solution. They buy time while supply chains adjust and alternative shipments arrive.

Ultimately, the situation also underscores the need for a deeper long-term shift in India's energy strategy. Reducing dependence on imported fossil fuels through expanded domestic production, renewable energy development and improved storage capacity would help insulate the country from external shocks. Such transitions, however, require sustained investment and planning. For the moment, India must navigate the immediate disruptions caused by the conflict in West Asia while ensuring that essential fuel supplies reach households and businesses. If the Strait of Hormuz remains closed for an extended period, the pressure on supply chains will intensify. But even if the crisis subsides soon, it should leave policymakers with a clear message: energy resilience is not merely an economic concern, but a strategic imperative in an increasingly uncertain world.

CONFLICT WATCH

A War the Gulf Didn't Choose

While the conflict's strategic drivers lie elsewhere, the Gulf states are bearing the immediate costs — from disrupted energy infrastructure and aviation to a shaken reputation for stability

ASIF ULLAH KHAN

THE WRITER HAS WORKED IN SENIOR EDITORIAL POSITIONS FOR MANY RENOWNED INTERNATIONAL PUBLICATIONS

Even if we set aside the controversial argument advanced by Tucker Carlson—that the war with Iran is primarily driven by Israel rather than the strategic interests of the United States—the consequences for the Gulf states are already unmistakable.

Carlson has argued that the conflict "happened because Israel wanted it to happen," describing it as a struggle for regional hegemony rather than a war fought primarily for American national security. He also suggested that Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu seeks to weaken several Gulf states, even though some of them now maintain diplomatic relations with Israel.

Whether one accepts or dismisses that interpretation, the broader reality is clear: the countries of the Gulf Cooperation Council are paying a heavy price for a war they neither started nor control. And the costs extend beyond economic disruption. The conflict has also damaged the carefully cultivated image of the Gulf as a sanctuary of stability for tourism, investment and global commerce.

Across Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, Qatar, Kuwait and Bahrain, the war has exposed how vulnerable the Gulf's economic model is to regional escalation. Energy infrastructure, aviation hubs and tourism centres have all been disrupted, while attacks on ports and shipping lanes threaten the flow of oil and gas through the Strait of Hormuz. In effect, regardless of whose strategic goals triggered the conflict, the Gulf states have become the frontline economies of the war.

For decades, the Gulf has transformed itself from a sparsely populated desert into one of the world's most interconnected economic regions.

As missiles and drones strike critical infrastructure, the Gulf's carefully built reputation for stability faces its most serious test

Its cities are global aviation crossroads. Its ports connect energy markets across continents. Its financial centres attract investors from every corner of the world.

Yet this prosperity rested on a fragile assumption: that regional wars would remain somewhere else.

That assumption is now under strain.

Iranian missile and drone attacks have targeted economic infrastructure across the region. Energy facilities operated by QatarEnergy at Ras Laffan and Mesaieed Industrial City were damaged, forcing the world's largest liquefied natural gas producer to halt operations. Saudi Arabia's Ras Tanura refinery—one of the most important oil processing centres in the world—has also been struck, alongside oil infrastructure in the UAE.

The war has also dealt a severe blow to the Gulf's aviation and tourism sectors—two pillars of its economic diversification strategy.

Dubai International Airport, the world's busiest hub for international passengers, suspended operations following strikes near the Jebel Ali port complex. Abu Dhabi's airport experienced a fatal incident, while drone strikes damaged Kuwait International Airport's passenger terminal. Qatar closed its airspace and grounded the fleet of Qatar Airways.

For the first time in recent memory, all GCC states experienced simultaneous airspace closures. Tourism during the Ramadan season—normally one of the region's most lucrative periods—collapsed almost overnight, with losses expected to exceed $40 billion.

But the reputational damage may prove even greater.

Videos of explosions in Dubai, Doha and Manama—and scenes of stranded tourists attempting to flee overland—have punctured the Gulf's carefully cultivated image as a haven of stability in an otherwise turbulent region. Iranian strikes on luxury hotels in Dubai and residential towers in Bahrain carried a powerful message: even the Gulf's most prestigious economic symbols are not immune from regional conflict.

Beyond tourism and energy, the war has also exposed deeper structural vulnerabilities. In an arid region with few natural resources, daily life depends on fragile networks of pipelines, ports and desalination plants that provide water and electricity to tens of millions of residents.

The Arabian Peninsula has no major rivers or lakes. Nearly all drinking water comes from desalination plants connected to coastal power stations. These facilities—responsible for roughly half of the world's desalination capacity—are highly exposed to missile or drone attacks.

Even if the war ends soon, its consequences will linger long after the missiles stop flying.

The conflict has revealed how easily advanced infrastructure can be threatened by relatively inexpensive drones and missile systems. It has also raised uncomfortable questions about the limits of existing air-defence systems and the reliability of external security guarantees.

As a result, military spending across the Gulf is almost certain to surge. Governments will likely invest billions more in missile defence, drone interception technologies, cybersecurity and hardened infrastructure protection.

But those investments will come at a cost.

For years, Gulf governments have poured resources into ambitious diversification projects—technology hubs, tourism megaprojects and financial centres designed to prepare their economies for a post-oil future. Now, some of those resources may increasingly be redirected toward security.

The war has also exposed another vulnerability: the Gulf's dependence on foreign labour and international investors. Millions of expatriates work across the region, and many have already begun leaving as the conflict intensifies. If security concerns persist, the Gulf's economic model—built on global mobility and investor confidence—could face long-term strain.

For decades, the Gulf states built their prosperity on a powerful narrative: stability in an unstable region.

This war has shaken that narrative.

And when the conflict finally ends, the Gulf will face a daunting task—not only rebuilding infrastructure and restoring investor confidence, but also reclaiming the reputation for safety and stability that made it one of the world's most successful economic hubs in the first place.

Views expressed are personal

AT VANTAGE

The Age of AI Warfare

With the increased use of artificial intelligence in warfare, countries such as India must stocktake and prepare for defence safety and autonomy

SHUTAPA PAUL

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND MEDIA ENTREPRENEUR

Boots on the ground may soon be a thing of the past. The current war scenario proves it. Advanced defence systems comprising precision weapons such as swarm drones, cruise missiles, and stealth bombers are causing massive devastation and destruction. But the actual number of soldiers across enemy lines is negligible. An evolutionary shift from the days of thousands of armed personnel storming borders and stockpiling defence equipment. And now aiding the new-age war is artificial intelligence (AI). The ongoing Israel-US war on Iran exemplifies AI killing machines, highlighting the urgent need for caution and preparation.

As per revelations, Anthropic's Claude, after being used in Operation Absolute Resolve in Venezuela, has been actively used in the strikes on Iran. According to a New York-based security research non-profit firm, Soufan Center, Operation Epic Fury has used the large language model (LLM) for battlefield simulations even after its ban due to emerging ethical fault lines. Operated through a possible embedding within Department of Defense's Palantir platforms, Claude sharpened US attacks and helped with planning and support, purportedly orchestrating attacks on over 1,000 targets in 24 hours. Another contract has been signed between OpenAI and the Department of War (DoW) for future conflict situations. These are in clear contravention of pledges taken by Big Tech and also spotlight the existing lacuna around global regulation and policy regarding the weaponisation of AI.

War and strife have largely metamorphosed today. It's no longer about human bravery or courage but rather of advanced defence systems facing off against competing state-of-the-art war tools. It's essentially tech versus tech. Military AI has been in use for a while now; it's only becoming more sophisticated and lethal now. The fear of AI learning from these calamitous scenarios and developing into autonomous, murderous programs as it gains superintelligence is also not entirely far-fetched anymore. The way AI learns and adapts, paints a near-future diegesis that's more real than sci-fi. And while that's a guaranteed occurrence if there are no guardrails, the immediate warning is coming to nations like ours to review our defence systems, both for safety and autarchy. Since India is reliant mostly on foreign LLMs, our risks run high. India must on war-footing protect its data privacy and supply chains while ensuring strong cyber defence, autonomous systems, and strategic sovereignty.

Modern warfare is rapidly shifting from soldiers on the ground to algorithms in command centres

And what of humans? Like in all sectors, even human jobs within defence can be usurped by AI that's able to analyse and strategise within seconds what would take human counterparts hours or even days. Though defence experts argue (or hope against hope) that human judgement will continue to be relevant. The speed of AI, however, runs the very plausible risk of making several, if not all humans, redundant.

Companies such as Anthropic and OpenAI claim to have internal bibles to prevent crossing of lines. But who governs the use or misuse of powerful AI? How do we even define the ethics around it? Can companies refuse their governments? And what of subterfuge and skulduggery? Today, groups such as the United Nations (UN) and the North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (NATO) are a shadow of their former influential selves. The stage is set for a global agreement on disarmament stipulations for the use of AI in war. Would megalomaniacs and dictators adhere to these rules? The diplomatic challenge is real but then a modern world begets novel problems — and this will be the test for current dispensations around the world.

Views expressed are personal

WHO SAID WHAT

Raghav Chadha
@raghav_chadha

Periods are natural. Stigma is not. If a girl misses school because there are no sanitary pads, no water and no privacy, it is not her personal problem. It is our collective failure. We live in a country where alcohol and cigarettes are sold openly, but sanitary pads are still wrapped in newspaper as if they must be hidden. Somewhere along the way, society turned a biological fact into a social taboo. A matter of science has been turned into a matter of silence. Menstrual hygiene is not charity. It is not a favour. It is not a side issue. It is a matter of health, education and equality. Above all, it is a matter of dignity. Raised this issue in Parliament today because it affects over 35 crore women and girls in India. A nation cannot call itself truly progressive if millions of girls still face fear, shame and silence for something so basic. The real test of progress is simple. The day every girl in India can go to school, live with dignity and speak about this without stigma, that will be the day we can truly say our society has moved forward.

THE KC-135 IS A LONG-SERVING TANKER PLANE

US military refuelling plane crashed in Iraq; all 6 dead

DUBAI: The US military on Friday said all six airmen aboard a refuelling aircraft that went down in Iraq are dead.

The military says the circumstances of the incident are being investigated.

The US Central Command, which oversees the Middle East, said the crash followed an unspecified incident involving two aircraft in "friendly airspace," and that the other plane landed safely.

REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

The KC-135 Stratotanker is a US Air Force aircraft used to refuel other planes in midair, allowing them to travel longer distances and maintain operations longer without landing. The plane is also used to transport wounded personnel during medical evacuations or conduct surveillance missions, according to military experts.

Based on the same design as the Boeing 707 passenger plane, the tanker has been in service for more than 60 years, supporting the US Air Force, Navy and Marine Corps as well as allied aircraft, according to an Air Force description. The aging plane is set to be phased out as the air force receives a full complement of next-generation KC-46A Pegasus tankers.

Despite upgrades over the years, the KC-135s' age has fuelled concern about their reliability and durability.

"The last of these planes were produced in the 1960s," said Yang Uk, a security expert at South Korea's Asan Institute for Policy Studies. He added that the transition to the KC-46A has progressed more slowly than expected.

According to the Congressional Research Service, the Air Force last year had 376 KC-135s, including 151 on active duty, 163 in the Air National Guard and 62 in the Air Force Reserve.

Refuelling typically happens at the back of the plane, where the boom operator is located. A fuel boom is lowered to connect with fighters, bombers or other aircraft. On many of the planes, the boom operator works lying face down while looking out of a window on the underside of the plane. Some KC-135s can also refuel planes from pods on their wings. The tankers also have room above the fuel stores to carry cargo or passengers if needed.

Refuelling tankers could play an increasingly important role if the Iran war drags on, as US aircraft may need to fly longer missions to pursue Iranian forces retreating deeper into the country, said Yang. The accident caused the tanker to crash, killing four onboard.

The disaster led to an extensive decontamination effort to clean up nuclear material dispersed when conventional explosives in the hydrogen bombs detonated after hitting the ground. AGENCIES

Highlights

- Based on the same design as the Boeing 707 passenger plane, the tanker has been in service for more than 60 years
- Despite upgrades over the years, the KC-135s' age has fuelled concern about their reliability and durability

China to provide $2L for victims of bomb attack on Iranian school

BEIJING: China on Friday said it will provide $200,000 in emergency humanitarian assistance to the students killed in an airstrike on an elementary school in Iran in the ongoing joint US-Israel attacks on the country.

China expresses deep condolences regarding the deaths of students in the recent attack on an Iranian elementary school and extends sincere sympathies to their families, Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun said at a media briefing here.

Red Cross Society of China has decided to provide the Iranian Red Crescent Society with $200,000 in emergency humanitarian assistance, he said.

Guo said China condemns all indiscriminate attacks against civilians and non-military targets. Targeting schools and harming children constitute a severe violation of international humanitarian law and cross the bottom line of human morality and conscience, he added.

"China is willing to continue to offer necessary support to Iran in the spirit of humanitarianism to help the Iranian people overcome the difficulties," he said. According to a statement by the United Nations on March 1, missiles reportedly destroyed a girl's primary school in Minab, southern Iran, killing around 150 and wounding almost 100. AGENCIES

'US 30-day waiver on Russian oil sanctions not right decision'

PARIS: Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Friday that the US 30-day waiver on Russian oil sanctions amid the Iran war is "not the right decision" and won't help bring a stop to Russia's more than 4-year-old invasion of Ukraine.

"This easing alone by the United States could provide Russia with about USD 10 billion for the war," Zelenskyy said. "This certainly does not help peace."

"I believe that lifting sanctions will, in any case, lead to a strengthening of Russia's position. It spends the money from energy sales on weapons, and all of this is then used against us," Zelenskyy said at a news conference with French President Emmanuel Macron during a visit to Paris.

"Therefore, ultimately lifting sanctions only so that more drones will later be flying at you is, in my opinion, not the right decision," he said.

The US Treasury Department announced Thursday a 30-day waiver on Russian oil sanctions.

The step aims to free up Russian cargoes stranded at sea and ease supply shortages caused by the Iran war.

Analysts say that spiralling oil prices due to Persian Gulf production blockages are benefiting the Russian economy.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy

> "MOSCOW RELIES HEAVILY ON OIL REVENUE TO FINANCE ITS INVASION, AND SANCTIONS WERE A GROWING HANDICAP"

Moscow relies heavily on oil revenue to finance its invasion, and sanctions were a growing handicap.

US-mediated talks between Moscow and Kyiv that seek to stop Europe's biggest conflict since World War II are on hold due to the Iran war, though they could resume next week, according to Zelenskyy.

Macron noted that broad sanctions on Russia still stand despite the temporary US waiver.

US waivers announced in recent days are "limited" and "taken on an exceptional basis," Macron said. "It does not broadly or permanently roll back the sanctions that they themselves decided to apply," he added.

German Chancellor Friedrich Merz adopted a more critical stance.

He said Friday that a meeting earlier this week of heads of state and government from the Group of Seven industrialised democracies discussed with US President Donald Trump the issue of Russian oil and liquefied natural gas supplies.

"Six members of the G7 expressed a very clear view that this (waiving of Russia sanctions) is not the right signal to send," Merz said during a visit to Norway.

"We learned this morning that the US government has apparently decided otherwise. Once again, we believe this is the wrong decision."

Merz added: "There is currently a price problem, but not a supply problem. And in that regard, I would like to know what additional motives led the US government to make this decision." AGENCIES

Format C-2

(For political party to publish in website, newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal antecedents of candidates set up by the party

(As per the judgment dated 25th September, 2018 of Hon'ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation &Ors. Vs. Union of India &Anr.)

Name of political party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**

*** Name of Election: BIENNIAL ELECTION TO THE COUNCIL OF STATES TO FILL UP FIVE SEATS FROM WEST BENGAL 2026**

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

1	2	3	4		5		
SL. No.	Name of constituency	Name of candidate	(A) Pending criminal cases		**(B)** Details about cases of conviction for criminal offences		
			Name of Court, case No. & status of the case(s)	**Sections of the Acts concerned & brief description of offence(s)**	**Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)**	**Description of offence(s) & punishment imposed**	**Maximum Punishment Imposed**
1	**WEST BENGAL**	**BABUL SUPRIYA BARAL**	**1. FIR Case No. 129/14. MPS & MLAS Court, Barasat. No Charges Framed. 2. Case No. 84/16. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed 3. FIR Case No. 129. A.C.J.M Alipore Bankshall Court. No Charges Framed 4. Case No. 438/16. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed 5. FIR Case No. 62. MPS & MLAS Court, Barasat. No Charges Framed. 6. FIR Case No. 97/18. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 7. Case No. 95/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 8. FIR NGR No. 948/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 9. Case No. 171/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 10. Case No. 113 of 2019. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 11. FIR Case No. 40/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 12. FIR Case No. 32/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 13. FIR NGR No. 34/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 14. FIR Case No. 347. ACJM, Alipore. No Charges Framed. 15. FIR NGR No. 995/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 16. Case No. 150. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 17. FIR Case No. 78. ACJM Alipore. No Charges Framed. 18. FIR Case No. 31. ACJM Alipore. No Charges Framed**	**1. 186/143/283 of the Indian Penal Code and 8(B)(II) NH Act 1956. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly and obstruction of public servants in the discharge of their duties 2. 188 of the Indian Penal Code and 32 of the Police Act. Allegations relating to disobedience of an order duly promulgated by a public servant 3. 504 of the Indian Penal Code.Allegations relating to intentional insult with intent to provoke a person 4. 166/323/353/355 of the Indian Penal Code.Allegations relating to disobedience of law by a public servant. 5. 509 of the Indian Penal Code.Allegations relating to the use of words, gestures, or acts intended to insult the modesty of a woman 6. 143/147/149/153A/186/ 188/ 353 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly. 7. 500/504/506/509 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to defamation, intentional insult with intent. 8. 171C/268/427 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to undue influence in connection with an election 9. 143/342/186/353/506 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly. 10. 143/186/283/506 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly and obstruction of public servants in the discharge of their duties 11. 353/186/188/506/120B of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to obstruction and use of criminal force against public servants 12. 143/147/149/153A/186/188/353 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly and rioting by members of a group 13. Information Not Available 14. 341/323/34/354/506/509 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to wrongful restraint and voluntarily causing hurt 15. 171C/500 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to undue influence in connection with an election and defamation 16. 419/506 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to cheating by personation and criminal intimidation 17. 153A/505/120B of the Indian Penal Code and RW 66/43 Information Technology Act. Allegations relating to promoting enmity between different groups and making statements that may incite public mischief, 18. 506 of the Indian Penal Code. Alleged criminal intimidation**	**N/A**	**N/A**	**N/A**

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency.

WITH ATTACKS BY BOTH SIDES ON BAGHDAD'S SOIL

Iraq caught in crossfire of Iran war

IRBIL: Iraq is getting caught in the crossfire of the Iran war as the only country facing strikes from both sides, and that threatens to drag the nation that has so far avoided two years of regional turmoil into a full-blown crisis.

As the war nears two full weeks, Iraq's situation is growing more desperate.

Disruptions to Gulf shipping and strikes on oil fields and infrastructure have all but halted exports, jeopardising a state that relies on such trade for the bulk of its revenue.

If the shutdown continues, Baghdad could be unable to meet its oversized public-sector payroll as soon as next month, risking widespread unrest, two Iraqi Kurdish officials said. The federal government has appealed to northern Kurdish leaders to resume exports via a pipeline to Turkiye, but talks remain deadlocked over long-standing domestic issues. The officials spoke to The Associated Press on condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive political matters. In the meantime, a parallel conflict to the wider war has escalated between Iran-backed Iraqi militia groups and the US.

Iraqi Shiite clerics attend a funeral in Baghdad for members of the Popular Mobilization Forces who were killed in a US strike in Qaim AP/PTI

Near-daily drone strikes have targeted American interests across the country, while the US has struck back against militia bases to defend its troops.

Since the war began February 28 following a major US and Israeli strike in Iran, drone and missile attacks have targeted American interests in Iraq, including military bases in the Baghdad and Irbil airports, and US diplomatic facilities. Iran and its allied Iraqi militias also have struck oil fields and energy infrastructure to escalate the economic toll.

Unlike other Middle Eastern states touched by the war, Iraq hosts both entrenched Iran-aligned forces and significant US interests.

Its economy depends overwhelmingly on oil, so disruptions to production or exports through the Strait of Hormuz could sharply cut government revenue just as a fraught political transition grips Baghdad.

The longer the conflict lasts, the greater the risk that economic shocks, political paralysis and friction with Iran-backed militias will combine to unravel Iraq's hard-won relative stability.

Leaders in Baghdad and Irbil continue to urge caution and insist the war must not be fought on their soil, but the conflict's trajectory is increasingly slipping beyond their control.

The US has communicated assurances to Iraqi leaders that the country won't be dragged into the regional war, according to the two Kurdish officials who spoke to AP. AGENCIES

Highlights

- As the war nears two full weeks, Iraq's situation is growing more desperate
- The federal government has appealed to northern Kurdish leaders to resume exports via a pipeline to Turkiye
- Leaders in Baghdad and Irbil continue to urge caution

Iran about to surrender: Trump tells G7 leaders

US President Donald Trump

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump has told G7 leaders that Iran is "about to surrender," claiming success in Operation Epic Fury, a media report said on Friday.

Trump made the claim on Wednesday during a virtual meeting of the G7 leaders amid growing concerns about the economic fallout of the war with Iran, Axios reported.

"I got rid of a cancer that was threatening us all," Trump told the leaders, who urged the US President to end the war quickly. During the call, German Chancellor Friedrich Merz, British Prime Minister Keir Starmer and French President Emmanuel Macron urged Trump not to allow Russia to exploit the war or receive sanctions relief, the report said, citing two officials. The US on Thursday announced a temporary authorisation to other countries to purchase Russian oil currently stranded at sea. AGENCIES

Afghanistan accuses Pak of targeting homes in airstrikes

At least six civilians were killed and over a dozen injured, as fighting between the neighbours entered its third week

KABUL: Afghanistan's Taliban government accused Pakistan's military Friday of targeting homes in overnight airstrikes in Kabul and other areas of the country, saying at least six civilians were killed and more than a dozen injured, as fighting between the neighbours entered its third week.

Afghan government spokesman Zabihullah Mujahid said on X that Pakistani aircraft also struck fuel depots belonging to the private airline Kam Air near the airport in Kandahar in southern Afghanistan. "This company supplies fuel to civilian airlines as well as to United Nations aircraft," he said. Meanwhile, Pakistan's state-run television reported that the country's armed forces carried out "successful airstrikes inside Afghanistan" as part of the ongoing operation, targeting what it said were four alleged militant hideouts and their support infrastructure in Afghanistan.

The developments come amid a dramatic increase in tensions between the two countries which Pakistan has referred to as "open war." They are adding to concerns about the stability in the region as the US-Israeli war against Iran continues with no end in sight, generating great uncertainty. AGENCIES

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Ashok Kr Gupta S/o Ghuram Poddar R/o H.No. 545, Gali No.05, Ambedkar Nagar Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 831/21 U/s 256/379/411/34 IPC at PS: Jahangir Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ashok Kr Gupta** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ashok Kr Gupta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ashok Kr Gupta of FIR No. 831/21 U/s 256/379/411/34 IPC of PS: Jahangir Puri, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 28.04.2026.**

By order
Jyoti Nain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North-West, Room No.6, 1st Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/2614/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sheikh Manwar Hasan, S/o: Sheikh Ziarat Ali, R/o: C-427, C Block, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 1065/15, U/s: 457/380 IPC, P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sheikh Manwar Hasan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sheikh Manwar Hasan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sheikh Manwar Hasan** of **P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.04.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Jyoti Nain
JMFC-07, North Distt., Ist Floor, Room No. 06,
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/3153/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 84 BNSS
(84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Jitender@Pannu@Kannu S/o Lt. Ratiram, R/o H No. 145/80, Kishanganj, Ganda Nala, Subzi Mandi, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 648/2021, U/s 379/411 IPC, PS Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrants of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Jitender@Pannu@Kannu** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jitender@Pannu@Kannu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Jitender@Pannu@Kannu of FIR No. 648/2021, U/s 379/411 IPC, PS Sarai Rohilla, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 15.04.2026.**

By order
Sh. Rangat Ghirra,
Judicial Magistrate of First Class-04
Central Court, Room No. 37,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/3215/N/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

Name of work	Cleaning of fresh air & Return air filters, AC grills and cooling/ condenser coils of AC coaches during maintenance works at Washing Line/ Sick Line and On-Board Electrical Escorting Duties in Primary-Based Shatabdi/ Tejas/ Shatabdi-Type/ Rajdhani/ Duronto/ Gatiman/ AC/ Express Trains under HNZM Depot over Delhi Division for three years.		
Tender No.	30-Elect-10T-Chg-2025-26		
Approx cost of the work	₹12,18,74,697.01		
Cost of tender form	0.00		
Address of the Office	Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/ Chg/ Northern Railway, New Delhi.		
Earnest Money	₹7,59,400/-		
Period of completion of work	36 Months	Last date & time of submission of tender	07.04.2026 up to 15.00 hrs.
And opening of tender	07.04.2026 at 15.01 hrs.	Website & notice board	www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. DEE/Chg/DLI

SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE 865/2026

millenniumpost CLASSIFIEDS

CHANGE OF NAME

It is for general information thatI, Bina Devi W/o Late Satish Kumar R/o H.No-B-62, Street No-5, Brahampuri, Delhi, North East, Delhi-110053 declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as Bina Devi Srivastava in my husband PPO No 25125. the actual name of mine is Bina Devi which may be amended accordingly.

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank — Branch office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Srishti Shrivastava (Deceased) Through Her Legal Heirs/ TBAMT00006623136/ LBAMT00006638779	Property Plot Private No. 148, Measuring 216.66 Sq. Yards, Comprised In Khasra No. 4091, 4092, 4093, 4094, 4095, 4096, 4097 & 4098 All Min. (As Per Sale Deed), And Khasra No. 4093 Min. As Per Jamabandi Year 2015-16, Khewat No.1041, Khatoni No. 2810, Situated At Sultanwind Sub-Urban Taraf Mahal-2, Abadi Kot Mit Singh (Silver Estate), Near Flat Tarn Taran Road, Tehsil And District Amritsar, Punjab-143001./ March 11, 2026	November 29, 2025 Rs. 22,73,381.61/-	Gautam Buddha Nagar Mumbai Amritsar

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: March 14, 2026
Place: Gautam Buddha Nagar

Sincerely Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-AUCTION PROGRAMME, NOTICE NO.01 MONTH OF APRIL-2026
No. S/Sale/611/E-AP/170758/2026-27 **Date: 12.03.2026**

E-AUCTION NOTICE

It is intimated that scrap materials available in all Divisions and Depots of North Central Railway will be sold through e-auction and all organizers will conduct the auction of their area. **Scrap Items:** P. Way Scrap, Scrap Rail, Cast Iron Scrap, Condemned rolling Stock, Non ferrous and Non metallic Scrap, Turning & Boring, Condemned Oil /Paints Drums, Condemned Machinery & plants, Condemned Vehicles, Condemned office equipments, Foundry Slag, Released overhead MS/GI tanks, Released ferrous scrap of train lighting fans, Released MS/GI pipe line, foundry skull, Workshop MS scrap and other MS scrap.

S.N.	e-auction Date & Day		Depot/Division	Organizer of Auction	Through Website
1.	07.04.2026	Tuesday	GSD/JHS	Dy.CMM/SYS./JHS	www.ireps.gov.in
2.	14.04.2026	Tuesday			
3.	21.04.2026	Tuesday			
4.	28.04.2026	Tuesday			
5.	08.04.2026	Wednesday	GSD/CNB	Dy.CMM/GSD/CNB	
6.	17.04.2026	Friday			
7.	23.04.2026	Thursday			
8.	01.04.2026	Wednesday	PRYJ DIV	Sr.DMM/NCR/PRYJ	
9.	16.04.2026	Thursday			
10.	22.04.2026	Wednesday			
11.	29.04.2026	Wednesday			
12.	08.04.2026	Wednesday	JHS DIV	Sr.DMM/NCR/JHS	
13.	15.04.2026	Wednesday			
14.	22.04.2026	Wednesday			
15.	29.04.2026	Wednesday	AGC DIV	Sr.DMM/NCR/AGC	
16.	09.04.2026	Thursday			
17.	16.04.2026	Thursday			
18.	23.04.2026	Thursday			
19.	30.04.2026	Thursday			

Special Conditions: 1. All type of scraps will be through e-auction mode **www.ireps.gov.in** website. In the event of auction not being completed on the same calendar day, auction may be continued on the next calendar days also. **2.** The unsold lots of e-auction will also be included in next e-auction of respective depot. **3.** The Intending purchaser may inspect the lot of scrap material before the auctions during working hours. **4.** To purchase material above Rs. 5 Lacs, the purchaser must be registered with GST. **5.** For further details on auctions (like catalogues, last sold rates in auctions & other details), Please visit North Central Railway's website **"www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in". 6.** For further detail regarding e-auction Please visit **"www.ireps.gov.in"** website. **569/26 (D)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Corrigendum to Tender Notice

Sr.DEE/Chg/DLI office tender notice for the following work due for opening on 01.04.2026 at 15:01 hrs. Due to adding in NIT Special Technical Criteria "The Contractor shall be submit bid along with valid Electrical Contractor license issued by any state government in his on name, it should be as per IE Rule 1956 clause no. - 45, failing which the offer will summarily be rejected. The firm shall have to download the tender documents from the Railway website. All other terms & conditions will remain the same.

S. No.	Tender No.	Description of work	Contact Value (Rs.)	Earnest Money (Rs.)	Period of completion
1.	30-Elect-7T-Chg-2025-26	Schedule Maintenance and repair contract of RMPUs of EOG LHB RMPU AC coaches including their sick line attention for heavy repairs work and On-board electrical escorting duties on AC coaches in Primary based Trains of & electrical coaching ACC/Delhi Elect/Chg./Delhi Sarai Rohilla Depot over Delhi Division for three years	Rs. 10,50,96,881.39	Rs. Rs. 6,75,500/-	36 Months

No. 30-Elect-7T-Chg-2025-26 Dated: 12.03.2026 846/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

GOVERNMENT OF CHHATTISGARH, WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE EXECITOVE ENGINEER
WATER RESOURCES DIVISION NO. 2, RAMANUJGANJ
DISTT.- BALARAMPUR-RAMANUJGANJ (C.G.)

e-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
eProcurement Portal: https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in

Online Tenders are invited for the following works up to 30.03.2026, (17.30 hours IST).

system Tender No.	NIT No. & Date	Name of work	Probable amount of contract (in lakhs)	Tender call
186958	20/SAC/2025-26 Dtd. 11.03.2026	RENOVATION OF RAMNAGAR TANK SCHEME	246.83	Second Call

The details can be viewed and downloaded online directly from the Government of Chhattisgarh Integrated e-Procurement Portal (**https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in) from Date 18.03.2026, at 17.31 Hours.(IST) onwards.**

NOTE :-
1. All eligible/intrested contractors/bidders are mandated to get enrolled on the Integrated e-procurement portal (**https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in**) and get approval on specific vendor class from PWD under Centralized Contractor/Supplier Registration in order to download the tender documents and participate in the subsequent bidding process.
2. Probable Amount of Contract (P.A.C.) is as per S.O.R. 01.08.2010 (As Amendments 22.08.2022)

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
WATER RESOURCES DIVISION NO. 2 RAMANUJGAJ
BALARAMPUR-RAMANUJGANJ (C.G.)
For, Chief Engineer
Hasdeo Ganga Basin, W.R. Deptt.
Ambikapur, Sarguja (C.G.)

G 252607163/6

ROAD CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, ROAD DIVISION, ARWAL
Email ID:- eercdarwal@gmail.com Mob:-8544410020
SBD BASED DETAILED NOTICE INVITING RE-TENDER
(Through e-procurement mode only https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
NIT No.- RCD / Arwal/05/SBD/2025-26

1. **Designation And Address of The Advertiser** :- **Executive Engineer, R.C.D., Road Division, Arwal**
2. Date Of Issue of Notice Inviting Tender :- Letter No-120, Date-10.03.2026
3. Period For Download of Tender Document :- From 18.03.2026 to25.03.2026 Up to 15:00 hrs. **(From Website:** https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in **) Only.**
4. Date, Time & Place of Pre-Bid Meeting :- 20.03.2026 at 11:00 hrs. at Office of The Chief Engineer, South, RCD, Bihar, Visvesvaraya Bhavan Patna. Bihar
5. Last Date & Time for Uploading Tender Document By Bidder :- 28.03.2026 Up to 15:00 hrs. **On Website**: (https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) Only.
6. Date, Time & Place Of Opening Of Technical Bid :- Date- .30.03.2026 after 3:30 hrs. **On Website :** https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
7. Details Of Works:-

Group No.	Name of work	Cost of B.O.Q. (in Lakh)	Amount of Earnest money (Rs. in Lakh)	Cost of B.O.Q. (To be paid through online mode) (Non-refundable) (In Rs.)	Bid Processing Fee (To be paid through online mode) (Non-refundable) (In Rs.)	Time of completion of work (in months) Including monsoon period. (in months)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Construction work of 2x16m size high level RCC bridge in Imamganj-Karpi-Shahar-Telpa Mehndia Road Km 28.54 under Road Division Arwal, year 2025 - 26	716.42	14.33	10000.00	5900.00	12

8. Date, Time & Place of opening of Financial Bid :- To be announced after approval of Technical Bid by Competent Authority **(on Website :** https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in **)**
9. Bid Validity :- 120 Days

Detailed NIT can be seen on website https://www.prd.bihar.gov.in or https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in or the notice board of the office of the undersigned.

Executive Engineer,
RCD, Road Division, Arwal

PR- 026015 (RCD) 2025-26

विस्तृत सूचना **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

M.P. STATE AGRICULTURAL MARKETING BOARD

26-Arera Hills, Jail Road, Bhopal
Board/Nirman/P.Cell/Water Treatment/IInd Call/25-26/2416
Bhopal, Dated : 13.03.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Online Lump-Sum Rate E-Tenders are invited from the eligible bidders for Supplying, Installing, Commissioning, Testing, Repair and Maintenance of PLC based CBR-MMS integrated Centralized Automatic Bacteriological Treatment Plant with Online Comprehensive Analyzer at Mandi Yards (APMC - Berasia, District Bhopal, APMC - Sehore, District Sehore, APMC - Ganj Basoda, District Vidisha, APMC - Harda, District Harda, APMC - Pipariya, District Narmadapuram, APMC - Itarsi, District Narmadapuram, APMC - Badnawar, District Dhar, APMC - Khargone, District Khargone, APMC - Ashta, District Sehore, APMC - Burhanpur, District Burhanpur, APMC - Ujjain, District Ujjain, APMC - Dewas, District Dewas, APMC - Neemuch, District Neemuch, APMC - Jaora, District Ratlam, APMC - Agar, District Agar-Malwa, APMC - Guna, District Guna, APMC - Ashoknagar, District Ashoknagar, APMC - Jabalpur, District Jabalpur, APMC - Seoni, District Seoni, APMC - Satna, District Satna) for treatment of water as per BIS standards vide IS:10500-2012. (Tender Number : 2026_MPSAM_490000 (IInd Call), (PAC amount Rs. 380.00 Lakh). The following Tender to be received online up to 5:30 PM on Dated 06.04.2026. Technical bid documents with EMD & Financial Offer to be received online only as per Detailed NIT. The tender documents can be obtained online on the **http://mptenders.gov.in** as per the Notice Published on the above Portal and detailed information can also be seen on website **www.mpmandiboard.gov.in**

Note : Any corrigendum in this NIT, if required, shall be displayed only in our above portal regarding any matter included in this NIT or otherwise. Other details of project and locations & key dates can also be seen on our website **www.mpmandiboard.gov.in**

M.P. Madhyam/124907/2026 **EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (PROJECT CELL)**

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.

Muthoot Homefin — Corporate Office : Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra- 400 028

POSSESSION NOTICE (As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of **Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. (MHIL)** under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(2) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest(Enforcement) Rules 2002, Demand Notice(s)issued by the Authorised Officer of the company to the Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of **Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.** for an amount as mentioned herein under with interest thereon.

The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Loan Account No./Branch	Brief details of secured assets	Date of Demand Notice & Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Possession Taken Date
1.	Hemlata Sagar/ Subhash/ DEL-HL-000600 & DEL-NHL-000574/ Delhi	Freehold Residential Upper Ground Floor (Without Roof/ Terrace Rights) (Front Side), Area Admeasuring 125 Sq. Yds Out of Built-up Property Built on Plot Bearing No.30 Area Admeasuring 250 Sq. Yds Out of Khasra No.32/17 Situated in The Area of Village-Nilothi, in The Colony Known As Abchal Nagar, Part-1, Delhi- 110041, East: Part of Plot No.30, West: Plot No. 29, North: Road 20 Ft Wide, South: Road 20 Ft Wide	22-Dec-2025/ Rs. 45,33,768/- Rupees Fourty Five Lakh Thirty Three Thousand Seven Hundred Sixty Eight Only & 22-Dec-2025/ Rs. 5,64,141/- Rupees Five Lakh Sixty Four Thousand One Hundred Fourty One Only.	09-Mar-2026
2.	Sanjay Varma/ Rekha Verma/ Sunil Kumar/ 083-08300193/ Delhi	Residential Plot of Land Area Measuring 125 Sq. Yds. i.e. 104.51 Sq. Mtrs., Out of Khasra No. 348, Situated At Pooja Colony Village Pavisadakpur, Pargana Loni, Tehsil & District Ghaziabad, U.P. (Hereinafter Referred As Said Property) Boundaries As Under: East: Plot of Others West: Plot of Others, North: Rasta 15 Ft., South: Plot of Others	22-Dec-2025/ Rs. 15,37,369/- Rupees Fifteen Lakh Thirty Seven Thousand Three Hundred Sixty Nine Only.	09-Mar-2026

Date: March 14, 2026, Place: Delhi, Ghaziabad Sd/- Authorized Officer, Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited

MARKETS DECLINE FOR THIRD STRAIGHT DAY

Sensex and Nifty tumble 2% amid West Asia conflict, boiling crude

BSE midcap select index tanked 2.87%, smallcap select index fell 2.48%

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Equity benchmarks Sensex and Nifty wilted under selling pressure for the third straight day on Friday as rising crude prices raised concerns over inflationary pressures and global economic stability amid the widening conflict in West Asia.

Intense selling in global markets, unabated foreign fund outflows and continuing weakness in the rupee also dented investor sentiment.

The 30-share BSE Sensex tumbled 1,579.82 points, or 2 per cent, to 74,454.60 during intra-day trade.

The benchmark finally settled at 74,563.92, down 1,470.50 points, or 1.93 per cent.

A total of 3,348 stocks declined, while 941 advanced and 132 remained unchanged on the BSE.

The 50-share NSE Nifty tanked 488.05 points, or 2.06 per cent, to end at 23,151.10.

The market capitalisation (mcap) of BSE-listed firms slumped by Rs 10,24,181.74 crore to Rs 4,29,82,252.27 crore ($4.65 trillion) on Friday.

On the weekly front, the BSE benchmark tanked 4,354.98 points or 5.51 per cent, and the Nifty dropped 1,299.35 points or 5.31 per cent.

Since February 27, the 30-share BSE Sensex has nosedived 6,723.27 points, or 8.27 per cent. During this time, the market capitalisation of BSE-listed companies eroded by Rs 33,68,419 crore to Rs 4,29,82,252.27 crore ($4.65 trillion).

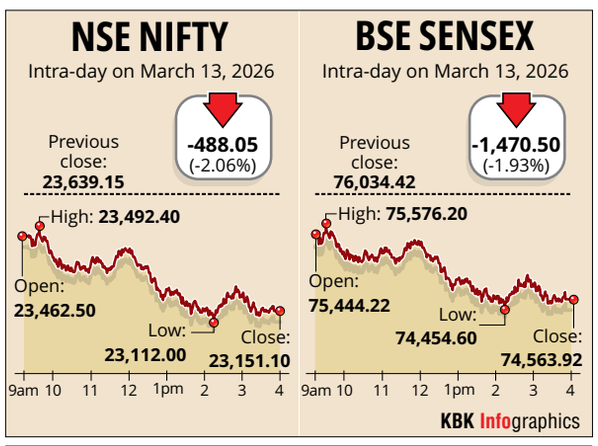
From the Sensex constituents, Larsen & Toubro plunged the most by 7.52 per cent, followed by Tata Steel, SBI, Bharat Electronics, Maruti, and UltraTech Cement.

In contrast, Hindustan Unilever and Bharti Airtel were the gainers.

The BSE midcap select index tanked 2.87 per cent, and the smallcap select index dropped 2.48 per cent.

Among the sectoral indices, Metal dropped the most by 4.83 per cent, followed by Industrials (4.15 per cent), Commodities (4.01 per cent), PSU Bank (3.73 per cent), Auto (3.27 per cent), MidSmall Private Banks Quality (3.13 per cent), Capital Goods (2.99 per cent), and Consumer Discretionary (2.69 per cent).

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, climbed 0.25 per cent to $100.7 per barrel.



Intense selling in global markets, unabated foreign fund outflows and continuing weakness in the rupee also dented investor sentiment

Highlights

- A total of 3,348 stocks declined, while 941 advanced and 132 remained unchanged on the BSE
- Market capitalisation of BSE-listed cos declined by Rs 10,24,181.74 cr to Rs 4,29,82,252.27 cr ($4.65 trillion) on Friday
- Since February 27, BSE Sensex has nosedived 6,723.27 pts, or 8.27%.
- During this time, mcap of BSE-listed cos eroded by Rs 33,68,419 crore to Rs 4,29,82,252.27 crore ($4.65 trillion)

Rupee falls 5 paise to 92.30 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee slumped 5 paise to close at a fresh record low of 92.30 against the US dollar on Friday amid the raging West Asia conflict.

A stronger greenback, heavy foreign fund outflows and sustained selling in the domestic equity markets further weighed on the rupee, forex traders said.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the local unit opened at 92.33 and kept losing ground to hit a fresh intra-day low of 92.47 against the US dollar.

It eventually settled at a new record low of 92.30, down 5 paise from its previous close. In the preceding session, the rupee lost 24 paise to settle at 92.25 against the US dollar, its lowest-ever closing level until Thursday. The dollar index was trading 0.43 per cent higher at 100.17. PTI

PV dispatches rise 10.6% in Feb to 4,17,705 units: SIAM

Domestic Passenger vehicle (PV) dispatches stood at 3,77,689 units in February 2025

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Domestic passenger vehicle dispatches from companies to dealers rose 10.6 per cent year-on-year to 4,17,705 units in February as positive market sentiments continued but the war in West Asia remains a concern as it could impact manufacturing and exports, industry body SIAM said on Friday.

Passenger vehicle (PV) dispatches stood at 3,77,689 units in February 2025.

Growth in PV sales last month was driven mainly by utility vehicles, which clocked a growth of 13.5 per cent at 2,36,957 units as compared to 2,08,795 units in February last year.

Passenger car dispatches declined 3.8 per cent at 1,06,799 units last month as compared to 1,10,966 units in the year-ago period, SIAM said.

Sales of vans in the domestic market were at 11,620 units last month as compared to 11,493 units in February 2025, up 1.1 per cent, it added.

Two-wheeler sales rose 35.2 per cent to 18,71,406 units last month as against 13,84,605 units in February last year, Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) said in a statement.

Motorcycle sales in February were up 30.8 per cent at 10,96,537 units as against 8,38,250 units in the year-ago month.

Similarly, scooter sales rose 42.3 per cent at 7,29,774 units last month as compared to 5,12,783 units in the same period last year, SIAM said.

Three-wheeler dispatches to dealers were up 29 per cent last month at 74,573 units as against 57,788 units in the year-ago period, it added.

Commenting on the performance, SIAM Director General Rajesh Menon said, "Positive sentiments in the industry continue as passenger vehicles, two-wheelers, and three-wheelers posted their highest ever Sales of February in 2026, with double-digit growth compared to February 2025."

On the road ahead, he said, "While March has festive drivers in several parts of the country, the recent conflict in West Asia remains a concern, both from the perspective of the supply chain, which could impact the manufacturing processes and exports."

Industry would keep a close watch on evolving geopolitical developments, he added.

Passenger car dispatches declined 3.8 per cent at 1,06,799 units last month as compared to 1,10,966 units in the year-ago period, SIAM said

Forex stocks drop $11.68 bn to $716.81 bn

MUMBAI: India's forex reserves dropped by $11.683 billion to $716.810 billion during the week ended March 6, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) said on Friday.

In the previous reporting week, the overall reserves had increased by $4.885 billion to an all-time high of $728.494 billion.

For the week ended March 6, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, decreased by $9.880 billion to $563.245 billion, according to data released by the central bank.

Expressed in dollar terms, the foreign currency assets include the effects of appreciation or depreciation of non-US units, such as the euro, pound, and yen, held in the foreign exchange reserves.

The value of the gold reserves declined by $1.612 billion to $130.017 billion during the week, the RBI said.

The Special Drawing Rights (SDRs) were down by $146 million to $18.720 billion.

India's reserve position with the International Monetary Fund (IMF) also fell $45 million to $4.828 billion in the reporting week, according to data. PTI

Sebi issues guidelines for mutual funds on intraday borrowing

NEW DELHI: Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) on Friday issued guidelines allowing mutual funds to undertake intraday borrowing from financial institutions such as banks to manage temporary cash-flow mismatches.

Under the framework, the board of an asset management company (AMC) and the board of trustees must approve a policy governing the use of intraday borrowing facilities. The approved policy must also be disclosed on the AMC's website.

The regulator said such borrowings can be used only for specific purposes, including repurchase or redemption of units and payment of interest or Income Distribution-cum-Capital Withdrawal (IDCW) to unitholders. The borrowing amount cannot exceed the "guaranteed receivables" expected on the same day.

Eligible receivables include maturity proceeds from TREPS (Triparty Repo in Government Securities), reverse repo transactions, and government securities such as G-Secs, Treasury Bills, State Development Loans (SDLs) and STRIPS, as well as interest payments and sale proceeds from these securities.

The guidelines will come into effect from April 1, 2026.

Sebi said mutual funds, particularly liquid and overnight schemes, often face a timing mismatch as redemption payouts are processed in the morning of T+1 day while maturity proceeds from TREPS and reverse repo transactions are received later the same day.

Earlier, Sebi had notified the Sebi (Mutual Funds) Regulations, 2026, which allow mutual funds to borrow up to 20 per cent of a scheme's net assets for certain purposes for a maximum of six months. However, this limit will not apply to intraday borrowings subject to Sebi's conditions.

The regulator also clarified that any borrowing costs due to delays in receiving expected funds must be borne by the AMC and not the scheme. AGENCIES

RBI compounds FEMA violations by Metrocorp Infrastructure Ltd; ED proceedings terminated

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: In a latest development, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has passed a compounding order against Metrocorp Infrastructure Limited for violations of foreign exchange regulations under the Foreign Exchange Management Act, 1999 (FEMA).

This has resulted in the termination of the adjudication proceedings initiated by the Directorate of Enforcement (ED).

The compounding order was passed by the RBI on February 10, 2026, on the basis of a "No Objection" from the Directorate of Enforcement (ED), which had initiated a probe against Metrocorp Infrastructure Limited based on credible information that the company had violated foreign exchange regulations.

According to sources, the ED had initiated a probe against Metrocorp Infrastructure Limited for violating FEMA regulations and had subsequently filed a complaint against the company for violating FEMA regulations under Section 16 of FEMA.

In the complaint, the ED had pointed out that the company had violated FEMA regulations on two counts by delaying the reporting of foreign inward remittances and by delaying the filing of Form FCGPR after the issuance of shares to foreign investors.

The late reporting of foreign inward remittances related to an amount of Rs 110.62 crore under Para 9(1)(A) of Schedule 1 of FEMA 20/2000-RB. In addition, the company had also not filed the FCGPR under Para 9(1)(B) of Schedule 1 of FEMA 20/2000-RB relating to the issue of shares in respect of foreign investment.

Following this complaint filed by the ED, a show cause notice was issued by the adjudicating authority on January 10, 2023, against the company and its directors/officers responsible for the conduct of the company's business during that period.

Thereafter, Metrocorp Infrastructure Limited filed an application for compounding of these contraventions under Section 15 of FEMA with the RBI.

On receipt of this reference from the RBI, a "No Objection" was issued by the ED for compounding these violations under the provisions of the Act.

Consequently, the RBI has compounded these contraventions by accepting a one-time payment of Rs 103,320 from the company under Section 15 of FEMA, resulting in the termination of adjudication proceedings against the company, thereby bringing this case to a close without any litigation under the provisions of FEMA.

The Compounding order was passed by RBI on Feb 10 on the basis of a 'No Objection' from ED

Maruti Suzuki Dzire sales cross 3 million units

NEW DELHI: Maruti Suzuki India Limited on Friday said cumulative sales of its compact sedan Maruti Suzuki Dzire have crossed 3 million units, marking a significant milestone for the model that also emerged as India's highest-selling car in calendar year 2025.

The company said the Dzire continues to witness strong customer demand owing to its sedan design, premium features, and safety credentials. It remains one of the most popular choices among young first-time buyers, with this segment accounting for nearly half of its customers.

Partho Banerjee, Senior Executive Officer (Marketing & Sales) at Maruti Suzuki India Limited, thanked customers for their support and said the fourth-generation Dzire has helped revive interest in the sedan segment with its refined styling and modern features. He added that comfort, convenience, and strong safety ratings have strengthened its appeal among evolving customers.

First launched in 2008, the Dzire has evolved across four generations. Over the years, it introduced several segment features including dual front airbags, climate control, anti-lock braking system (ABS) and automatic gear shift (AGS) transmission. Subsequent generations added LED projector headlamps, infotainment upgrades, and premium interior elements.

The latest-generation Dzire is powered by the new Z-Series engine and comes equipped with features such as an electric sunroof, a 9-inch SmartPlay Pro+ infotainment system with wireless Android Auto and Apple CarPlay, and a 360-degree camera. The sedan also offers multiple safety features including six airbags, electronic stability program, hill hold assist, ISOFIX child seat mounts and has received a five-star rating from Bharat New Car Assessment Programme and Global New Car Assessment Programme. MPOST

Maruti Suzuki Dzire also emerged as India's highest-selling car in 2025

NMDC becomes India's first miner to produce 50 MT iron ore in a fiscal

HYDERABAD: NMDC Limited has scripted history by becoming the first mining company in the country to produce 50 million tonnes (MT) of iron ore in a single financial year, a significant milestone that comes days ahead of the close of FY26.

Established in 1958 to develop India's iron ore resources, NMDC produced around 10 MT in 1978.

Over the decades, output has expanded fivefold to reach a historic 50 MT in FY26, reflecting the company's steady transformation into the backbone of India's iron ore supply chain.

NMDC's rise to the 50-million-tonne mark also underscores a sharp acceleration in growth in recent years. Production has increased by nearly two-thirds since 2015, rising from about 30 MT to 50 MT, with nearly one-fifth of the current capacity added in the last four years alone showing the fastest expansion phase in the company's history.

As India advances towards its target of expanding steel-making capacity to 300 million tonnes by 2030, ensuring a stable and reliable domestic supply of iron ore has become a strategic priority.

Commenting on the achievement, Amitava Mukherjee, Chairman and MD, NMDC Ltd, said: "Reaching 50 million tonnes is a notable achievement and reflects the strong progress we have made under NMDC 2.0. What once took decades to build, we have accelerated in just a few years through sharper execution, responsible mining practices, and a clear commitment to national priorities. Being India's largest iron ore producer comes with a huge responsibility, and this milestone reflects not just the strength of our operations but also the trust placed in us to support the nation's steel ecosystem."

With highly mechanised operations across the mineral-rich regions of Chhattisgarh & Karnataka, NMDC remains central to ensuring the country's iron ore security. MPOST

FIVB Beach Pro Tour Challenge 2026 at KIIT University concludes

KIIT University became the first university in India to host an FIVB Beach Pro Tour Challenge event.

BHUBNESWAR: The FIVB Volleyball World Beach Pro Tour Challenge 2026, hosted by KIIT University, concluded successfully at Dutee Chand Athletic Stadium after five days of high-intensity competition and international sporting spirit. The prestigious tournament brought together 83 teams from 52 countries, with more than 300 players and officials participating in the championship.

KIIT University created history by became the first university in India to host an event of the FIVB Beach Pro Tour Challenge series, marking a proud moment for the institution, the state of Odisha and the country.

The tournament was formally inaugurated on March 4 by Odisha's Minister for Law, Works and Excise, Prithiviraj Harichandan, in the presence of Dr. Achyuta Samanta, Founder of KIIT and KISS, Blair Harrison, FIVB Technical Delegate, and Prof. (Dr.) Saranjit Singh, Vice Chancellor of KIIT University, along with several international delegates and sports officials. Throughout the tournament, spectators witnessed thrilling matches featuring some of the world's leading beach volleyball players.

"All 300 players and officials were accommodated at KIIT Campus. We made very good arrangement for their stay inside campus. All of them were happy with KIIT hospitality", said Dr. Samanta.

The championship also created a vibrant sporting atmosphere on the KIIT campus and attracted large numbers of sports enthusiasts.

Several international players and officials praised the world-class infrastructure, professional organisation and warm hospitality provided by KIIT University as the host institution. Many participants expressed appreciation for the excellent facilities and the welcoming environment created for athletes from across the globe.

WINNERS:

Women's Gold Medal – United States: Durish / Koenig

Men's Gold Medal – Belgium: Vercauteren / Van Langendonck MPOST

CLOSER LOOK

- Tournament featured 83 teams from 52 countries
- Over 300 players and officials participated in the championship
- Int'l players & officials praised the world-class infra, organisation and hospitality provided by KIIT University

Silver falls to ₹2.65L/kg, gold declines to ₹1.63 lakh/10 gms

NEW DELHI: Precious metal prices declined up to 4 per cent in the national capital on Friday, with silver tumbling to Rs 2.65 lakh per kilogram and gold sliding to Rs 1.63 lakh per 10 grams amid a strong US dollar and uncertainty over global monetary policy.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, the white metal slumped by Rs 11,000, or 3.97 per cent, to Rs 2,65,500 per kilogram from Thursday's closing level of Rs 2,76,500 per kg.

In the bullion market, gold of 99.9 per cent purity also declined by Rs 2,000, or 1.21 per cent, to Rs 1,63,200 per 10 grams.

The yellow metal finished at Rs 1,65,200 per 10 grams in the previous session.

In the global market, spot silver was trading nearly 1 per cent lower at $83.14 per ounce, while gold went up marginally to $5,088 per ounce. PTI

India & US engaged in talks on bilateral trade pact, says govt

At no point in time have the two sides ever stated that the trade talks have stopped or 'we are not doing an agreement', an official clarified

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India and the US remain engaged in discussions for a mutually beneficial bilateral trade agreement, the Commerce Ministry said on Friday.

Chief negotiators of the two countries were scheduled to meet last month in Washington to finalise the legal text for the first phase of the bilateral trade agreement, but it was agreed to be postponed following a decision of the US Supreme Court striking down sweeping tariffs of the American administration.

The ministry has denied reports about a hold off on bilateral engagement.

"We have noted a media report regarding ongoing trade talks with the US. It is denied that there is any hold off in bilateral engagement. It is reiterated that the two sides remain engaged for a mutually beneficial trade agreement," the commerce ministry said in a statement.

The remarks came after the United States Trade Representative (USTR) on March 11 launched a fresh round of Section 301 trade investigations targeting policies and industrial practices of 16 economies, including India and China. Following the US Supreme Court's ruling, President Donald Trump announced 10 per cent tariffs on all countries for 150 days from February 24. And now the US has announced these investigations.

An official clarified that at no point in time have the two sides ever stated that the trade talks have stopped or "we are not doing an agreement".

Some countries, such as Bangladesh, Malaysia, and Cambodia, have signed trade deals with America, but some others have only finalised and not inked the legal text. India and the US have finalised the contours of the first phase of the trade pact.

"Every country is watching how the overall scenario of tariffs is in the US. The chief negotiators of India and the US have spoken at least 4-5 times since this (West Asia) crisis, and virtual sessions are also happening.

"There is no breakdown of talks. We are discussing. We are trying to see that we keep the agreement ready, but signing of the agreement will only happen at an opportune time, because this agreement, as you all are aware, is based on comparative advantage, preferential access to the US market," the official added.

The US tariffs are not going away; they will be calibrated and placed at a level where India is going to get a comparative advantage vis-a-vis its competitors in the US market, another official said.

Before the US Supreme Court ruling, the Trump administration had announced in a joint statement to reduce tariffs on India to 18 per cent from 50 per cent.

The tariffs at that time on India were among the lowest compared to its competitor nations, such as China, Thailand, Bangladesh, Indonesia, and Vietnam.

"So, since their side of the deal is not clear, there cannot be any signing ceremony right now. But the deal is there, and the design structure and the position of the deal are there," the official said.

The US had announced that it would reinstate the tariffs, which were set aside by the court. Initiation of Section 301 investigations by the US against 16 economies is a step in that direction.

"So, their intent is very clear. Now, what actions follow we have to see and based on that, we will have to take the next steps," the official added.

At present, there are no reciprocal tariffs. The 10 per cent levies are for all countries for 150 days.

"The basket of goods and services that India supplies to the US...we are in a good zone," the official added.

Some countries, such as Bangladesh, Malaysia, and Cambodia, have signed trade deals with America, but some others have only finalised & not inked legal text

Highlights

- India and the US have finalised the contours of the first phase of the trade pact
- The chief negotiators of India & US have spoken at least 4-5 times since this (West Asia) crisis, and virtual sessions are also happening
- We are trying to see that we keep the pact ready, but signing of the agreement will only happen at an opportune time

India evaluating US Section 301 probe against 16 trading partners

USTR on March 11 announced that it has initiated investigations against 16 trading partners, including India

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India is evaluating the US announcement to initiate investigations under Section 301 against 16 trading partners, and will respond accordingly, an official said on Friday.

The United States Trade Representative (USTR) on March 11 announced that it has initiated investigations against its 16 trading partners, including India, China, Japan, and the European Union (EU), to look into and address unfair foreign practices such as forced labour and overcapacity that are adversely affecting American manufacturing.

The probe covers sectors, including steel, aluminum, automobiles, batteries, electronics, chemicals, machinery, semiconductors, and solar modules.

The 16 trading partners China, Singapore, Switzerland, Norway, Indonesia, Malaysia, Cambodia, Thailand, South Korea, Vietnam, Taiwan, Bangladesh, Mexico, Japan, India, and the 27-nation EU bloc.

"We are studying what is there in their note. We are looking at it from all perspectives. Both from the legal perspective as well as the economic angle which is being mentioned there. India is evaluating the documents," the official said.

The move comes at a time when the US Supreme Court has ruled against the Trump tariffs.

After that, US President Donald Trump had stated that the US has other alternatives to impose such levies.

Through this, the US is looking at rebuilding tariff pressure on its trading partners.

Following the court's order, the US has imposed 10 per cent tariff on all countries for 150 days from February 24.

The probe will examine whether policies such as industrial subsidies, state-supported manufacturing expansion, activities of state-owned enterprises, market-access barriers, currency practices or suppressed domestic demand have contributed to global manufacturing overcapacity that burdens US commerce.

If such practices are confirmed, Washington may impose retaliatory trade measures, including additional tariffs, quantitative restrictions or other trade barriers.

As per the defined process, public dockets for written submissions will open on March 17, allowing companies, trade groups and governments to submit their comments on the probe.

The move comes at a time when the US Supreme Court has ruled against the tariffs. After that, Trump had stated that the US has other alternatives

Key Points

- 'We are studying what is there in their note. We are looking at it from all perspectives. Both from the legal perspective as well as the economic angle,' an official said
- Through this, the US is looking at rebuilding tariff pressure on its trading partners
- Following the court's order, the US has imposed 10 per cent tariff on all countries for 150 days from February 24

RBI injects ₹50K cr into banking system via OMO

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Friday injected Rs 50,000 crore into the banking system through Open Market Operation (OMO) purchases of government securities.

The central government purchased 7.41 per cent GS 2036 bonds worth Rs 14,491 crore, 6.45 per cent GS 2029 bonds worth Rs 13,006 crore, 6.64 per cent GS 2035 bonds of Rs 8,350 crore, 7.06 per cent GS 2046 bonds of Rs 5,000 crore, 6.79 per cent GS 2034 bonds of Rs 4,496 crore, 7.95 per cent GS 2032 bonds of Rs 2,908 crore, and 7.62 per cent GS 2039 bonds of Rs 1,749 crore, the release said.

The liquidity currently in the banking system is estimated to be in surplus of about Rs 2.49 lakh crore.

This auction was part of the two auctions of Rs 50,000 crore each announced by the RBI last week.

The OMO purchase auction was announced ahead of expected heavy outflows from the banking system due to advance tax and Goods and Services Tax (GST) payments scheduled later this month.

As per RBI data, the central bank has infused Rs 3.50 lakh crore through OMO purchases of government securities so far since the start of this calendar year, including today's auction. PTI

India's urea imports from China hit 3-year high, Russian supplies also rise

NEW DELHI: India imported 21.24 lakh tonne of urea from China between April 2025 and February 2026, the highest in three years, even as total fertiliser imports from China and Russia rose sharply this fiscal year, as per the government data placed before Parliament on Friday.

In a written reply to the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Fertilisers Anupriya Patel said that India had sourced fertilisers from both countries, with Chinese urea imports dramatically outpacing the 0.99 lakh tonne recorded in the full fiscal year 2024-25 and also exceeding 18.65 lakh tonne in 2023-24 and 12.80 lakh tonne in 2022-23.

Beyond urea, India imported 5.11 lakh tonne of Di Ammonium Phosphate (DAP), 0.28 lakh tonne of Muriate of Potash (MoP) and 9.61 lakh tonne of NPK fertiliser from China between April 2025 and February 2026, bringing total phosphatic and potassic imports to 15 lakh tonne.

Urea imports from Moscow stood at 13.99 lakh tonne till February, already higher than the 9.23 lakh tonne imported in 2024-25. India also sourced 7.55 lakh tonne of DAP, 12.97 lakh tonne of MoP and 21 lakh tonne of NPK fertilisers from Russia this fiscal year.

Total urea imports from China and Russia alone are about 35.23 lakh tonne till February of the current fiscal.

Overall, urea imports from other countries were at 56.47 lakh tonne achieved in 2024-25.

On domestic availability, the minister said approximately 432.44 lakh tonne of urea is currently available in the country against a requirement of 370.84 lakh tonne. Sales of urea through direct benefit transfer have reached 381.59 lakh tonne so far this year.

Phosphatic and potassic fertilisers are covered under the Open General Licence, allowing companies to import or manufacture them based on their own commercial assessments. PTI

Beyond urea, India imported 5.11 lakh tonne of DAP, 0.28 lakh tonne of MoP & 9.61 lakh tonne of NPK fertiliser from China during April 2025 & February 2026

National Stock Exchange hosts 'Ring the Bell for Gender Equality 2026'

MUMBAI: The National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) on Friday hosted the 'Ring the Bell for Gender Equality 2026' ceremony at its Mumbai headquarters, bringing together leaders from financial markets, policymakers, global institutions and industry to highlight the role of capital markets in promoting gender equality and inclusive growth.

The event was part of the global 'Ring the Bell for Gender Equality' initiative led by UN Women, International Finance Corporation (IFC), the Sustainable Stock Exchanges Initiative, the World Federation of Exchanges and the UN Global Compact. The initiative encourages companies to adopt the Women's Empowerment Principles (WEPs) and strengthen gender equality across workplaces.

In his opening remarks, Ashishkumar Chauhan, MD and CEO of NSE, stressed the need for stronger representation of women in corporate leadership and financial markets. He noted that women now account for nearly 25 per cent of NSE's registered investor base, with about 2.5 crore women joining capital markets over the past decade. He added that women investors are increasingly demonstrating disciplined and long-term wealth creation approaches.

Suhela Khan, Country Programme Manager for Women's Economic Empowerment and Officer-in-Charge at UN Women India Country Office, said the bell-ringing ceremony and adoption of WEPs reflect growing commitment from businesses and financial institutions to advance gender equality through inclusive leadership and governance practices.

Representatives from IFC and the Indian Institute of Corporate Affairs also addressed the gathering, sharing insights on promoting gender diversity in corporate leadership and expanding opportunities for women in the financial ecosystem. The programme concluded with the symbolic ringing of the closing bell and a renewed commitment by participating organisations to promote gender-inclusive workplaces and equal opportunities across corporate India. MPOST

MTNL misses escrow deposit for sovereign guarantee bond interest

NEW DELHI: State-owned MTNL has failed to deposit interest on sovereign guarantee bonds in the escrow account due on March 24 this year, the company said in a regulatory filing on Friday.

As per the structured payment mechanism of Tri-Partite Agreement (TPA) signed among MTNL, the Department of Telecommunications (DoT), Beacon Trusteeship Limited, the telecom company has to fund the semi-annual interest into the escrow account maintained in Bank of India with an adequate amount 10 days before the due date, which in this case is March 24, 2026.

"In view of the above provisions of TPA, it is informed that due to insufficient funds, MTNL could not fund the escrow account maintained in Bank of India with an adequate amount," the public sector telecom firm said.

MTNL said that all bonds issued by MTNL are Sovereign Guaranteed Bonds by the centre.

"In case of any default made by MTNL in payment of Principal and Interest on the Bonds issued by it, then the Sovereign Guarantee will be invoked by the Debenture Trustee and the Government of India is obliged to make the payment to MTNL for the same," the filing said. PTI

Global investors unwilling to let go of Adani Group's dollar bonds despite global uncertainty

NEW DELHI: Even as tensions stemming from the West Asia crisis unsettle global markets, investors have shown little willingness to part with Adani Group's dollar bonds, despite a buyback by its ports arm, Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Ltd (APSEZ).

On March 12, APSEZ, India's largest private port operator, completed a cash tender offer to repurchase parts of two series of US dollar-denominated senior notes, trimming its outstanding debt by about $199.5 million, people with direct knowledge of the matter said.

The offer covered up to $345.1 million of 4 per cent notes due in 2027 and $150 million of 3.10 per cent notes due in 2031, suggesting a potential buyback of roughly $495 million. Yet bondholders offered back far less than that. APSEZ eventually accepted $102.1 million of the 2027 notes and $97.5 million of the 2031 notes, they said.

In effect, more than 60 per cent of investors chose to keep their bonds, declining the opportunity to exit through the tender offer. After the early tender deadline, holders submitted an additional $0.5 million of the 2027 notes and $2.13 million of the 2031 notes, bringing the total repurchased to $199.5 million, they said. The exercise forms part of APSEZ's broader effort to utilise its excess cash on the balance sheet and gradually reduce leverage. In recent years, the company has used refinancing & selective buybacks to reshape its debt profile while maintaining access to international capital markets.

"We were expecting more investors to tender their shares, but the response has been quite positive," said one of the persons involved in the transaction.

Investors' limited participation in the tender suggests a steady appetite for the group's debt, particularly among global funds looking for exposure to India's infrastructure expansion.

According to people familiar with the matter, some US-based institutional investors have also continued to add to their holdings in Adani-linked bonds in the secondary market. Settlement for the notes accepted after the early tender date is expected around March 16.

For APSEZ, the buyback provides a modest reduction in debt and underscores its liquidity position. For bondholders, the choice to stay invested points to a continuing willingness to back one of India's largest privately-owned infrastructure groups. PTI

Power demand from data centres to reach 13.56 GW by 2031–32, says Prasada

NEW DELHI: Electricity demand from data centres in the country is expected to reach 13.56 gigawatt by 2031-32, Parliament was informed on Friday.

Minister of State for Electronics and IT, Jitin Prasada said the total data centre capacity in the country increased from 375 megawatt (MW) in 2020 to around 1,500 MW by 2025.

"The expected electricity demand from the growth of AI and other large-scale data centres is factored into the planning process of the government. As per information available with Ministry of Power, electricity demand from data centres is estimated to reach 13.56 GW by 2031–32," Prasada said.

The minister said about 38,231 Graphics Processing Units (GPUs) have been onboarded through 14 empanelled service providers and data centres under the AI compute capacity framework to support AI development.

"These are being provided to startups, researchers, academia and other eligible users at a subsidised average rate of Rs 65 per hour. This is about one-third of the global average cost. These data centres are located across the country such as Mumbai, Navi Mumbai, Hyderabad, Bengaluru, Noida and Jamnagar," Prasada said. PTI

Fitch ups India's GDP growth estimate for FY26, projects $70/barrel oil in 2026

Fitch expects growth to slow in first half of FY27, with rising inflation constraining real incomes and limiting consumer spending growth

NEW DELHI: Fitch Ratings on Friday raised India's GDP growth forecast for current fiscal and the next to 7.5 per cent and 6.7 per cent, and projected global crude oil price to average $70/barrel in 2026.

Fitch had, in December, projected India's GDP growth for current fiscal at 7.4 per cent and 6.4 per cent for 2026-27.

Fitch expects growth to slow in first half of FY27, with rising inflation constraining real incomes and limiting consumer spending growth.

GDP growth slowed in the December quarter to 7.8 per cent YoY from 8.4 per cent in September quarter.

"We estimate that for 2025-26 financial year (starting April 2025), growth will be 7.5 per cent, a marginal upward revision from December. Domestic demand is the biggest growth driver this year, with consumer spending and investment rising by (an estimated) 8.6 per cent and 6.9 per cent in the current fiscal year," Fitch said.

In its Global Economic Outlook- March 2026, Fitch projected world GDP growth at 2.6 per cent in 2026 on the assumption that the Iran war does not result in a larger or an enduring spike in energy prices that pushes the annual 2026 oil price forecast above $70/barrel. Global growth last year was 2.7 per cent.

"But a scenario where oil prices rise to $100 and stay there would be a significant adverse global supply shock," Fitch Ratings Chief Economist Brian Coulton said.

Fitch said oil prices have risen by $20/barrel to around $90 (Brent) since the US and Israel attacked Iran at the end of February.

Fitch's baseline assumption in the Global Economic Outlook report is that oil prices remain in the $90-100 range through March - as the Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed for around a month - before falling to the mid $60s by second half of 2026 in a fundamentally oversupplied market.

"This implies an annual average price of $70 in 2026, up from $63 in the December GEO. We believe this revision would not have a material impact on global growth, inflation or monetary policy," Fitch said.

However, there are huge uncertainties and there is a possibility of more sustained disruptions to oil shipments and significant damage to production facilities in West Asia.

With regard to India, Fitch said there are tentative signs that real activity is slowing in January and February, but the economy remains resilient, and credit growth is still in double digits.

A comprehensive revision of national accounts data including a rebasing of the base year to 2022-23, from 2011-12 earlier, has resulted in a smoother path for real GDP, with growth in 2023-24 and 2024-25 now estimated at 7.2 per cent and 7.1 per cent, respectively, rather than 9.2 per cent and 6.5 per cent in the previous national accounts.

Fitch said it expects investment growth to ease in the short-term but recover in sequential terms from second half of next fiscal with looser financial conditions and lower real interest rates. The government's budget forecasts public capital expenditure to rise in line with nominal GDP growth.

Weaker domestic demand will affect imports, translating into a positive net trade contribution to growth. At the margin, a lower US ETR (effective tax rate) following the US Supreme Court decision and the Section 122 blanket tariffs will support external demand.

"We expect overall GDP growth to slow to 6.7 per cent in FY26-27 and to 6.5 per cent in FY27/28 (these forecasts are revised upwards by 0.3 percentage points from the December GEO)," Fitch said.

"We expect inflation to rise steadily to 4.5 per cent by December 2026. Persistently higher oil prices could cause inflation to rise faster than the expected gradual pace," it said. PTI

CLOSER LOOK

- 'We estimate that for FY26, growth will be 7.5 per cent, a marginal upward revision from December', Fitch said
- In its Global Economic Outlook- March 2026, Fitch projected world GDP growth at 2.6 per cent in 2026
- Fitch's baseline assumption is that oil prices remain in $90-100 range through March, before falling to mid $60s by the second half of 2026

GOVERNMENT OF WEST BENGAL

NOTICE INVITING ONLINE PERCENTAGE RATE TENDER

Notice Inviting e-Tender No. 17/NKDA/SE-SWM/2025-26

Name of Work: **Arrangement of Equipment to Combat the Disaster Management (2026-28) and also as when Required within AA-I, II & III under NKDA, New Town, Kolkata for 02 Years.**

Online Percentage Rate Tender are invited by the Superintending Engineer, New Town Kolkata Development Authority Vide Memo No. **2455/NKDA/Engg.-SWM/DM 03(Equip. Disaster Management-2025-26)/2025** dated **13/03/2026** for the work. Having tender amount **Rs. 1,21,11,590.00** only. Bid submission closing date 08.04.2026 up to 2.00 P.M. For other details please visit our website at www.nkdamar.org & https://wbtenders.gov.in and the office notice board Newtown, Kolkata -700156.

Sd/- Superintending Engineer
New Town Kolkata Development Authority

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER INFORMATION

Name of work	Cleaning of fresh air & Return air filters, AC grills and cooling/ condenser coils of AC coaches during maintenance works at Washing Line/Sick Line and On-Board Electrical Escorting Duties in Primary-Based Shatabdi/Tejas/ Shatabdi-Type/Rajdhani/ Duronto/Gatiman/AC/Express Trains under Anand Vihar Depot over Delhi Division for three years.
Tender No.	30-Elect-11T-Chg-2025-26
Approx. cost of the work in (Rs.)	Rs. 12,68,02,167.22/-
Cost of tender form	Rs. 0.00
Address of the Office	Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/Chg/Northern Railway, New Delhi.
Earnest Money	Rs. 7,84,000/-
Period of completion of work	36 Months
Last date & time of submission of tender	08.04.2026 up to 15.00 hrs.
And opening of tender	08.04.2026 at 15.01 hrs.
Website & notice board	**www.ireps.gov.in & Sr.DEE/Chg/DLI**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 864/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Sultan @ Deny, S/o:** Md. Sahid, **R/o:** N-86/207, Jhuggi Lawrence Road, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR No. 288/2025, U/s: 25/54/59 Arms Act,** registered at **P.S.: Keshav Puram, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Sultan @ Deny,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Sultan @ Deny,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Sultan @ Deny, FIR No. 288/2025, U/s: 25/54/59 Arms Act,** registered at **P.S.: Keshav Puram, Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.08.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
(North-West), Room No. 112, First Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/3198/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

Tender No.	**30-Elect-9T-Chg-2025-26**		
Name of work	Cleaning of fresh air & Return air filters, AC grills and cooling/ condenser coils of AC coaches during maintenance work at Washing Line/Sick Line and On-Board Electrical Escorting Duties in Primary-Based Rajdhani/Duronto/Gatiman/AC Express/Tejas Trains of EOG/Rajdhani Section & ACC/NDLS Depot over Delhi Division for three years.		
Approx. Cost of the work (in ₹)	₹16,91,99,916.75		
Earnest Money	₹9,96,000/-	**Cost of Tender Form**	₹0.00
Address of the Office	Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/Chg/Northern Railway, New Delhi		
Period of Completion of work	36 Months		
Last date & time of submission of tender	06.04.2026 upto 15:00 hrs.		
Opening of Tender	06.04.2026 upto 15:01 hrs.		
Website & Notice Board	**www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. DEE/Chg/DLI**		

844/2026

SERVICE CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/624 Date: 12.03.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N.C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

T.No. 230-TRD-WC-1013-2026

Description of work : 25kV OHE modification due to yard remodelling work at Chunar Station (Phase-1) of Prayagraj Division.

Advertised Value : ₹ 4,79,36,636.68	**Bid Security :** ₹ 3,89,700.00
Completion Period: 12 Months	**Bidding system:** Single Packet

Tender Closing Date & Time: 02.04.2026 & 14.00 Hrs.

Tender Opening Date & Time: 02.04.2026 & 15.00 Hrs.

Note: 1. The complete information along with tender document of above e-Tenders shall be available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. **2.** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. **3.** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached.

578/26 FA

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

THE KANGRA CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD.

C-29, Community Centre Pankha Road, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058
Phone: 011-25611042, 25611043, 25611044
E-mail: legal@kangrabank.com, legal1@kangrabank.com,
Website: www.kangrabank.com

APPENDIX IV [See rule 8(1)]
POSSESSION NOTICE (For immovable property)

Whereas, The undersigned being the Authorised officer of "**The Kangra Co-operative Bank Ltd.",** Head office at, C-29,Community Centre, Pankha Road, Janak Puri, New Delhi - 110058, having its registered office at 1916, Chuna Mandi, Pahar Ganj, New Delhi-110055, under The Securitisation and Reconstruction of the Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, **(54 of 2002)** and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule [3] of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Bank had issued a demand notice on dated 19-11-2025, calling upon the borrower **Smt. Shalini Yaduvanshi W/o. Sh.Deepak H.No.R-62, Phase-2, Street No.6, Shiv Vihar Karwal Nagar, Delhi-110094 also at Smt. Shalini Yaduvanshi W/o. Sh.Deepak , C/o. M/s. Engineer Dheeraj Sharma Computer, Training Institute, Khasra No.175, Karawal Nagar, Delhi-110094, and Smt. Shalini Yaduvanshi W/o. Sh.Deepak ,C/o. M/s. Deep Computer Education Institute, B-96, S/F No. 710, Sadat Pur Extn., Main Road, Karawal Nagar, Delhi-110094 and calling upon the mortgagor & surety and Smt.Sarvesh W/o. Sh.Nanhe Singh H.No.R-62, Phase-2, Street No.6,Shiv Vihar Karwal Nagar, Delhi-110094,** to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being Rs.14,13,247/- (Rupees Fourteen Lakhs Thirteen Thousand Two Hundred and Forty Seven Only), together with further interest, penal interest and other charges as are applicable to this Loan account from time to time, from the date of the notice till the date of payment, with in 60 days from the date of receipt of the notice.

The above mentioned borrower, mortgagor & surety having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower, mortgagor & surety and the public in general that the Bank has taken **Symbolic Possession** of the property described here in below in exercise of powers conferred under sub-section (4) of section 13 of The Securitisation and Reconstruction of the Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, read with rule [8] of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, on this 11thday of March'2026.

The borrower, mortgagor & surety in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the mortgaged property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of **"The Kangra Co-operative Bank Ltd.", for an amount of Rs.14,13,247/-** together with further interest, penal interest and other charges as are applicable to this Loan account from time to time, from the date of notice till the date of realization together with all the costs incurred by the Bank in realizing the said amount.

The borrower, mortgagor & surety attention is also been invited towards provisions of Sub-Section (8) of Section 13 of The Securitisation and Reconstruction of the Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, in respect of time available, to redeem the below mentioned mortgaged property/Secured Asset.

DISCRIPTION OF THE PROPERTY

The property under consideration is Built up ground floor area measuring 41.80 Sq. Mtrs.	All that part and parcel of the HOUSE NO.R-62, (KHASRA NO.20/13), OLD NO. 250/2 & 38-C, PLOT NO.38-C, STREET NO.6, PHASE-II, GIS ID NO.GEO-COORDINATES FILE DDA/GIS/07122020054511/227001 & MEASURING 41.80 SQ.MTRS. HAVING FLOOR 01, SITUATED COLONY SHIV VIHAR PHASE-II, KARAWAL NAGAR, DELHI-110094. Falling Under the Registration of Sub-Registrar IV, Delhi.

Which is bounded under :- **NORTH : OTHERS PLOT, EAST : PLOT NO.38-B, SOUTH OTHER PLOT, WEST : PASSAGE 10 FT.**

PLACE : DELHI
DATED: 11-03-2026

(HARISH SHARMA)
AUTHORISED OFFICER
THE KANGRA CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD.
HEAD OFFICE AT, C-29, COMMUNITY CENTRE, PANKHA ROAD, JANAKPURI, NEW DELHI-58.
Phone.90135684018, 9013568419,9810487548.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused Persons Namely **Gufran S/o** Md. Zafar **R/o** L-314, Gali No. 24, Janta Colony, Welcome, Delhi, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 288/2013 U/s 392/411/34 IPC**., has been registered at **P.S. Nand Nagri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the Said, **Gufran** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Gufran** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Gufran** of **FIR No. 288/2013 U/s 392/411/34 IPC**., has been registered at **P.S. Nand Nagri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.04.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
JMFC-03, Room No. 19
1st Floor, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/2866/NE/2026
(Court Notice)

THE KANGRA CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD.

Head Office At, C-29, Community Centre, Pankha Road, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058,
Phone : 011-25611042, 25611043, 25611044
E-mail: legal@kangrabank.com, legal1@kangrabank.com, Website : www.kangrabank.com

APPENDIX IV
[See rule 8(1)]
POSSESSION NOTICE
(For immovable property)

Whereas,

The undersigned being the Authorised officer of **"The Kangra Co-operative Bank Ltd."**, Head office at, C-29,Community Centre, Pankha Road, Janak Puri, New Delhi - 110058, having its registered office at 1916, Chuna Mandi, Pahar Ganj, New Delhi-110055, under The Securitisation and Reconstruction of the Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, **(54 of 2002)** and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule [3] of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Bank had issued a demand notice on dated 19-11-2025, calling upon the borrower & Mortgagor **Sh. Anil Kumar S/o. Sh.Ved Pal Singh Tomar R/o. B-429, Gali No.21, Block-B, Bhajan Pura, Delhi-110053 also at Sh. Anil Kumar S/o. Sh.Ved Pal Singh Tomar C/o. M/s. Tapasya Spares P-31/20, Gali No.4, Anad Parbat Indl. Area, Delhi-110005,** to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being Rs.9,83,538/- (Rupees Nine Lakhs Eighty Three Thousand Five Hundred and Thirty Eight Only), together with further interest, penal interest and other charges as are applicable to this Loan account from time to time, from the date of the notice till the date of payment, with in 60 days from the date of receipt of the notice.

The above mentioned borrower & mortgagor having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower, mortgagor and the public in general that the Bank has taken Symbolic Possession of the property described here in below in exercise of powers conferred under sub-section (4) of section 13 of The Securitisation and Reconstruction of the Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, read with rule [8] of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, on this **11th. day of March' 2026.**

The borrower & mortgagor in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the mortgaged property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of **"The Kangra Co-operative Bank Ltd.", for an amount of Rs.9,83,538/-** together with further interest, penal interest and other charges as are applicable to this Loan account from time to time, from the date of notice till the date of realization together with all the costs incurred by the Bank in realizing the said amount.

The borrower & mortgagor attention is also been invited towards provisions of Sub-Section (8) of Section 13 of The Securitisation and Reconstruction of the Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, in respect of time available, to redeem the below mentioned mortgaged property/Secured Asset.

DISCRIPTION OF THE PROPERTY

The property under consideration is a Built up property upto last storey, area measuring 50Sq.Yds.	**All that part and parcel of the BUILT UP PROPERTY, AREA MEASURING 50 SQ.YDS. i.e 41.81 sq. mtrs., BEARING PROPERTY NO.B-429, OUT OF KHASRA NO.323, CONSISTING OF ACCORDING TO THE SITE, WITH THE RIGHTS TO USE AND CONSTRUCT UP TO THE LAST STOREY, SITUATED AT VILLAGE GHONDA GUJRAN KHADAR, IN THE ABADI OF B-BLOCK, GALI NO.21, BHAJANPURA, ILLAQA SHAHDARA, DELHI-110053. Falling Under the Registration of Sub-Registrar IV-Seelampur, Delhi.**

Bounded as EAST : Property of Others/Satish Kumar Verma, WEST : Gali 13 ft. wide, NORTH : Property of Others/Kusum Devi, SOUTH : Property of Other/ Sh.Suraj.

(HARISH SHARMA)
AUTHORISED OFFICER
THE KANGRA CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD.
HEAD OFFICE AT, C-29, COMMUNITY CENTRE, PANKHA ROAD, JANAKPURI, NEW DELHI-58.
Phone No.9013568418, 9013568419

PLACE : DELHI
DATED : 11.03.2026

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Sandeep Kumar
Addl. Civil Judge Sr. Divin. Narwana
Kamla Wd/o Ranbir S/o Dariya, Mother of Sunil (Disabled) son of Ranbir, R/o Village Lown, Tehsil Narwana, District jind.
Vs.
General Public
Case No. HMG Act/11/2025
CNR No.HRJNA1-001236-2025
Next Date of Hearing :23.03.2026 at 10:00 AM

NOTICE TO:
General Public

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **23.03.2026** at **10:00.a.m.**

For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?trs = district Notice&district=Jind**

Sd/- Sh. Sandeep Kumar
Addl. Civil Judge Sr. Divin.
Dated 12.03.2026 Narwana

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF Dr. Madhur Bajaj Civil Judge (Senior Division) Fatehabad
Lakhwinder Kaur
Vs.
General Public

Petition under section 8 of The Hindu Minority and Guardianship Act, 1956 as amended up to date for giving permission to petitioner for sale of land/lal dora plot measuring 497.210 sq. mtrs. number 604490910 bearing UID No./ Property Code No. 604490EPAS100PH0910B being share belonging to minor son Jagjot Singh @ Jagjeet Singh son of Tajinder Singh registered certification/deed of title/ownership situated in village Bighar, Tehsil and District Fatehabad. On the basis of oral as well as documentary evidence of all kind.

CNR No. HRFT02-000715-2025
Next Date:- 17-07-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO::
General Public
:-
Fatehabad

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **17-07-2026** at **10:00 am.**

For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?trs = district notice & district =Fatehabad**

Sd/- Dr. Madhur Bajaj Civil Judge (Senior Division)
Dated 10.03.2026 Fatehabad

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Ravi, S/o:** Amarjeet, **R/o:** House No. E-35, Camp No. 2, Nangloi, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR No. 13345/2022, U/s: 411/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Tilak Nagar, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Ravi,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Ravi,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Ravi, FIR No. 13345/2022, U/s: 411/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Tilak Nagar, Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.04.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Vikas Madan
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
Court No. 289, District West
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/3246/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Varun Jain S/o** Mahender Kumar Jain **R/o** E-12, Om Vihar Phase 05, Uttam Nagar, Dwarka New Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 1003/2020, 123/2020 & CT No. 1339/2020 U/s 135 Eletricity Act PS: Uttam Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Varun Jain** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Varun Jain** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Varun Jain** accused of **FIR No. 1003/2020, 123/2020 & CT No. 1339/2020 U/s 135 Eletricity Act PS: Uttam Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.04.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Harleen Singh
ASJ, Special Court Eletricity,
Room No. 609, 6th Floor
Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/3139/DW/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDERING NOTICE

Dy. CEE/PU/Agra for & on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on - line only (e-Tendering) for the following work:

Tender No.: AGCPU202603	**Approximate Cost:** Rs. 28640535/-

Name of work: Supply, erection, testing and commissioning of Automatic Fault Locator (AFL) for 2x25 KV AC traction system based on auto transformer neutral current ratio for SP, SSP and TSS on Mathura-Palwal Section in Agra Division of North Central Railway in connection with Raising of Speed to 160 kmph over existing New Delhi-Mumbai Route.

Earnest Money: Rs. 293200/-	**Period of completion:** Six months

1. For full details & submission of bid please see the Indian Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in**. **2.** Tender can only be submitted through web portal **"www.ireps.gov.in"** up to **16:00 Hrs.** on date **02.04.2026** **571/26 (ADM)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **S.B. Singh** Prop of Guru Ram Dass Tedarss Office, 201, IInd Floor Bhogal Complex, Nirman Vihar Metro Station V3S Mall Laxmi Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 1451/19 U/s 138 NI Act PS: Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **S.B. Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **S.B. Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **S.B. Singh** accused of **CC No. 1451/19 U/s 138 NI Act PS: Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.05.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Pankaj Rai
JMFC-01, Room No.73
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/3059/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PUBLIC NOTICE

GODREJ FINANCE LIMITED

Registered office at Godrej One, Pirojshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East) Mumbai- 400079 Maharashtra
Branch Office: Godrej Capital, 208 & 208 A, 2nd Floor, ABW Tower, Sector 25, Gurugram- 122002

DEMAND NOTICE

Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The undersigned is the Authorised Officer of Godrej Finance Limited under Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the said Act). In exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorised Officer has issued Demand Notices under section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower(s) (the "said Borrower(s)"), to repay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice(s) issued to them that are also given below. In connection with above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Borrower(s)to pay to Godrej Finance Limited, within 60 days from the publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated herein below, together with further interest as detailed in the said Demand Notice(s), from the date(s) mentioned below till the date of payment and/or realization, payable under the loan agreement read with other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Borrower(s). As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged to Godrej Finance Limited by the said Borrower(s) respectively.

Name of the Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s)/ Loan Account Number	Demand Notice Date, Amount and NPA Date	Description of secured asset (immovable property)
1. Sangeeta MetalIndustries, Flat No 3/12 DSIDC, Complex Nand Nagari, Near Police Station, 3/112 Complex Nand Nagari, New Delhi- 110093. **Also at:** 30/28 Gali No-9, Vishwas Nagar, New Delhi- 110032. **2. Mohit Metal Industries,** Shed No-3/12 DSIDC, Nand Nagri, Phase-2, Nand Nagri Shahdara, New Delhi- 110093. **Also at:** 30/28 Gali No-9, Vishwas Nagar, New Delhi- 110032 **3. Kamal Chauhan,** S/o Dev Raj Chauhan, 30/28 Gali No-9, Vishwas Nagar, New Delhi- 110032 **4. Mohit Chauhan,** S/o Dev Raj Chauhan, 30/28 Gali No-9, Vishwas Nagar, New Delhi- 110032 **5. Sangeeta Devi,** W/o Dev Raj Chauhan, 30/28 Gali No-9, Vishwas Nagar, New Delhi- 110032/ Loan Account No. **GFL3101LP0046425**	**09.03.2026 Rs. 16,046,767/- (INR One Crore Sixty Lakhs Fourty - SixThousand Seven Hundred Sixty Seven Only) 06th March 2026**	All That Piece & Parcel of Property No. 30/28-A, Part of Plot No. 28-A, Area Measuring 71.0685 Sq. Mtrsi. E, 85 Sq. Yds., Out of Khasra No. 819 Min, Situated At Village Chandrawali Alias Shahdara, in The Abadi of Block No. 30, Gali No. 09, Vishwas Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi- 110032. India, Boundaries Are Mentioned Below:- East: Na, West: Na, North: Na, South: Na

If the said Borrowers shall fail to make payment to Godrej Finance Limited as aforesaid, Godrej Finance Limited shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the Act and the applicable Rules, entirely at the risks of the said Borrowers as to the costs and consequences. The said Borrowers are prohibited under the Act from transferring the aforesaid assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of Godrej Finance Limited. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the said Act or Rules made there under, shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

Date: March 14, 2026
Place: Shahdara

(Authorised Officer)
Godrej Finance Limited

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank Branch office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Robin Dahiya / Karambir Singh / LBPNP00005475079/ LBPNP00005475077	Property Situated At Khewat No. 1707 Min, Khatoni No. 2283 Min, Khasra No 969/2(2-6), 968(1-7) Kite 2 Rakhba 3,4/73 Part 3 Bighe 13 Biswa Bakdar Rakba 4 Biswa, Waka Pati Insar, Inside Mc Limits, Panipat, Haryana- 132103/ 10 March, 2026	October 30, 2025 Rs. 40,03,033.64/-	Panipat/ Gurgaon (Haryana)

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: March 14, 2026
Place: Gurgaon (Haryana)

Sincerely Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Mithlesh Mishra S/o Sh Bharat Mishra R/o:** H.No. 967, Gali No. 19, Prem Nagar IInd, Kirari **Delhi. Also At:** Village Niwahi Dandi, Post. Jogiya Buzurg, PS. Ruderpur, Distt. Deoria, **Uttar Predesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 1448/2015, U/S: 279/338 IPC, PS: Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Mithlesh Mishra,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Mithlesh Mishra**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Mithlesh Mishra**, of **FIR No. 1448/2015, U/S: 279/338 IPC, PS: Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.04.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class
North West Court No. 109 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/2828/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ajay Kumar, S/o:** Babu Lal, **R/o:** Plot No. 136, J.P. Block, Nangli Shakrawat, Najafgarh, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 858/2022 U/s 379/511 IPC, P.S.: Paschim Vihar East, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ajay Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ajay Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ajay Kumar** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 858/2022 U/s 379/511 IPC, P.S.: Paschim Vihar East, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.04.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Moksha Bains
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11 (West)
Court No. 31, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/3173/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Gulshan Kumar, S/o. Sunil Chaudhary, R/o.: Jhuggi No. 382, Gali No.04, Raja Vihar Samaipur Badli, Outer North, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **e-FIR No.41320/2019 U/S 379/411 IPC** registered at **P.S Shahbad Dairy, Outer North District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Gulshan Kumar** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Gulshan Kumar** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Gulshan Kumar**, accused of **e-FIR No.41320/2019 U/S 379/411 IPC, P.S Shahbad Dairy, Outer North District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **23.04.2026.**

By Order, Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)
Court No.114, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/3207/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No: 11620252026 **Dated: 10.03.2026**

E-TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/ North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-TENDERS on prescribed form for the following work up to **13.30** hrs. on **08.04.2026.** The details of the Tender are as under:-

Tender No : 260	**Approx Cost of work (Rs.) :** 72900704.80
Name of Work : Cess Repair work in Etah-Barhan branch line under ADEN/TDL	
Bid Security : 514500.00	**Completion Period :** 12 Months
Date of Opening of tender : 08.04.2026	
Eligibility Criteria for Similar work : Earth Work in formation	

Note: 1: E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. **2:** The complete information along with tender document of above E-TENDER is available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in.** up to **13:30** hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e. **08.04.2026. 3:** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with **IREPS** website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by **CCA** under **IT Act-2000. 4:** The tenderers shall submit a copy of certificate as given in tender document in standard format, without which their tender may not be considered and shall be summarily rejected. **5:** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **6:** The tenderer has to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-I) of GCC April 2022 mandatorily, otherwise offer will be considered as Incomplete Offer and accordingly shall not be considered. **555/26 (AS)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice

Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

N.I.T. No.	**34 (A,B,C)/25-26/WE**		
Name of work with its location			
(A)	AMC for two years of commercial RO 3000 Ltr/hrs. at RPSF Block A Electric workshop printing press and 2 nos 500 Ltrs/Hr. capacity at RPF & RPSF and other different capacity RO in the section of SSE/W/Punjab Bagh under ADEN-II. & Maintenance of RO plant cap. 3000 LPH, softening plant, Chlorine dosing pump & filtration plant at P.K. Road in the section of SSE/W/PG under ADEN/E-1.		
(B)	Supply of Potable water through tankers under DEN/E-I		
(C)	Supply of Potable water through tankers under DEN/E-II		
(D)	Annual Supply of Horticulture Material in the S/o SSE/Hort./SPM & SSE/Hort./SOJ under ADEN/Hort./NDLS		
Approx. cost of work	**(A)** 10996399.26	**(B)** 17499946.54	**(C)** 17499946.54
EMD amount	**(A)** 205000.00	**(B)** 237500.00	**(C)** 237500.00
Completion period of work	**(A)** 24 Months	**(B)** 12 Months	**(C)** 12 Months
Date and Time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Closing date of tender on 07.04.2026 at 15:00 hrs.		
Website particular notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.	Above tender available on website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in**		

No: 128-W/269/O.E.T/NIT No. 34 (A,B,C)/25-26/WE Dated :- 12.03.2026 841/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.-Dy. CEE/PU/CNB/T-02A/25-26 **Date: 11.03.2026**

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (Project), N. C. Railway, Kanpur for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: Dy. CEE/PU/CNB/T-02A/25-26

Description of work: Supply, Erection, Testing and commissioning of CB for feeding Siding in connection with Modification to increase speed to 160/200 Kmph over PRYJ Division of NCR.

Approx Cost (Rs.): 134272254.48	**Earnest Money (Rs.):** 821400.00
Cost of Tender Form (Rs.): 00	**Validity of Tender:** 90 days

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 06 Months

Date of closing Tender: 02.04.2026, 15:00 Hrs.

Tender on line can be submitted up to **15:00 hrs** on **02.04.2026.** For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in** **554/26 (ADM)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

Format C-1
(for candidate to publish in Newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal cases
(As per the judgment dated 25th September, 2018, of Hon'ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation & Ors. Vs. Union of India &Anr.)

Name and address of candidate: : **SHRI BABUL SUPRIYA BARAL of IDEAL GRAND, 16 B & C, 16th Floor, Block B Resplanda, 456, G. T. Road South, Near Shibpur Police Line, Shibpur, Haora (M. Corp), P.O- Sibpur Bazar, Dist- Howrah, West Bengal-711102**

Name of political party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**
(Independent candidates should write "Independent" here)

Name of Election: **BIENNIAL ELECTION TO THE COUNCIL OF STATES TO FILL UP FIVE SEATS FROM WEST BENGAL 2026**

*Name of Constituency: **WEST BENGAL**

I **BABUL SUPRIYA BARAL**(name of candidate), a candidate for the abovementioned election, declare for public information the following details about my criminal antecedents:

(A) Pending criminal cases

Sl. No.	Name of Court	Case No. and dated	Status of case(s)	Section(s) of Acts concerned and brief description of offence(s)14
1	Court of the LD MPS & MLAS Court, Barasat, North 24 PGS. LD. Judge Special Court	FIR Case No. 129/14 Dt. 12/04/14	Charges Not Framed	186/143/283 of the Indian Penal Code and 8(B)(II) NH Act 1956. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly and obstruction of public servants in the discharge of their duties.
2	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	Case No. 84/16 Dt. 09/04/16	Charges Not Framed	188 of the Indian Penal Code and 32 of the Police Act. Allegations relating to disobedience of an order duly promulgated by a public servant.
3	Court of the LD. A.C.J.M Alipore Bankshall Court	FIR Case No.129 Dt. 29/04/16	Charges Not Framed	504 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to intentional insult with intent to provoke a person.
4	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	Case No. 438/16 Dt. 21/10/16	Charges Not Framed	166/323/353/355 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to disobedience of law by a public servant.
5	Court of the LD. MPS & MLAS Court, Barasat, North 24 PGS. LD. Judge Special Court	FIR Case No. 62 Dt 04/01/17	Charges Not Framed	509 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to the use of words, gestures, or acts intended to insult the modesty of a woman.
6	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	FIR Case No. 97/18 Dt 29/03/18GR No.901/2016	Charges Not Framed	143/147/149/ 153A/186/ 188/ 353 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly.
7	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	Case No. 95/19 Dt. 19.3.2019	Charges Not Framed	500/504/506/509 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to defamation, intentional insult with intent.
8	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	FIR NGR No. 948/19 Dt. 18/04/19	Charges Not Framed	171C/268/427 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to undue influence in connection with an election.
9	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	Case No. 171/19 Dt. 21/04/19	Charges Not Framed	143/342/186/353/506 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly.
10	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	Case No. 113 of 2019 Dt. 14/04/19	Charges Not Framed	143/186/283/506 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly and obstruction of public servants in the discharge of their duties
11	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	FIR Case No. 40/19 Dt. 29/04/19	Charges Not Framed	353/186/188/506/120B of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to obstruction and use of criminal force against public servants
12	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	FIR Case No. 32/19 Dt. 2019	Charges Not Framed	143/147/149/153A/ 186/188/353 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly and rioting by members of a group
13	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	FIR NGR No. 34/19 Dt. 2019	Charges Not Framed	Information Not Available
14	Court of the LD. ACJM, Alipore	FIR Case No. 347 Dt 22/09/19	Charges not framed	341/323/34/354/ 506/509 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to wrongful restraint and voluntarily causing hurt
15	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	FIR NGR No. 995/19 Dt. 2019	Charges Not Framed	171C/500 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to undue influence in connection with an election and defamation
16	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	Case No. 150 of Dt. 01.06.2019	Charges Not Framed	Offences under Sections 336/504 of IPC. 419/506 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to cheating by personation and criminal intimidation
17	Court of the LD. ACJM Alipore	FIR Case No. 78 Dt.09/05/20	Charges Not Framed	153A/505/120B of the Indian Penal Code and RW 66/43 Information Technology Act. Allegations relating to promoting enmity between differentgroups and making statements that may incite public mischief.
18	Court of the LD. ACJM Alipore	FIR Case No. 31 Dt. 31/03/21	Charges Not Framed	506 of the Indian Penal Code. Alleged criminal intimidation

(B) Details about cases of conviction for criminal offences

Sl. No.	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & punishment imposed	Maximum Punishment Imposed
1.	N/A	N/A	N/A
2.	N/A	N/A	N/A
3.	N/A	N/A	N/A

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency

FIH WOMEN'S WORLD CUP QUALIFIERS

Manisha's strike propels India into final against England

HYDERABAD: India, capitalising on a precise third-quarter penalty-corner strike from Manisha Chauhan, edged past Italy 1-0 in a tense semifinal to set up a highly anticipated title clash with England in the FIH Women's World Cup Qualifiers here on Friday.

Midfielder Manisha netted the decisive goal in the 40th minute after a fiercely contested first quarter, with both sides locked in a tight battle, relentlessly vying for possession.

India, having already secured a spot in the World Cup to be jointly hosted by the Netherlands and Belgium from August 15 to 30 this year, began assertively with a couple of powerful circle entries, but Italy quickly responded, mounting aggressive attacks and creating several promising goal-scoring opportunities.

However, India seized the momentum in the second quarter, with the hosts exploiting sharp flank runs, attacking in numbers, and making key circle entries to assert control over the game.

In the 18th minute, India won the first penalty corner of the game but Navneet Kaur's shot at goal was stopped well by Italian goalkeeper Lucia Ines Caruso. In the 27th minute, the hosts were awarded another penalty corner as India played out an interesting variation.

The ball was played back to the injector, captain Salima Tete, but her shot was stopped on the line by Italy's last defender, denying them a goal. In the 29th minute, India had another opportunity to score through a penalty corner but Navneet's shot went off target.

In the early minutes of the second half, Italy launched a strong attack on goal as Emilia Munitis was through on goal but India's goalkeeper Bichu Devi Kharibam came out and made a crucial save.

In the 40th minute, India were awarded yet another penalty corner and this time they successfully converted it to break the deadlock.

Manisha delivered a powerful dragflick down the middle that pierced through the Italian defence and found the net. India earned two early penalty corners in the final quarter in a bid to extend their lead, but Italy held firm with resolute defending.

Italy gave it their all in the final minutes of the match and won a crucial penalty corner in the 59th minute but India managed to deny their opposition the equaliser and emerged victorious.

Earlier, England defeated Scotland 2-0 in the other semifinal at the GMC Balayogi Hockey Ground. Lottie Bingham (25') and Drcy Bourne (29') scored the goals to book England's spot in the final. AGENCIES

Midfielder Manisha netted the decisive goal in the 40th minute after a fiercely contested first quarter, with both sides locked in a tight battle, relentlessly vying for possession

Key Points

- In the 29th minute, India had another opportunity to score through a penalty corner but Navneet's shot went off target
- In the 40th minute, India were awarded yet another penalty corner and this time they successfully converted it to break the deadlock

INDIA EARNED 2 EARLY PENALTY CORNERS IN THE FINAL QUARTER IN A BID TO EXTEND THEIR LEAD

India seized the momentum in the second quarter, with the hosts exploiting sharp flank runs

Sabalenka and Sinner move to BNP Paribas SFs

INDIAN WELLS: Aryna Sabalenka held off Victoria Mboko, 7-6(0) 6-4 in the quarterfinals of the BNP Paribas Open, keeping the top-ranked player in women's tennis in the running for her first title at Indian Wells.

Jannic Sinner, Alexander Zverev and Daniil Medvedev all advanced to the men's semifinals on Thursday, with Medvedev benefiting from a disputed, overturned point late in his 6-1 7-5 victory over defending champion Jack Draper.

Draper momentarily threw his arms to his side to signal he thought Medvedev's deep forehand had landed long during a rally that ended several shots later when Medvedev's backhand went into the net. Medvedev, already up one set, asked chair umpire Aurelie Tourte for a video review.

Tourte said that by rule, Draper's gesture was "something different than you would do normally," and that she felt compelled to award the point to Medvedev. AGENCIES

India could look at a new T20 captain beyond Suryakumar

S.KANNAN

NEW DELHI: Suryakumar Yadav must consider himself lucky India won the ICC T20 World Cup in Ahmedabad on Sunday under his leadership, despite a very dry run from his own bat. There has been a plethora of interviews of the captain as well as coach Gautam Gambhir, after the massive win against New Zealand.

One common thread, noticeable, is, how the template for Team India, post the triumph in the 2024 edition of the World Cup in the West Indies was "not to focus on individuals but the team."

This line of thinking, mentioned in the interviews, is a bit strange.

It clearly shows the captain and coach still have some grudge against Rohit Sharma, winning captain of the T20 World Cup in 2024, and his predecessor, Virat Kohli.

Just to jog the readers' memory, just after the win in the West Indies in 2024, Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli had bid goodbye to the T20 international format. Their only presence, today, in international cricket, is in the ODI format. In 2027, India will be competing in the ODI World Cup in South Africa, where it is expected both Kohli and Rohit Sharma will have important roles to play with Shubman Gill as captain.

Suryakumar Yadav

Looking at the calendar for Indian cricket, after the conclusion of the latest World Cup, the emphasis is on more ODIs. That has been accepted by the BCCI as well, with the tour to New Zealand, later this year, becoming a high profile one.

Back to Suryakumar Yadav, he had also said after the World Cup win, the next goal is the 2028 ICC T20 World Cup and the Olympics in Los Angeles, where cricket is a medal sport. Why Rohit and Kohli chose to retire from T20m internationals is well-known, they were not getting younger. Surya will turn 36 in September.

So, when the BCCI sits down and ideates, after the Indian Premier League (IPL) fever is over, the blueprint for the ODI World Cup, as well as the important events in 2028 will be debated upon.

It is hard to imagine the BCCI will go with Surya as captain in the T20 format, as he will turn 38 in 2028.

Add to it his lack of form, which began even before the World Cup, he has not looked one bit as a match-winner. By Surya's own admission in an interview there was a furore when India dropped vice-captain Axar Patel for the match against South Africa. For the record, the only time Surya did as well as he should was against the United States of America in the World Cup opener in Mumbai last month.

Surya has also been singing praise of "Jay Bhai" – Jay Shah, who was secretary of the BCCI in 2024. Today, Jay Shah is a big man as the ICC chairman. Decisions pertaining to Indian cricket will be taken by the BCCI, where, today, Devajit Saikia, as the secretary is fully empowered.

It is hard to imagine the BCCI not planning for a younger T20 captain who can handle the leadership role in 2028. Indeed, Surya being critical of two former teammates, indirectly, is surprising.

The world knows, Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli were in the T20 national team as performers. Even now, they are in the ODI mix, by sheer weight of performance.

OVER SUNRISERS LEEDS' SIGNING OF ABRAR

It doesn't concern us. It's not IPL: BCCI VP Shukla

NEW DELHI: The BCCI vice-president Rajeev Shukla on Friday downplayed the acquisition of Pakistan spinner Abrar Ahmed by Sunrisers Leeds during The Hundred auction, saying the development in an "overseas league" is beyond the board's ambit.

The Sunrisers Leeds, owned by Chennai-based media conglomerate Sun Group, on Thursday signed Pakistan mystery spinner Abrar during The Hundred player auction, making him the first Pakistan cricketer to be picked by an Indian-owned franchise in the tournament.

"It doesn't concern us. It's not the IPL. What happens in The Hundred or other overseas leagues, we have nothing to do with it," Shukla told PTI.

The franchise paid GBP 190,000 (approximately Rs 2.34 crore) for Abrar after a bidding contest with Trent Rockets. The tournament will be held from July 21 to August 16.

Sunrisers Leeds faced backlash following Abrar's signing, with the team's X account suspended briefly.

IPL franchises have not signed any Pakistani player since 2009 due to strained diplomatic relations between the two countries.

The Sun Group, which also owns Sunrisers Hyderabad in the IPL, completed a full takeover of the erstwhile Northern Superchargers last year, acquiring a 49 per cent stake from the ECB and the remaining 51 per cent from county club Yorkshire for around GBP 100 million. Sunrisers CEO Kavya Maran attended the Thursday's auction and raised the paddle during the bidding.

The group also owns Sunrisers Eastern Cape in SA20 but does not have a Pakistan player in its squad. AGENCIES

IPL franchises have not signed any Pakistani player since 2009 due to strained diplomatic relations between the two countries

Leisu

PRIYANKA RECALLS WITNESSING VIJAY'S STARDOM IN CHENNAI

The actress still remembers exactly what it felt like to watch the actor walk in

Priyanka Chopra was just 18, new to acting and fresh off her Miss World 2000 win, when she stepped onto the set of her first film, the Tamil production 'Thamizhan' in Chennai. What greeted her was a crowd of hundreds who had gathered simply to watch her co-star dance. That co-star was Vijay.

More than two decades after her first day on a film set, Priyanka still remembers exactly what it felt like to watch 'Thalapathy' Vijay walk in. In a recent interview on the 'Not Skinny But Not Fat' podcast, the actress looked back on her Tamil debut and described the scale of Vijay's stardom as something that genuinely stopped her in her tracks.

"It was a movie called 'Thamizhan' in the Tamil language. I remember the film; I phonetically learned the language. It's almost impossible to learn a completely new language that quickly. But it was my first exposure to fame through my co-actor. His name is Vijay and he is extremely popular," Chopra recalled.

She described the experience as a culture shock that reshaped her understanding of what celebrity could look like

The actress described the experience as a culture shock that reshaped her understanding of what celebrity could look like. Watching hundreds of people gather on set just to see Vijay dance, she said, felt like witnessing a demigod.

Beyond the spectacle of Vijay's fan following, Priyanka was paying close attention to how he carried himself when the cameras were not rolling. She recalled that he had tremendous humility on set and that once he arrived, he never left. He stayed, spoke to the crew, understood the shots being taken and remained present throughout the day. AGENCIES

My heart is full: Aditya Dhar

He is gearing up for the release of his film 'Dhurandhar: The Revenge'

Dhurandhar' director Aditya Dhar said he feels overwhelmed with a sense of gratitude for the faith the audience has shown in his work over the years.

Dhar, who is gearing up for the release of his film 'Dhurandhar: The Revenge', celebrated his 43rd birthday on Thursday and shared a post on his 'Instagram' handle, in which he expressed gratitude to his team and fans.

"As I spend my birthday adding the final touches on 'Dhurandhar: The Revenge', I find myself pausing for a moment and looking back at the phenomenal year that has gone by," he wrote.

He added, "Sitting here today, I feel an overwhelming sense of gratitude for the journey, for the team who has always walked beside me and for the faith so many of you have shown in my work over the years."

The director said his 'heart is full' and the trust of the audience means everything. "Reading all your messages, tweets, stories and all the peak detailing by Aditya Dhar memes, my heart is full. I wish I could personally respond to each one of you, but please know how deeply I value all your love and encouragement."

He added, "None of this is something I take for granted. In an industry where nothing is guaranteed and every film is a leap of faith, the trust of the audience means everything... If this year has taught me anything, it is never to lose belief in your dreams, however big they might be. Show up with honesty. Give your work everything you have. And the universe will respond. PTI

He feels overwhelmed with a sense of gratitude for the faith the audience has shown in his work over the years

FRAMES OF ETERNITY

The Monochrome Chronicles of Roshan Lal Chopra

The India International Centre (IIC) has organised 'Frames of Eternity - The Monochrome Chronicles of Roshan Lal Chopra: A Retrospective Photo Exhibition'.

Curated by Ravi Chopra and Dr Shobhana Radhakrishna, this exhibition showcases the rare black-and-white photographs of Roshan Lal Chopra. Spanning Delhi's evolving landscape, everyday life, political upheavals and prominent leaders, the works reflect his distinguished career in photojournalism. The exhibition forms an evocative visual archive of immense social and historical significance.

The exhibition will remain open daily from 11 am to 7 pm at IIC's Art Gallery (Main). MPOST